



Reconquista and Riposte in Spain
1085-1086

by Volko Ruhnke



BACKGROUND BOOK

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STRATEGY TIPS

Here two ace play testers give us their advice on skilful play of Almoravid, first a player specialized in the Christian side, then one focused on the Muslims.

From John Campbell:

Hopefully, you're familiar with *Nevsky* and can get right into things with a cursory reading of scenario rules and the slight changes from that great game. If you are new to *Levy & Campaign*, then fear not! The rules are well written and hopefully with this little play guide you'll be off and running.

Levy. You'll begin by drawing Capabilities prior to Levying, but this should rarely impact your overall seasonal Campaign. Look at the map and decide what objective you want to go for. Is it a large prize such as Toledo or Zaragoza or just border reiving? If Besieging a Fortress or City is your aim, then how many Lords will you need to Besiege it and equip and guard your Supply Route? How many Command cards will you delegate to the Besieging army?

You will quickly learn that you can't do everything at once and you cannot do everything on all fronts, so it is better to decide on a particular objective and plan for that. How big of a force do you need? Lords with six or fewer units counting Mules only require one Provender when they move or fight. Do you need to cross any mountain Passes? If so, Mules can be very handy.

But will a Lord all alone with just five units and a Mule be strong enough not to worry about an enemy counterattack? I almost lost Pedro Ansúrez once when I left him to defend the Siegeworks at Toledo alone in Spring 1085 and al-Mutamid's host fell upon him. If you max out then you are tough as nails but not very maneuverable as it probably will require three Provender to feed a Lord's forces, in which case you'll need to be within Transport distance to a Seat to be able to Feed all those extra soldiers.

One thing to do in Muster is add Capability cards; they are really important. So, assuming you didn't end your previous Campaign sitting in Enemy Territory and you can Muster, look at the situation and what a Capability might do. For instance, Ravaging-related Capabilities are great early on, but, as more Locales become Ravaged, other Capabilities become important. If you are expecting Battle, then combat Capabilities are critical (especially for the Taifa Lords, as cards can multiply their force by a factor of two or more).

But remember: when you Levy a Capability, you are taking the Event on that card out of play. As the Christians, for example, I use the ADALIDES Capability extensively, especially for King Alfonso, so as a result the SWOLLEN RIVER and DEVALUATION Events end up almost always out of play for me. In my experience, Events that shift Enemy Service are potent; so I often don't take the Capabilities on those cards.

In the early game, for the Christians I suggest ADALIDES for faster movement past Strongholds and CABALGADAS for long-distance Ravaging cards, and for the Muslim Taifa Lords Missile (AQQARA, ALRAMA, HARBAH, SLINGERS) and extra Command (HASHAM)

Capability cards. The extra Command action that HASHAM can confer to a Lord during Campaign is very valuable: going from 2 Command to 3 doesn't seem like much, but trust me it is, as it's an extra move or Provender.

BATTERING RAM and, for the Christians, BISHOPRICS are quite valuable as well. I almost always want to have a BATTERING RAM on hand, and the extra fighting power of the Bishops spread across three Lords helps a great deal. A Bishop will raise the Feeding requirements of most Lords' armies except Alfonso's to two Provender. But, personally, I like running most Christian Lords at 11-12 units plus Mules and perhaps Alfonso at just six total.

Campaign. Dedicate enough Command cards to get where you need to go. That includes earmarking some for the gathering of provisions as well as March. It does you little good to get to Toledo with insufficient Provender and too little Transport to be sure of drawing more.

Pay attention to your Lords' surroundings in a couple of ways. First, be careful to have a clear path for Avoiding Battle or Retreating if defeated. This is usually not too hard in that the map is fairly large with lots of connecting ways and roads. But Retreat over a mountain Pass will get you good if you don't have Mules: Carts with Provender are Laden over Passes so cannot carry your Provender over them when you Avoid or Retreat.

Second, know and Plan for where your Lords are going to be at the end of Campaigning, because that will determine whether or not individual Lords can do anything in the following Levy phase. Outside of your home Territory, a Conquered Stronghold is the only place that gives you the ability during Muster to add Capabilities and Levy Vassals. It's almost always best to have them end up in Friendly Locales. Sometimes, you may need to leave them on Enemy or Neutral ground, but keep in mind that they will suffer Wastage and, if outside of Friendly Locales, not be able to Levy in the next 40 Days. Furthermore, if you want to Pay a Lord with Loot to extend his Service, you will similarly need a Friendly Locale. This is very important, as *Almoravid* typically features tons of Ravaging, making Loot a key aspect of prolonging your Campaigns.

Strongholds in *Almoravid* are very tough. Expect a full seven-to-eight cards with BATTERING RAMS to take down a City. I prefer to starve Fortresses by Siege, but they can be Stormed, albeit usually with losses. Ravaging a Locale that you will be Besieging or Storming will benefit you in the short term (easier to get to Surrender and you gain Provender and Loot), but will become ½ VP for the Enemy once the Stronghold is yours. Generally speaking, I Ravage then Siege, as I am averse to the casualties risked in Storm.

If you want to keep your Lords in the field, you're going to have to Pay them to extend their Service. Keep an eye on the Calendar to see when each of your Lords' Service (and that of Vassals, if using the advanced rule) is due to end. (By the way, playing with advanced Service markers and hidden mats really ups the game, and, honestly, I don't know if I myself would play it any other way.) If Service limits are coming up soon and you don't want to let anyone Disband, you may have to plan on finishing the Campaign in a suitable place: you can only

use Loot in Friendly Locales, and Loot, as noted above, is key (especially for the Christians) for keeping Lords on the map up to the first Winter turn.

You will want to keep all your Christian Lords in play indefinitely if possible (difficult if you have hired El Cid). The impetus, at least early on, is on you to get gains in Taifa Territory. And you will want to cover León and Aragón against Muslim raids.

The Taifa Lords are a little different. For example, it can be a good choice if you cannot defend a Taifa to let that Taifa Lord Disband, go Parias and pay tribute, lest all the Locales there get Ravaged. Early Campaigns are going to be tough on the Muslims as Alfonso VI and his loyal Lords will run around Ravaging and Sieging. But the Taifa lords can catch Alfonso unawares (as happened to me on the outskirts of Toledo one late Autumn morning). Once the Almoravid generals are summoned and arrive with their considerable forces, the tides turn quite quickly. The hunters become the hunted, and careful resource management, card selection, and movement become critically important for the Christian Lords. One wrong engagement with the Almoravids, and the Christians will be lucky to have anyone left to get back north.

El Cid. What can I say about him? You can't have a proper Reconquista without this legend. As the rules for his use evolved, I made many efforts with Rodrigo in employ (both as Christian and as Muslim). I prefer to lessen my variables and employ him as soon as I can afford it operationally. El Cid is high-risk/high-reward in the sense that you may hire him and then have an Event pull him away. Personally, however, I think the rewards usually outweigh the risks, so I hire him often.

As a Christian player, I like to employ him for two reasons. First, it will mean that he is not my enemy. This is very important because, if you are faced off against El Cid in Muslim employ, you must be very wary, as he is instantly the Muslims' best general until the two Almoravid Lords arrive. Second, I can use him to strike from afar (up to five Locales away with a MESNADA). And if an enemy is unfortunate enough to be on an open plain or outside a hostile Stronghold, EL CID can pull SWOLLEN RIVER from the deck to pin the enemy in Battle. And I've found Rodrigo quite effective in Storm as well.

Cards that work really well with the Cid include not only MESNADA and (most importantly) EL CID but also ALFÉREZ and AL-FARAJ. This last one is really good when you are defending against the Almoravid Lords because it can bleed them of their hidden Held cards. Many times, for speed, I ran El Cid with just his starting retinue of six units. But keep in mind that Rodrigo can Muster a Bishop, which helps a lot. I am sure others will find more ingenious ways to use such a capable commander and push his limits.

I hope you enjoy this wonderful game. I know that I certainly have and will for the rest of my years.

From Phil Dreher:

Many of you, probably most of you, are smarter than I am. Hopefully, you will digest this game, dissect its mechanics, and synthesize strategies of pure brilliance beyond my pitiful comprehension. I hope here only to share with you some observations earned by much trial and more error, to help you understand the forces of *al-Andalus*.

Your Lords. Let's start with a review of your Lords. It may be tempting to look over at the Christian player's Lords with envy, fantasizing about large armored detachments and abundant reserves of Vassal troops waiting to be called up. Tempting, yes, but not fruitful. Your forces benefit from your strategic posture—you don't need to crush the Christians, just to survive them. We might divide Muslim Lords generally into three tiers:

(1) The other Taifa Lords. The motley assortment of Lords around al-Mutamid has better things to do than join his war effort to beat back Christendom, and this is partially reflected in their measly Lordship Ratings of "1". Generally, they have few if any Armored units and have single-unit Vassals. Tooling them up for Battle is painfully slow. You will want to look to pair up these Lords into Lieutenants with Lower Lords to take advantage of Shared Transport and to put on a more threatening face for war. There's also no shame in leaving one of these Lords at home—for instance Abd Allah in Granada—just to deprive the Christians of VP for Parias and to collect Tax revenue.

(2) Al-Mutamid. A reliable Lord and the main workhorse of my campaigns: he's the most similar to some of the more well-rounded Christian Lords. Lordship of "2" may not seem like much, but as the only Taifa Lord with Lordship more than "1", you will be grateful for it. It's not hard to Levy his multi-unit Vassal with a Transport and quickly have a scrappy combat force at your command. Most of my turns involved all al-Mutamid's Command cards.

(3) Yusuf and Sir. Monster power and monster appetites: while the Almoravids are in the field, the Christian player finally has something to fear! But when playing scenarios that involve these Lords, you will need to think about how you are going to keep them going. Are you going to spend Levy actions adding DAWUD IBN AISHA or AL-YAZIRAT AL-HADRA to boost the power of their Supply actions? Are you going to spend Campaign actions taking in Tax revenue to pay these armies to stay in the field on starvation rations? (I was partial to the latter—indeed a substantial part of my 1085 strategy was accruing revenue to the Taifas Box to fund an explosive sprint from the Almoravids.)

Taifa Politics. You may not have the flashiest troops or the most dedicated generals, but you certainly have some tricks up your sleeve. Taifa Politics are a potentially devastating weapon for you. A well-timed switch of a particular Taifa from Independent to Parias not only can stanch the Victory Point bleeding in an overwhelmed province, it also can confound the Christians' whole game plan. You essentially have the power to decide where the war will be fought.

So, bear Taifa Politics in mind, particularly at the beginning of your turn, when you're making your decisions about which Lords to Pay in order to keep them in the field. Yes, allowing a Taifa Lord to Disband concedes Coin and a VP to the Christians—but they are suddenly stuck in Neutral Territory. If they are not currently Besieging the Reconquista targets for that Taifa, they will not be able to push the Territory into Reconquista. Indeed, they will not be able to gain any points at all unless they are already outside a Stronghold and are willing to give you Jihad points first, or if you already have some Jihad there.

The especially devious among you will figure out how to bait the Christian into a big fight on one front, only to have the local Taifa Lord starve himself into Disbanding in the middle of the Campaign phase. The Christian player who spent so many Levy actions and Command cards targeting that Taifa will find Christian Lords overinvested in a Campaign that will yield no more profit.

Preparation. More so than for any faction in the *Levy & Campaign Series*, the Muslims in *Almoravid* need to think through the Levy phase. Remember, you bought a *Levy & Campaign* game. Fifty percent of the purchase price went into the Levying. As the Muslim player, you are going to become an artist proficient at Levy or die in the attempt.

Those of you familiar with *Nevsky* should know the basics already: Your Lords really need Capabilities to shine. Sending a Lord into Battle without some kind of ranged weaponry or to a Siege without some kind of siege engines is just begging for trouble. John knew that, if he was going into Battle with my troops, his forces were sure to eat a hail of slung stones and crossbow bolts before they closed to Melee range. I went into Battle wary of the same. Unprepared Lords die, and dead Lords don't win wars.

First point to keep in mind: with your coterie of 1 Lordship emirs, the Wastage can undo your entire turn. My stupid brain spent many turns realizing too late that giving al-Mutawakkil an extra Cart was not terribly helpful if he was just going to Waste it at the end of the turn anyway. So be mindful of this—either have your Lords take a diversity of Assets during Levy (a Lord with two Carts must Waste something, a Lord with a Cart and Mule alone Wastes nothing), or be prepared to have a Lord take a Supply action so that he can at least Waste Provender instead of Transport.

Second: Have a division of labor for your Lords. I at least found this helpful. Some of my Lords were there to sit back and Tax. They were also there to help Levy global Capabilities so that I could free up the forward Lords to take on precious Transport Assets and weapons Capabilities.

Third: As always, mind where your Lords end up. If they do not end up in Friendly territory, they will lose their Levy. You already know this, of course, because you are smarter than me. But don't forget that Parias Taifas are not Friendly Territory unless there are Jihad markers. They are just as much foreign territory for you as they are for the Christian player, and you need to plan the end of your turns accordingly. Forgetting that, say, Valencia has turned Neutral can pull the rug out from under your meticulously crafted plans.

Lose slowly. Remember that as the Muslim player you can afford to lose here and there. It's unlikely that you will be restoring the Caliphate to its former glory, menacing Christendom beyond the Pyrenees. Instead, you will be stalling and frustrating your Christian enemies, carrying out a Ravage there, staving off a Siege here, suddenly allowing a Taifa to switch to Parias to throw a wrench in the enemy's plan. If you can occasionally capture a Leonese Stronghold, so much the better. Just remember that your goal is to make conquering Al-Andalus an agonizing quagmire.

The world is now flat. Other than the historical setting, the most immediate and obvious difference between *Nevsky* and *Almoravid* is the diminished importance of Seasons. *Nevsky* seemed to pit each player against the Baltic climate as much as against each other. Each season was a bit like playing a different game—a long season with complicated Transport, two short Seasons with simple Transport, and a mid-sized Season with very restricted Transport.

Almoravid's transportation system is much simplified, its Seasons much less volatile. The difference between a 7-turn and 8-turn Campaign phase is meaningful but much more subtle than the variation among Seasons in *Nevsky*.

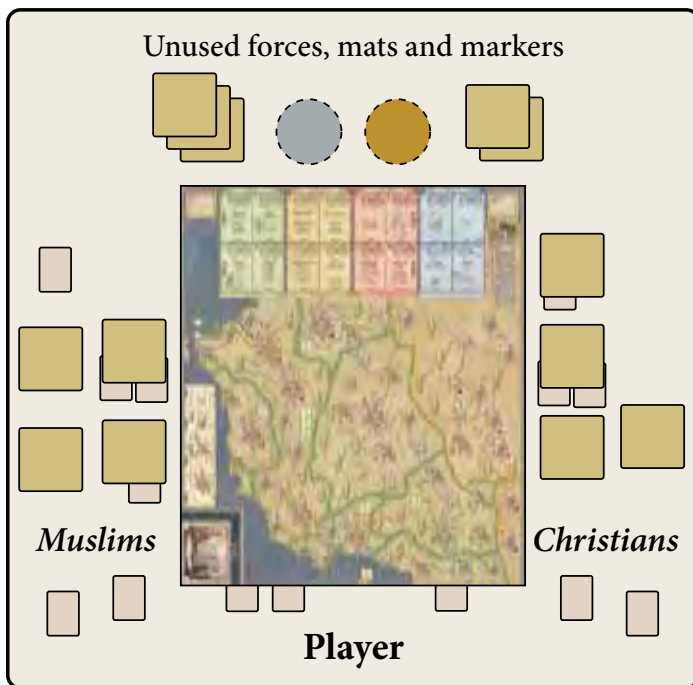
Use fog of war. Some of you may be fog of war skeptics. I was once like you. Content. Complacent. Dare I say—afraid—to break the chains of habit. If you look at the rules for Hidden Mats and dismiss them as some eccentric variant meant only for the most decadent board-gaming hedonists, you are missing out on a fairly simple tweak to the rules that greatly enriches the experience.

Once you have learned the rules and are comfortable that you and your opponent can reliably enforce them, it's time to start playing Hidden Mats. The whole game speeds up since players can mostly conduct the Levy phase simultaneously. You will have to account for a few edge cases in which one player gets priority, like the COUNT OF BARCELONA Capability card, but these are fairly rare. Fog of war ramps up the tension and enriches the options for the Campaign phase. Even if you can guess at an opposing army's size and resources based on the summoned Vassals, food needs, and previous casualties, you will never quite know what Capabilities that army has brought along. If you have a strong enough army, it might just be worth it to accept a Battle just to get a peek at the enemy's forces.

Play to win. My frequent playtest partner John often expressed his predilection for reenacting the historical course of events and for carrying out actions that he thought were operationally sensible, even if they did not result in direct VP profits. Many of you may feel the same way. Even Volko appears sympathetic to that point of view. I say this is sentimentalist hogwash! Break the game! Exploit the rules! Diverge from history and win at any cost!

Solitaire or Team Play

Solitaire. *Almoravid* includes no solitaire system, but a single player readily can handle both sides. Arrange the table as suggested in the illustration below or however preferred and alternate in the Christian and Muslim roles by the normal sequence of play. The only information that one side hides from the other will be Held Event cards (3.1.3) and Command Plan card stacks (4.1). Keeping these cards face down whenever playing the other side can help you forget their contents. Alternatively, keep all these cards face up throughout play—doing so somewhat alters decision-making, but the game will still work well. Either way, simply alternate making the best decisions that you can for each side with the information that you have available.



Team Play. To play *Almoravid* with two players on a side, one Christian player is Alfonso, the other chooses any Christian Lord (on or off map). One Muslim player is Yusuf (even if not in play) while the other chooses any other Muslim Lord. Split remaining Lords as evenly as able between teammates. Each player takes all his Lords' Levy and Command actions. All other decisions fall to the Alfonso or Yusuf players.

EXAMPLES OF PLAY

The following examples, while far from exhaustive, will help get you going with a walkthrough of several of the game's more common or more involved procedures. Rules references appear in parentheses. On Battle, see also the Battle of Sagradas Minigame starting page 44.

Taifa Politics

Almoravid features a political underlay to its simulation of military operations in 11th-Century Spain, to account for the weakness of the *taifas* as states, the *parias* tribute arrangements that bound them to the Christian kingdoms, and the advances that León's King Alfonso VI made in "reconquering" Muslim territory. The Taifa Politics rules in section 1.4 can be a daunting read ahead of play. Therefore, it may be better at first to just go ahead and play while keeping in mind these three general aspects:

- Taifas change status among Independent, Parias, or Neutral depending on whether their Lord is on the map and who controls their Cities (1.4.1).
- Taifa Territory is Muslim if Independent, Neutral if Parias, or Christian if Reconquista (1.4.2).
- Jihad markers are like mini-Conquered markers for the Muslims, rendering any Stronghold in a Taifa Muslim-Friendly (1.4.4).

Whenever a Taifa's status is to change (1.4.1, 1.4.3), refer to the separate Taifa Politics reference sheet for the steps to adjust from one status to another.

Here we walk through two examples of how to adjust Taifa status: Alfonso's historical Reconquista of Toledo and his attempted suppression of resistance by Zaragoza's al-Mustain. (In each case, we have altered some details from history, so as to illustrate as many different rules as able.)

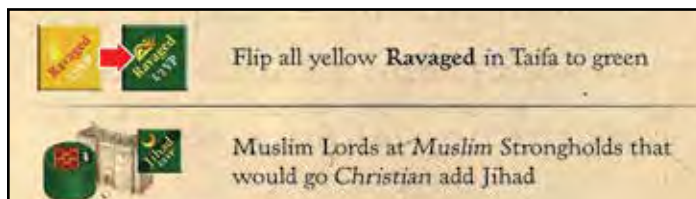
The Conquest of Toledo. The Christians are campaigning in the Taifa of Toledo. Toledo Taifa, uniquely, is always either in Parias or *Reconquista* in status. This is because the third possible status, Independent, requires that that Taifa's Muslim Lord be on the map, and Toledo has no Taifa Lord in the game (Taifa Politics Reference sheet, 1.4.1, 1.5.1 TAIFA LORDS). Until the Taifa's City is Conquered, it is at Parias—its Territory and Locales default to Neutral status (because its ruler is paying off the Christians).

Toledo City in this scenario, however, had one or more Jihad markers on it (representing, in this case, Muslim resistance to the Emir's payment of *parias*). The Jihad markers provide VP to the Muslim side, but they also allow the Christians to attack the City: the Toledo Locale would be Neutral due to Parias but is Friendly to the Muslim Side and Enemy to the Christians because of Jihad (1.4.2, 1.4.4).

Taking advantage of that pretext, King Alfonso's army Besieged and has just succeeded via Surrender in Conquering Toledo City (4.5.1). Conquest of the Taifa's only City (as it has no printed Seats) immediately adjusts the Taifa's status from Parias to Reconquista (1.4.1). (Note the Reconquista target map symbol at

Toledo City.) The player flips the Taifa's Parias marker to its Reconquista side and immediately adds 2 Victory Points (VP) to the Christian score on the Calendar—the difference between the 3 VP for Reconquista and the 1 VP previously awarded for Parias (5.1). Note that the added VP for Reconquista are in addition to the 3 VP that the Christians would have just gained for Conquered markers on Toledo City (4.5.1).

The players next refer to the Taifa Politics Reference sheet to find the summary of what else happens when a Taifa changes from Parias to Reconquista (also set out in detail in rule section 1.4.3). They find this summary within the "Adjust Status" section of the sheet, in a yellow box "Parias to Reconquista".



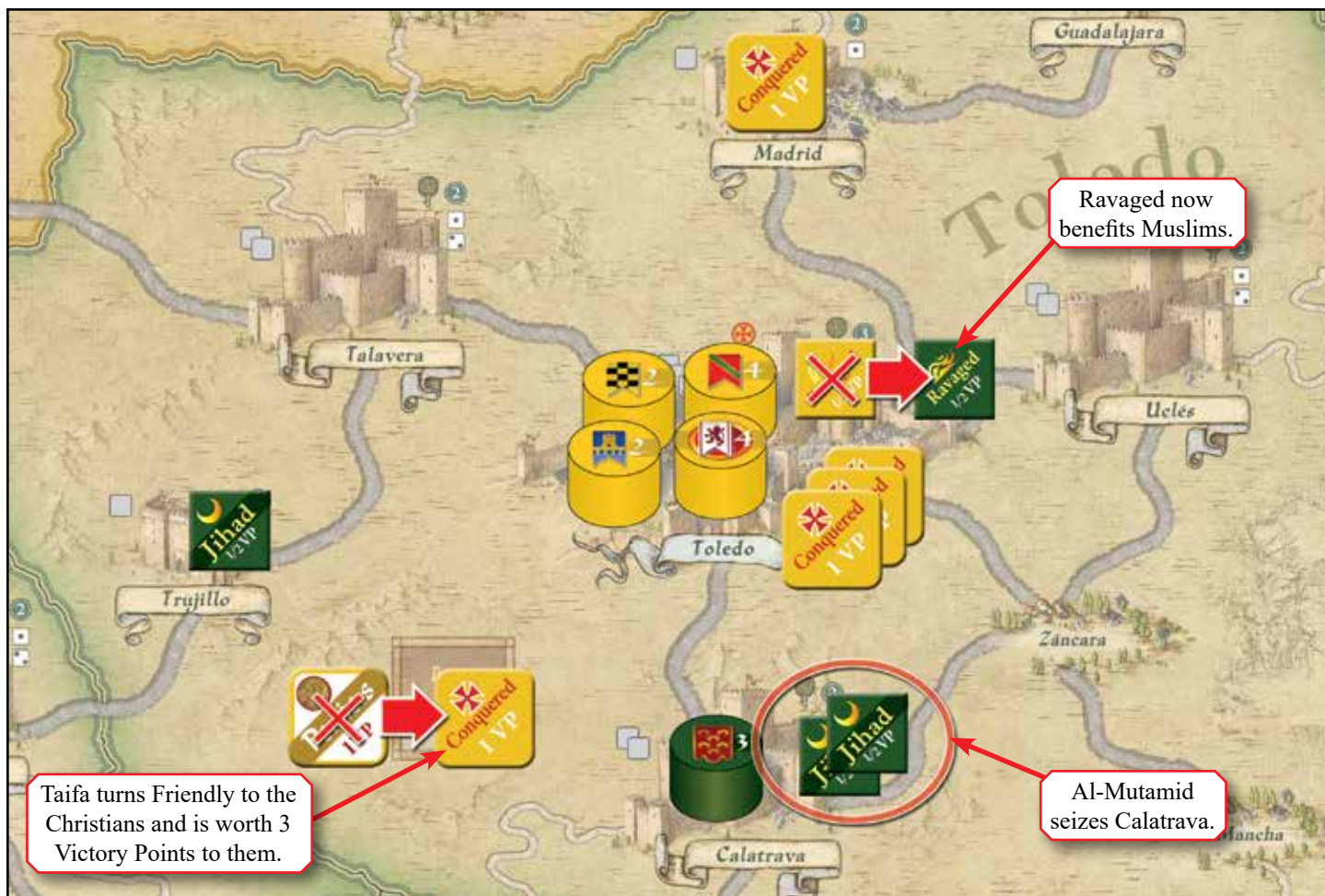
There, the players see that yellow (Christian) Ravaged markers anywhere within the Taifa flip to green (Muslim, 4.5.1 Ravaged Land). This represents the fact that Christian lords will now claim and control the area, so damage done to the land no longer credits them but rather the enemy. "You broke it, you own it", you could say!

There is only one yellow Ravaged marker on the map within the borders of Toledo Taifa, at Toledo City, where Alfonso's army had Ravaged earlier both to help Feed its forces and speed the City's Surrender (4.5.1). The player flips that Ravage marker to green, immediately reducing the Christians' VP count on the Calendar by ½ point and adding ½ VP to the Muslim score (5.1).

The second and final item of procedure listed in the Parias to Reconquista box is that any previously Neutral Locales with Muslim Lords—which would now default to Enemy to them—instead receive Jihad markers and become Friendly to the Muslim side (1.4.2, 1.4.3 HOSTAGE POPULACE). What is happening here is that a Muslim army in or in the vicinity of an officially Neutral Stronghold is in effect Conquering it (though without Sacking it or receiving any Spoils). Whenever Muslim Lords Conquer a Stronghold in a Taifa, they place Jihad markers instead of Conquered markers (1.3.1 Conquering, 1.4.4, 4.5.1).

The Muslim Lord al-Mutamid happens at the moment to be at the Fortress of Calatrava. Therefore, the player puts two Jihad markers at Calatrava (because a Fortress's Victory value is two, per the Strongholds table) and adds a full 1 VP to the Muslim score (5.1). The Conquered and Jihad markers elsewhere in the Taifa remain as is.

That's it, the Reconquista of Toledo Taifa is done—if Alfonso can hold on to it!



The Conquest of Toledo City causes the adjustment of Toledo Taifa's status from Parias to Reconquista.

The Disband of al-Mustain. Let's have a look next at what happens when the Lord of an Independent Taifa Disbands. The Christian Kings Alfonso and Sancho have been Besieging al-Mustain, the Muslim Lord of Zaragoza, inside his capital City. The Christian army has been too weak to either advance their Siegeworks or Storm the City's Walls. But penning al-Mustain up inside the Stronghold has cleared the way for the Christians to Ravage much of the Taifa, which has shortened al-Mustain's Service (his eagerness to fight, 4.7.2 ENFORCING PARIAS). Besieged inside Zaragoza City, moreover, al-Mustain cannot draw Coin from the Taifas box to extend his Service (1.3.3, 3.2.1). In our example, his time has run out: he is at his Service limit and Disbands to the Calendar (3.3.2).

Until this moment, Zaragoza Taifa was Independent because it had both an Unconquered City or Seat (Zaragoza City) and its Taifa Lord on the map (al-Mustain). That second condition no longer applies. Nor does the condition for Reconquista of Zaragoza—the Conquest of all of its Cities/Seats (Reconquista targets) apply. Therefore, Zaragoza enters the only remaining possible status: *Parias* (1.4.1, Taifa Politics reference sheet Conditions line).

Because al-Mustain is a Taifa Lord, the players now proceed with steps to adjust his Taifa's status as part of his Disband (1.5.1, 1.4.3, 3.3.2). After placing al-Mustain's cylinder from the map onto the Calendar four boxes ahead (as his Service rating is "4"), setting aside his mat, and discarding any "This Lord"

Capability cards there, the players put a *Parias* marker on the map in Zaragoza's green Taifa status holding square, covering up the word "Independent". As the *Parias* marker reminds, this new status awards the Christian side 1 VP, which the players mark on the Calendar (1.4.2, 5.1).

<i>Independent to Parias</i>		
	= Service	Christians add Coin equal to Service of Disbanded Taifa Lord
		Muslim Lords at Muslim Strongholds that would go Neutral add Jihad (Conquer them)
		Christian Lords at Muslim Strongholds that would go Neutral either remove Siege/Bypass OR add Jihad (markers equal to value)

The players then consult the "Independent to *Parias*" text box on the Taifa Politics sheet. First, the sheet's text reminds them that part of Disbanding any Taifa Lord is to pay the Christian Lords *Parias* Coin—tribute—equal to the Service rating of the Disbanding Lord. That means that the Christian player now distributes as desired four Coin among any Unbesieged Christian Lords' mats (1.4.3, 3.3).

Next, players check whether any Muslim Lords are at Strongholds in the Taifa that were Friendly to them but would now become Neutral because the Taifa is now *Parias* (1.4.2). At each such Stronghold, the Muslim player would add Jihad markers equal to its value, similar to what we saw occur with al-Mutamid at Calatrava in the previous example (1.4.3). There are no Muslim Lords left within Zaragoza Taifa, so that step is checked off.



Disband of the Taifa Lord al-Mustain makes his Taifa of Zaragoza a Parias state.



Finally, the third item in the text box concerns Christian Lords at Strongholds that were Enemy to them but would now turn Neutral. Here, the Christian player has a choice: either recognize that Locale's new Neutrality by removing any Siege or Bypass markers there, or keep the Stronghold Enemy (in hopes of later Conquering it) by adding Jihad markers (1.4.3 RECOGNITION OF NEUTRALITY?).

This choice applies in our example to Alfonso and Sancho Besieging Zaragoza City and to García Ordóñez, who has been holding the Supply Route to Zaragoza open by Bypassing the Muslim Fortress of Tudela (4.3.5, 4.6.1). To maintain the Siege of Zaragoza would now call for placing three Jihad markers there (the City's value, 1.4.4), which would immediately award the Muslim side 1½ VP. The Christian player decides that the City Stronghold is too tough to Conquer by Surrender or Storm. So, the Christians avoid creating an Enemy of the City and instead recognize its Neutrality by removing the Siege marker there.

At Tudela, however, the Christian player decides to try for a Conquest. Because Conquest of a Neutral Stronghold is not possible, the Christians maintain their Bypass of Tudela

Fortress with García Ordóñez and reluctantly add two Jihad markers there (the value of a Fortress Locale). The new Jihad markers add up to +1 VP for the Muslims, recorded on the Calendar. That award, as it happens here, counters the +1VP that the Christians just received for imposing Parias upon the Taifa!

The players have completed the adjustment of Zaragoza's Taifa status from Independent to Parias. The Ravaged markers in the Taifa are not affected, nor would be any other Jihad, Conquered, or Seat markers.

Muster

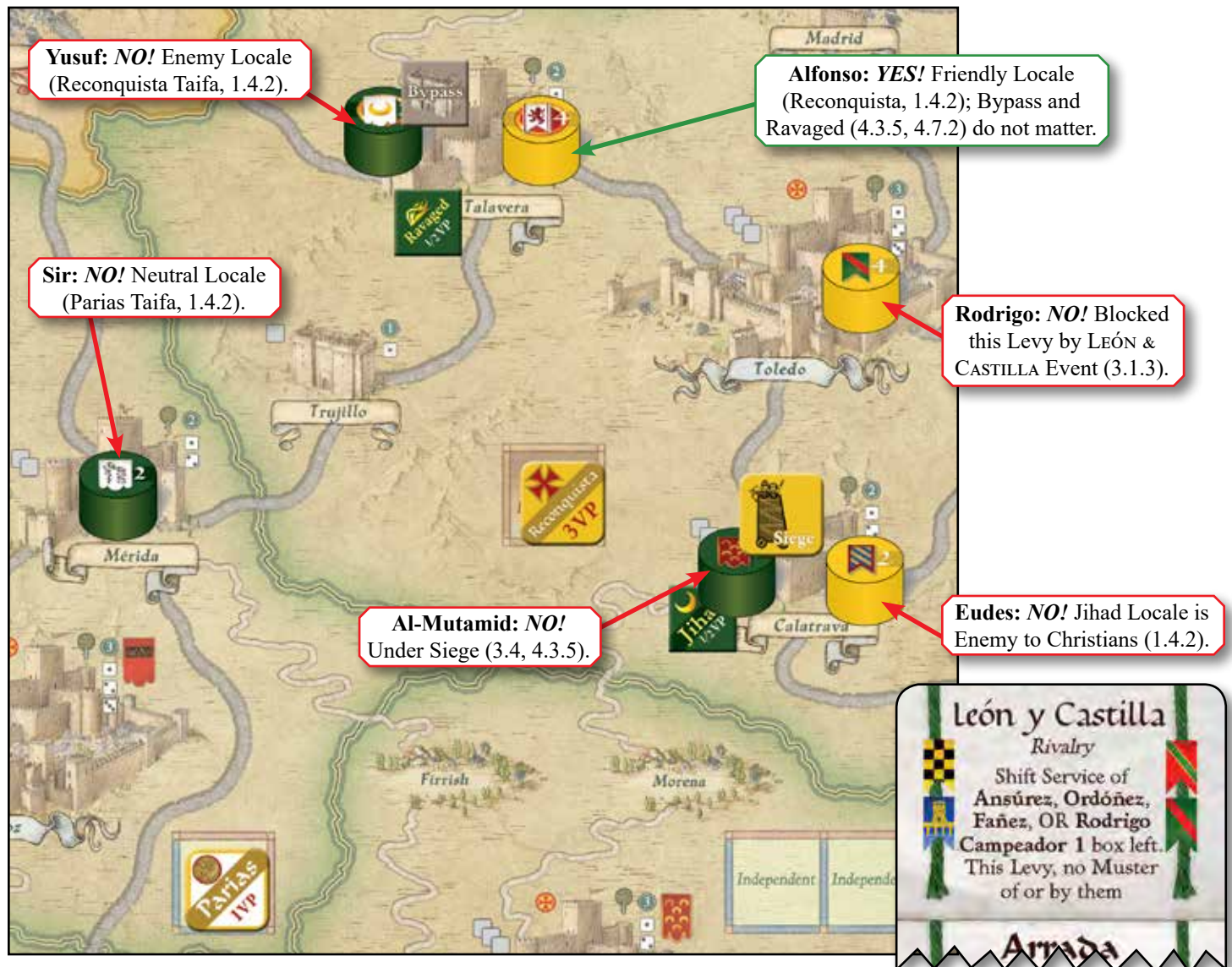
Each 40-day turn of *Almoravid* begins with a Levy phase in five segments—Arts of War, Pay, Disband, Muster, and Call to Arms—not all of which typically will apply. Grab the player aid foldout, turn to the Sequence of Play sheet, and track down the list under “Levy” in the top half of the sheet to carry out each step of each segment. The most involved player decisions almost always will occur during the Muster segment, when Lords equip themselves for the Campaign to follow. So here we will have a look at

Muster in detail. The corresponding section of the Rules of Play is 3.4, including subsections 3.4.1 to 3.4.4.

Typically, both players will carry out their Muster steps at the same time since the actions of each are independent. Technically, however, the Christians go first (2.2.4, 3.4); so, the Muslim player may if desired wait to see what the Christian player does (outside of the Hidden Mats Option, 1.5.2) before committing to any actions during Muslim Muster.

Who can Muster? A sound way to begin one's Muster segment is to determine which Lords on the map will be able to act now. Even if one Lord Musters another Lord onto the map, that newly arriving Lord will not be allowed to participate in Muster this turn (3.4), so the roster of Lords using actions this segment will not change.

To use Lordship to take Levy actions during Muster, a Lord must be at a Friendly Locale on the map and not be Besieged (3.4). Look over the illustration here, which includes some potentially tricky cases. The Sequence of Play sheet, by the way, has a handy text box summarizing what makes a place Friendly, Enemy, or Neutral.



Sample cases of which Lords may and which may not take part in Muster (3.4).

Use of Lordship for Levy Actions. Let us then walk through the Muster segment for just one Lord, in this case, Alfonso. Lords during Muster acquire stuff by expending Levy actions up to their Lordship rating, each action obtaining one thing. The Lord's mat shows his Lordship rating in a shield shape: for Alfonso, the great King of León, that is a generous "3" (1.5.3).

The Sequence of Play sheet handily lists the four options for how to spend those actions under "Muster" as "[a]", "[b]", "[c]", and "[d]". In the Rules of Play, you can find them described in detail as cases 3.4.1 through 3.4.4. In short, they are to attempt to bring another Lord into play, to bring a Vassal's forces onto the Lord's mat, or to add a Transport or a card.

You can mix or match these options any way you like, several of one and none of the others, one of each, in any order, as long as you complete one Lord's actions before moving on to the next (3.4). Here the Christian player decides Alfonso's three actions will be to 1) Muster a Vassal, 2) add a card, and 3) roll once to Muster another Lord.

To Muster a Vassal, simply slide a Vassal Service marker from the "Assets & Vassals" area of that Lord's mat forward into the "Forces" area and add the corresponding wooden unit pieces onto or near the marker (3.4.2). The Vassal must be "Ready", meaning

with its Service marker face-up in "Assets & Vassals". In most cases, that will be so for any Vassals of that Lord that have not already Mustered to the "Forces" area.

The exception is if you have chosen to play with the Vassal Service Advanced Rule of 3.4.2, which tracks Vassal Service limits and Disband in a similar way to that of Lords (3.3). We won't cover the details here, but this more complicated rule instead places the Mustering Vassal's Service marker onto the Calendar and can lead to Vassals becoming Unready (face down on the mat) or even permanently removed from play.

In our example, the player chooses Alfonso's Vassal marker that shows three units, slides it up on the mat and adds the three units shown to the mat.

To add a card, look through those currently in your Arts of War cards deck—all those not currently in play in any way or Held as Events—and choose any Capability (lower half of the card) that bears a pennant symbol that matches or includes the Lord involved (1.9.1, 3.1.3, 3.4.4). If the Capability includes the words "this Lord" (in bold italics), then tuck the top half of the card under the Lord's mat, otherwise under the map-board's edge. Note that there is only room for two cards along a mat's edge: a reminder that that is the limit of "this Lord" cards that a Lord can have.



Alfonso during Muster uses his Lordship of "3" for three Levy actions: 1) Muster a Vassal (3.4.2), 2) put a Capabilities card into play (3.4.4), and 3) roll to Muster another Lord—unsuccessfully, in this case (3.4.1). Adding three units to his mat from the MILITES card cost him an Asset not an action.

Our Christian player has selected the **MILITES** Capability. It does not say “this Lord” so goes at the map edge as shown. The player immediately carries out the instructions on the card to place unit pieces there. The Capability allows Lords to obtain these units if participating in Muster, at the price of any one Asset (3.4.2). Therefore, Alfonso may now add some units by removing one Asset—the player chooses one of Alfonso’s two Provender—with-out using any Levy action.

To Muster another Lord, check that Lord’s Fealty rating at the top right corner of his mat (1.5.3, 3.4.1). It is a colored die symbol there: the pips or fewer on a single die roll needed for success. Each Levy action allows one die roll to be made, so repeated attempts are allowed.

Here, Alfonso will attempt to Levy Pedro Ansúrez, whose mat shows a Fealty rating of “4” pips. The player rolls a “5”: unsuccessful, so Pedro finds an excuse not to answer his King’s call at this time and nothing happens. The player cannot attempt to roll again for Pedro because, with three Levy actions spent, Alfonso is out of Lordship and therefore his Muster segment this turn is over.

Call to Arms

Each 40-day turn, a Call to Arms segment immediately follows the two sides’ Muster segment to conclude the Levy sequence. Call to Arms mainly has to do with those Lords who never Muster by the usual means of another Lord’s Levy action and Fealty die roll (3.4.1) but rather by this special Call to Arms procedure. You can recognize these Lords by their mats’ lack of a Fealty die-symbol rating: the mercenary Rodrigo on either side; the Almoravid Africans on the Muslim side; and the crusader Eudes on the Christian side. Along with the option to call in one of these Lords, the Muslim side may be able to gain Victory Points (VP) by declining to call upon the Almoravids’ help. For this example, focus on rules section 3.5 and the Call to Arms portion of the Sequence of Play on the foldout.

Christian Call to Arms. It is the start of Scenario E, Alfonso and the Almoravids, the Levy of box 9, and the sequence has reached Call to Arms. The Christians are up first (3.5.1). The situation may offer them any of up to three options:

- [a] **Reconcile with Rodrigo** if he is on the map fighting for the Muslims or if the Christians have suffered a notable combat defeat (had a Lord permanently removed in Battle or Storm). King Alfonso swallows his pride—giving up VP—to recall El Cid from exile and thereby deny his services to the Muslims and make him available to the Christian side in a future Levy.
- [b] **Employ Rodrigo** for some Coin if he is Ready on the Calendar as a Christian Lord.
- [c] **Call for Crusade** to Muster Eudes of Burgundy if he is Ready.

Looking at the first Calendar illustration (and realizing that the scenario is just begun, so no Christian Lords have fallen in combat), we can see that the Christian player has none of these options at the moment: neither is Rodrigo Mustered for the Muslims or Ready for the Christians (3.4.1), nor is Eudes Ready. The Christian Call to Arms passes uneventfully this Levy.

Uphold the Dynasties. Muslim Call to Arms is next—and a bit more interesting (3.5.2). The Muslim’s potential options:

- [a] **Employ Rodrigo** for Coin if he is Ready on the Calendar as a Muslim Lord: he is!
- [b] **Invite the Almoravids** to fight in Spain if at least one of the Almoravid Lords, Yusuf or Sir, is Ready: they are!
- [c] **Uphold the Dynasties**—that is, keep the Taifas independent—for VP and Jihad if both Yusuf and Sir are Ready: again, they both are so.
- [d] **Call upon an Emir** to Muster a Taifa Lord if Yusuf is at that Lord’s Seat: that is not the case, as Yusuf remains on the Calendar.



Call to Arms – Uphold the Dynasties: The Christians have no Lords available to Call to Arms. The Muslims choose to decline Yusuf and Sir in order to gain +1VP in the Taifas box (3.5.2).

Strategically, the choice for the Muslim player here is to pay some Coin now to bring the hard-hitting but somewhat unreliable Cid into play on their side as Rodrigo al-Sayyid, to start bringing in the massive Almoravid armies of Yusuf and Sir, or to do neither to instead gain Victory Points. The player decides to wait until the Christians prove on the gameboard that more help for the Muslims is needed and chooses to Uphold the Dynasties.

Following the text of the Sequence of Play sheet under Call to Arms, Muslims, option [c], and referring to the fuller text of rule 3.5.2, the player shifts both the Yusuf and Sir cylinders on the Calendar from the current turn, box 9, by one turn ahead, to box 10. The effect is that the Muslims decline the option that they had to Muster any Almoravid Lord—because both were Ready (3.4.1)—until the following turn's Call to Arms, when the Almoravids will be Ready again.

The reward for declining Almoravid intervention (and in this case also for declining to employ Rodrigo) is to add one green 1VP Conquered marker to the Taifas box plus one ½VP Jihad marker to the map: an immediate Muslim gain of 1½ VP total. The Muslim player slides Yusuf and Sir to box 10, adds a 1VP marker to the Taifas box, finds and selects a map Locale eligible for adding a Jihad marker, and slides and flips the Muslim Victory marker from box 8 to “+½” in box 9 (adjusts the Muslim score from 8 to 9½). The Jihad marker could go to any Stronghold in a Parias or Reconquista Taifa, provided that the Stronghold is free of any Christian Lords, Christian Seat markers, or Christian Conquered markers (1.4.4).

Invite the Almoravids. Sticking with the Muslims while skipping forward to a later Call to Arms segment, let's look at the next Calendar illustration: it's the Levy of turn 11. The Muslim player is feeling the pressure of the Christian onslaught and wants to bring the Africans into the fight. Yusuf and Sir are Ready.

The Muslims Invite the Almoravids (3.5.2). One (only) of the two Almoravid Lords Musters. Here, the Muslim player chooses Yusuf, the Marshal. Yusuf has no Seat printed on the map; instead, he gets a Seat marker (1.3.1) at Algeciras when he Musters, or, if Algeciras is Enemy, Neutral, or Besieged, at the nearest Port that is not. Yusuf's cylinder goes at his Seat and his Service marker four boxes ahead for his Service rating of “4” (3.4.1).

Note that Inviting the Almoravids costs nothing up front. However, while either Yusuf or Sir are Mustered, there is no longer the option to Uphold the Dynasties for VP, since that requires both Lords to be Ready on the Calendar. In addition, the arrival of the zealously Muslim Almoravids adds to the attractiveness of a Christian crusade from outside Iberia: as part of the Call of Arms, the Christian player gets to add Eudes's cylinder to the Calendar, two boxes ahead of the current turn.

Call upon an Emir. Two turns further in the game, Yusuf is on the map and has Marched from Algeciras to Badajoz. Option “[d]” under Muslim Call to Arms on the Sequence Sheet is available when Yusuf (only) is at the Seat of a Taifa Lord and that Seat is free of Enemy control or Siege (3.5.2). The option enables the Muslims to automatically Muster that Lord regardless of whether he is Ready (3.4.1) or, if already Mustered, to extend his Service by two turn boxes.

In this case, Yusuf is alone at Badajoz, the Seat of al-Mutawakkil, who recently Disbanded (3.3.2). Disband put al-Mutawakkil's cylinder into Calendar box 16: unless something changes, he will not be Ready for the rest of the scenario.



The Muslims Invite the Almoravids: In the Call of Arms of early Summer 1086, the Muslim player Musters Yusuf (3.5.2, 3.4.1), opening the door to the later arrival of European crusaders led by Eudes (3.5.1).



Yusuf at at Taifa Lord's free Seat will call him to arms.

The Muslim player has Marched Yusuf to Badajoz with this in mind. Calling upon an Emir, Yusuf effects the Muster of al-Mutawakkil now without need of a Fealty roll and despite the fact that that Lord is not Ready. The player puts al-Mutawakkil's cylinder with Yusuf's at the Badajoz Seat (3.4.1), converting that Taifa from Parias to Independent (1.4.1-1.4.3). The action took up the Muslim Call to Arms for the turn but bore no other cost (3.5.2).



Muslim Call upon an Emir: Yusuf in early Fall 1086 calls the Emir of Badajoz to Muster (3.5.2).

March, Ravage, Feed

Lords on Campaign often move their forces by March. Such movement will require them to Feed their Troops. Here we also show how Lords can Avoid Approaching Enemies, how Neutral and Enemy Strongholds affect March, the difference between Besiege and Bypass, and how to Ravage.

March and Laden. The Christians have just flipped a Command card for Álvaro Fañez, Command rating "4" (4.2, 1.5.3). Álvaro is in the Júcar Region southeast of Toledo to face down the Muslim Lord al-Mundir, currently at Valencia.

Before Marching with Álvaro, the player checks that he is able to move with the Assets he has and how fast: more Provender than Transport (Carts and Mules), any use of Carts to carry Provender over Passes (rather than along Roads), or any Loot coming along will make him Laden, costing him two actions per destination (4.3.2-4.3.3). If he has more than twice as much Provender as Transport, he will have to discard some before moving at all. (A reminder of all this is near the bottom of the Commands aid sheet.) Álvaro happens to have neither any Provender nor any Loot, so none of those apply: he will be able to March for 1 action per connecting Way.

Álvar spends Command action 1 of four Marching from Júcar to the Stronghold Town of Játiva. If this Town were Enemy to him, he would have to stop Marching there; however, Játiva lies in the Taifa of Valencia, currently at Parias status, meaning that all Locales there are Neutral unless otherwise marked (1.3.1, 1.4.2).

Because Álvaro has moved, whatever else happens on this Command card, he will have to Feed at the end of it (4.8.1). The player could put a "Moved/Fought" reminder marker on or next to Álvaro's cylinder now. But the player is experienced enough with the game not to bother and instead simply makes a mental note not to forget the Feed step later.

Approach and Avoid Battle. Álvaro proceeds with his 2nd action to Approach the Enemy Lord al-Mundir at Valencia. The Christian player pauses at that point because the Muslim player now has a decision (4.3.4). Al-Mundir can stand in Battle against Álvaro Fañez, or he can Avoid Battle to an adjacent Locale in another direction. He cannot Withdraw inside the Stronghold in this case, because Valencia is Neutral not Friendly: the Valencians won't interfere with al-Mundir's forces, but they are not about to let him inside the walls to drag the city into some bloody siege affair. Nor, on the other hand, would the Christian King of León—who is receiving Valencia's *parias* tribute—allow his captain Álvaro to besiege the city.



The Muslim player glances at what units al-Mundir has on his mat and quickly sees (or, if using the Hidden Mats option, 1.5.2, suspects) that Álvaro is bearing down with a much stronger force. The player chooses for al-Mundir to Avoid Battle back across his own border to Burriana. (Another possible destination was Alpuente.)

Al-Mundir can Avoid only with what he can carry Unladen (4.3.2, 4.3.4). So, as the Christian player did before Marching Álvaro, the Muslim player doublechecks that al-Mundir has

enough Carts and/or Mules to take any Provender with him and no Loot: Álvaro would immediately take any excess! Fortunately for the Muslim Lord, he has enough Transport and no Loot on him. By the same token, al-Mundir now also has moved on Álvaro's Command card, so, whatever else happens, also will have to Feed (4.8.1).

Besiege or Bypass. Álvaro is now alone at Valencia, the City still Neutral to both sides. He keeps the pressure on with Command action 3, invading Lérida Taifa to Approach al-Mundir at Burriana Castle. This time, the Muslim could Withdraw inside the Stronghold (4.3.4), since it is Friendly to him (in an Independent Taifa and not otherwise marked, 1.3.1, 1.4.2). Not wishing al-Mundir to be Besieged, the Muslim player again has him Avoid away, further up the coast to Baniskula.

That leaves Álvaro outside the Enemy Stronghold of Burriana. He therefore may not continue to March but must instead either Besiege or Bypass it (4.3.5). Besiege means to get right up to the Castle, encamp there and begin Siegeworks in hopes of blockading the place into Surrender or in preparation for Storming its Walls. The player would put a yellow Siege marker on Burriana. The price of doing so, however, would be that Álvaro would forfeit any remaining Command actions on this card.

In this case, the Christian player would like to use Álvaro's remaining fourth action. So Álvaro instead Bypasses Burriana, and the player puts a Bypass marker on his cylinder. Álvaro still cannot keep Marching in pursuit of al-Mundir, but he could do something else such as Forage, Supply, or Ravage.

Ravage. The Christian player decides that Álvaro will Ravage Burriana with his final Command action (4.7.2). The Locale must be Enemy and not yet Ravaged, which are the case here. That Álvaro is Bypassing the Stronghold is irrelevant. The player puts a yellow Ravaged marker at Burriana.

The Ravage will have several benefits for the Christians:

- First, the marker on the map adds $\frac{1}{2}$ victory point to the Christian score (5.1), so the player immediately records that flipping and/or shifting the yellow Victory marker on the Calendar.
- Second, the Ravage adds one Loot and one Provender to Álvaro's mat. (Were Burriana a Region rather than a Stronghold, it would add one Loot only.)
- Finally, every odd yellow Ravage marker placed in an independent Taifa shifts that Taifa Lord's Service by one Calendar box left: depending on how many Ravage markers Lérida's Territory already has, al-Mundir could suffer shortened Service having suffered these enemy depredations. The players check the Taifa's Locales (being sure to include the exclave of Denia to the south). They see that there are no other yellow Ravaged markers there now. This Ravage makes it one yellow Ravaged in Lérida: odd, so al-Mundir's Service does shift a box.

Feed. With all four of Álvaro's Command actions completed, it is time for the Feed/Pay/Disband sequence that finishes off each Command card (4.8). The players recall that Álvaro and al-Mundir each have moved, so the Christian player checks Álvaro's mat to see how many supplies will be eaten up. The requirement is one Provender or Loot for every six Troops units plus Mules on that Lord's mat, rounded up (4.8.1 and Sequence of Play sheet Feed summary box).



The Christian player now regrets not making this calculation ahead of time, as Álvaro turns out to have exactly seven mouths to feed: six unit pieces plus one Mule marker. That rounds up to two Prov and/or Loot to be removed!

If Álvaro did not have (or could not share, 1.5.2) enough Provender or Loot, he would eat what he had then shift his Service marker one box left on the Calendar. Fortunately, he does have enough here: one Prov and one Loot. Unfortunately, it means that his Troops will now eat up the Loot that the Christian player was hoping to bring back to Friendly ground to reward Álvaro's men and thus extend his Service in a later Pay step (4.8.2). Álvaro could let his Mules go to avoid an adverse Service shift, but only if he cannot Feed them—if he can Feed them, he must do so (a Greed rule)—and, here, he can. The player grumbles and removes both the Loot and the Provender just acquired by Ravage, then puts a "Feed x2" reminder marker on Álvaro's mat so as not to be wrongfooted again.

The Muslim player similarly tends to Feeding (or shifting) al-Mundir. Both players check for any Pay they would like to carry out now anywhere on the map, then any Disband that must occur because Service markers are at or left of the current Campaign box (4.8.2), then finally proceed to the next Muslim Command card (4.2).

Storming a Stronghold

Battles between armies in the open field and assault of a Besieged Stronghold work quite similarly. Here we will focus on the latter, called Storm, which you are likely to engage in more frequently than open Battle. For more on setting up a field Battle, see also the Battle of Sagradas Minigame later in this booklet.

With the following example, open the foldout to the Forces, Strongholds, and Battle and Storm charts. Refer especially to righthand column under Storm Procedure and, in the Rules of Play, to sections 4.4 on Battles in general and 4.5.2 on the particulars of Storming a Stronghold.

It's 1085. King Alfonso and Álvaro Fañez fresh from Reconquista of Toledo have invaded Abu Bakr's Independent Taifa of Valencia, bent on Conquest. Abu Bakr has gotten himself holed up inside the walled Town of Játiva, around which Alfonso and Álvaro have been building up their Siegeworks for some time (4.5.1). The Besiegers' food has run out and—since the Town will not Surrender as long as Abu Bakr remains Mustered inside, and since the Muslim Lord retains ample provisions, both food and gold, to hold out—the Christians have decided to risk Storming the Town. Actually, they are confident because the Siegeworks are quite advanced, without the Hidden Mats option (1.5.2) they can see that Abu Bakr is relatively ill equipped to defend, and the Attackers have brought with them the necessary Vassals and specialists (as we shall see).

Álvar and Alfonso will Storm the Town of Játiva with Abu Bakr Besieged inside.

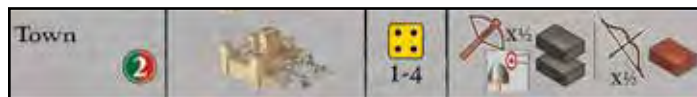


Álvar and Alfonso will Storm the Town of Játiva with Abu Bakr Besieged inside.

It is Álvaro's Command card. Since Storm (unlike Siege) takes only one Command action (4.5.2 Storm) but automatically ends actions on that card (4.4.5 Recovery), the Christian player has Álvaro first use three of his four actions to attempt to Forage (4.7.1), succeeding in adding two Provender to his mat. Álvaro then expends his final action on the card to Storm. The player puts the round Storm reminder marker onto the map near Játiva.

Storm Array. Storming on Álvaro's Command action puts in him in Front; only one Lord starts in Front on Round 1 of Storm, so Alfonso may not yet Strike (4.4.1 Battle Array; 4.5.2 Array and Reposition). The Christian player slides Álvaro's mat and Capability cards to a common Battle area of the table, with Alfonso's mat behind Álvaro's in Reserve (not pictured). The player takes the three Siege markers from the Storm Locale on the map and places them just in front of Álvaro's mat: they represent trenches, mines, or other preparations that will protect the Attackers (4.5.2 Siegeworks).

We see that Álvaro has all his original Forces plus both his Vassals Mustered as well as BALLESTEROS and JABALINAS Capabilities (Crossbowmen and Javelins, 1.9.1). The Javelins come with a reminder marker because they can be used during only one Round (4.4.2 Javelins). If playing with the Hidden Mats option, 1.5.2, the Muslim player might be seeing these details for the first time now.



As for the Defenders, the Town entry on the foldout's Strongholds table (above) shows that Abu Bakr will benefit from Walls 1-4 and a Garrison of two Men-at-Arms units with Crossbows and one Militia unit with regular Bowmen. The Muslim player positions Abu Bakr's mat opposite the Attacker's mat and adds the three Garrison units from the pool, placing them just in front of the Defending mat (4.5.2 Stronghold Effects). (If there were no Defending Lord, the Garrison units would Defend alone.) We see that Abu Bakr has no Capability cards but has Mustered his Vassal (as it happens, a unit of Játiva Militia).

If preferred, the players could have Arrayed Lord cylinders, Siege markers, and Garrison units on the Battle mat instead of sliding the Lord mats around the table.

A player places a "1" reminder marker near the Storm Array to show that Round 1 is underway.

Round 1 Strike. Tracking down the Storm Procedure column on the foldout, the players each state they are playing no Events this Storm, the Attacker naturally declines to Concede, and Repositioning is moot until after Round 1. The first relevant step of Round 1 will be a sequence of Defending then Attacking Missile then Melee Strikes. As in a field Battle, the Defender Strikes first within each type of unit combat: Missile then Melee (4.4.2 Strike Initiative). A difference is that, in Battle, Horse units Melee before Foot; here, the riders are not on their mounts, so all units of a side Melee together (4.5.2 Stronghold Effects and as shown on the Battle and Storm table of the foldout).

Missiles. Our first illustration of Abu Bakr's mat faced off against Álvaro's mat (left half of page 15) shows the effect of the Defenders' Missiles (step 1a). Abu Bakr's own Forces have no Missiles, but the Strongholds table tells us that Játiva's Garrison units do: the Men-at-Arms have Crossbows and the Militia unit have regular Bowmen. The table says "x1/2", so the Hits are equal to half the number of units, rounded up, with odd Hits benefiting from the more effective Crossbows (4.4.2 Mixed Missiles). The three Muslim Garrison units generate 1½ rounded to two



Round 1

Round 1



*Storm setup and Round 1 Defender Missiles:
Álvar is fortunate not to lose some Men-at-Arms.*

*Round 1 Attacker Missiles:
Álvar Fáñez's Crossbowmen knock out a Garrison unit.*

Missile Hits, of which one will be Crossbows. The Hits must first get past the Attackers' formidable Siegeworks: a Protection roll of 1-3 for the three markers cancels the Hit. The Christian player separately rolls one die for the Crossbow Hit, "4", and one for the Bowmen, "3". The Crossbows got through, so the Muslim player (because these are Crossbows) gets to select the target unit from Álvár's mat, choosing a Men-at-Arms. That unit now gets an Armor Protection roll, per the Forces table, a 1-3 to cancel the Hit. Crossbows per the same foldout sheet reduce Armor by -1, so the Men-at-Arms now need to roll a 1-2 or they will Rout. The roll is a lucky "2", and the unit stands.

The next illustration (right half of page 15) similarly shows the next Initiative step, 1b), return shots by Álvár's Crossbowmen and Javelin throwers. The Forces table and JABALINAS card tell us that Javelins are $x\frac{1}{2}$ in Storm (because of the tight spaces), not $x1$ as in Battle, and Strike in any one Round only. Since Álvár's Militia already have Missiles $x\frac{1}{2}$ with their Crossbows, and his three Crossbow units will round up to two Hits, adding Javelins to the Militia and the single Serfs unit adds no Hits. The Christians therefore reserve the Javelin throw for some later Round where it may help.

As shown, with rolls of "5" and "3", one of the two Crossbow Hits gets through the Town's 1-4 Walls (shown on the Strongholds table rather than with a marker). The Garrison must take the Hit before any of Abu Bakr's Troops (4.5.2 Garrison Forces During Storm). The Crossbowmen choose a Men-at-Arms unit from the Garrison. It rolls "6" against its reduced Armor of 1-2, Routs, and is removed.

Melee. Melee is next, starting with the Defenders (step 2a). All surviving Troops in Front Strike together—the Garrison plus Abu Bakr's units (4.5.2 Stronghold Effects). Per the Forces table, the Muslims' three Armored units do a Hit each, plus $\frac{1}{2}$ Hit from each Unarmored unit, for a total of five dice against the Christians' 1-3 Siegeworks. Grabbing five dice at once to speed things along, the Christian player rolls "1", "3", "3", "4", "6". Two Melee Hits have gotten through to the Attacking Troops.

In Storm, Armored Attacking units must absorb Hits before any Unarmored Attackers do (4.5.2 Stronghold Effects): you hardly can ask your baggage handlers to brave the enemy's walls if your knights show themselves unwilling to do so! The Christian player could select Sergeants or Men-at-Arms but chooses a tough Knights unit, Armor 1-4, to absorb the first Hit: a Protection roll of "3" is good enough to negate the blow. For the second Melee Hit on Álvár's units, the owner chooses the same Knights unit again (since it did not Rout), but this time a roll "5" does Rout it, sliding the unit piece back into the "Rout" area of the mat (1.5.2 Mat Sections, 4.4.2 Rout).

Finally, Álvár's Attackers Melee Strike (2b). His six Armored and two Unarmored units still fighting generate a total of seven Hits; however, in Storm, Attackers get a maximum of six Melee Hits per Lord in Front (4.5.2 Stronghold Effects and the Battle and Storm table). Any of those six Melee Hits that make it past the Defenders' Walls 1-4 Strike any Garrison units first. In this case, Walls Protection rolls cancel four of the six Hits, but the remaining two Hits end up Routing (removing) both remaining Garrison units.



Round 1 Melee: Five Defender Hits Rout a Knights unit; the max six Attacker Hits reduce the Garrison.

Round 2. As not all Attackers or Defenders have Routed, no one has Conceded, and there is more than a single Siege marker at the Stronghold (4.5.2 Ending the Storm), the players go back to the top of the “Round” section of the Battle and Storm table to begin Round 2.

The Attackers certainly are not going to Concede, but they will Reposition. Each Round of Storm, each side may advance one additional Lord from Reserve to join the fray in Front—up to the Capacity of the Stronghold (❶, ❷, or ❸). The Strongholds table (and the game board) show that Játiva, a Town, has a Capacity of “❷” Lords. The Christian player slides Alfonso’s mat up from Reserve to the Front next to Álvaro’s mat. As Round 2’s Strikes proceed (our last illustration for this example), Alfonso’s Troops will participate, adding his ARQUEROS Bowmen and up to another six Melee Hits and potentially absorbing Hits from the enemy.

Note also that Alfonso’s SIEGE TOWERS Capability now comes into effect. It was not necessary that Alfonso be in Front for the SIEGE TOWERS to help the Attack: by card text, the owning Lord need only be “at” the Storm to provide the SIEGE TOWERS benefit; he can do that from Reserve. But the SIEGE TOWERS take a Round to push up to the enemy walls, so they count only from Round 2 forward. Their effect is “Walls -1”, so the Town’s Walls 1-4 reduce to Walls 1-3.

Round 2

Abu Bakr Routs: Stronghold Conquered

1b 2 Bowmen Hits
2 Crossbow Hits

2a 3 Melee Hits
Siege Towers: Walls -1

2b 12 Melee Hits: max 6 per Attacking Lord

Alfonso VI King of León
Service 4
Lordship 3
Command 1
Routed

Álvar Fañez King's Captain
Service 4
Lordship 2
Command 4
Routed

Assets & Vassals

Arqueros Bowmen
This Lord's Foot and Light Horse have Missiles x½

Siege Towers
This Lord at Storm from Round 2 on weakens Enemy Stronghold to Walls -1

Ballesteros Crossbowmen
This Lord's Men-at-Arms and Militia have Missiles x½ that select target units, -1 to target's Armor

Jabalinas Javelins
Up to 4 of this Lord's Unarmored units have Missiles x1 on any 1 Battle Round, Missiles x½ if Storm (mark)

Storm Round 2: Alfonso is able to Reposition to Front. SIEGE TOWERS come into play. Abu Bakr's Strike Routs another unit of Knights, but the Christian Strikes are enough to Rout all remaining Defenders.

The Initiative sequence of Missile then Melee Strikes repeats that of Round 1, as shown in the illustration. But this time the Town Garrison is no longer in action to shoot bows or take Hits; with Alfonso's added strength, the Attackers are able in Round 2 to Rout all of Abu Bakr's units while losing just one more Knights unit to Rout.

End, Sack, and Aftermath. All Defenders have Routed, so that side loses the Storm (4.5.2 Ending the Storm). Tracking on down the Storm Procedure column of the Battle and Storm table, we see that the losing Defending Lord Abu Bakr is permanently removed from the game (captured by the Christians, most likely) and will award Spoils (4.5.2 Sack). The players remove Abu Bakr's cylinder from the map, his Service marker from the Calendar, and his mat from the table (as if Beyond Service, 3.3.1).

"Spoils" mean first that all of Abu Bakr's Assets—in this case a pile of Coin and Provender—go to the winners, distributed among the Lords present as the winning side prefers (4.4.2 Spoils). Second (as shown a little further down the Storm table), the Sacked Town itself renders Spoils to the victorious Lords: as shown on the Strongholds table, a total of one Coin and two Provender (4.5.2 Sack). That's a great thing for the Christians, as they will need some those captured provisions in a moment!

The Christians Conquer the Town: any Jihad markers there would be removed (there are none in this case) and the player adds yellow Conquered markers equal the value of the Stronghold (4.5.1). The Strongholds table and the single gray icon at Játiva on the map show that the Town has a value of one Victory Point, so one marker. The player adjusts the Christian Victory marker on the Calendar accordingly (5.1).

No Lords Retreated, so there is no penalty to Service markers (4.4.3 Service), but the survivors must check for Loss of Routed units. Sometimes, Routed units recover by rolling the same roll needed to absorb a Hit; for Knights, that's a 1-4. But Storming a Stronghold is deadly business, so Routed Attackers recover only on a roll of "1" (4.5.2 Ending the Storm). The Christian player rolls a die for each of Álvar's Routed units: neither roll is a "1", so the player removes both units from the mat.

Having seen to ending the Storm, the players remove the Storm marker from the map and proceed to the Aftermath (4.4.5). The surviving Lords have Fought, and Command actions are automatically over. It is time to Feed (4.8.1). Alfonso and Álvar each have between 7 and 12 units on their mat after the combat and so will consume two Provender apiece. They share the bounty of the Sacked enemy Town with their Troops, removing the required Provender markers. Álvar's activation is done.

GEOGRAPHY

by Albert Alegre Jove with Volko Ruhnke

This section takes you on an orientation tour of 11th-Century Iberia's patchwork of middling to tiny "taifa" emirates, then of its Christian kingdoms and counties. We visit each 1085 state and its ruler in turn, with a quick word on the role of each in the game.

The Muslim Taifas

In the year 711, Berber commander Tariq ibn Ziyad launched the Muslim conquest of what is now Spain and Portugal from a rock now named after him: *Djabal Tariq*—Gibraltar. Following his army's shattering of Iberia's Visigoths in the Battle of Guadalete, control of the bulk of the peninsula lay for centuries in Muslim hands. But this Muslim power was not the monolithic entity we might think, as different tribes and nationalities within the Muslim world arrived on the peninsula over the years and provided a perfect mosaic for the outbreak of internal revolts.

Unhindered Muslim control would last some 300 years until the death in 1002 of Almanzor, who would be known as the last great scourge of the Iberian Christians. Thereafter, the lack of a strong leader, the dire state of the coffers, and internal intrigues caused the atomization of the Muslim Caliphate into dozens of new independent states known as the "*taifa* kingdoms"—emirates, some large and others comprising just single a city.* From that century, the Peninsula's Christian kings would take advantage of the rivalries among Muslim lords to extend and consolidate power over them and accelerate the budding *Reconquista*.

* The appellation "taifa" came from the Arabic for "party" or "faction"—a pejorative reflecting these states' status as petty dynasties within a once mighty and unified caliphate (*al-Andalus*); "taifa" also could refer to an ancient Arab combat unit made up of 2,048 men—the smallest unit considered able to operate as an independent army.

By 1085, this fracturing of *al-Andalus* reached an equilibrium. Here we present the map-puzzle pieces that was the *taifas*' territory and how the game's board represents them, starting in the north and traveling roughly counter-clockwise.

Taifa of Zaragoza

Zaragoza was a front-line *taifa* dominating the northeast and bordering the Christian kingdoms of León and Aragón. Around it lay the *taifa* kingdoms of Lérida, Valencia, Toledo, and Albarracín.



Emir Yusuf al-Mutamin of the Banu Hud (the Arab Hud family) ruled Zaragoza until his death and succession by his son **al-Mustain II** in June 1085. In light of the son's rule during the bulk of the time covered in

Almoravid, the game represents both individuals with a single Lord piece, "al-Mustain".

During the reign of Al-Mustain II's grandfather, the *taifa* had included not only the 1080s territory of Zaragoza but also that of Lérida to the east and Denia in the south. But that emir's death divided the territory among his descendants.

In the years before 1085, the main effort of Zaragoza's Emir was to defend his *taifa*, not only against Christian attacks from the kingdoms of León and Aragón but also against his brother who ruled Lérida and had allied with the Christian monarchs of Aragón and Barcelona in attempts to carve Zaragoza up. Al-Mutamín had fended off all these challenges, so far, thanks to Rodrigo Díaz de Vivar ("the Cid"). The Christian Rodrigo in the early 1080s served as a mercenary in Muslim Zaragoza's employ and brilliantly oversaw the *taifa*'s defense.

By 1085, however, the Banu Hud rulers of Zaragoza and Lérida had at least temporarily put aside their feud in the face of the swelling threat from the unified León, Castilla, and Galicia under King Alfonso VI and his alliance with King Sancho I of Aragón.

In *Almoravid*, Zaragoza under its Lord al-Mustain often will find itself under immediate and heavy Christian pressure to resume Parias tribute payments or even as a target of territorial Reconquista. In one shorter scenario, Zaragoza City begins already Besieged by Alfonso with al-Mustain inside. And the Taifa can even become the target of a formal crusade should the Burgundians of Duke Eudes show up. However, should the Christian player send

Alfonso elsewhere or fail to Muster or keep the field with Sancho, Zaragoza instead can see an easy opportunity to Ravage Christian border Locales. In addition, not only Rodrigo (a separate Lord) but the opportunist COUNT OF BARCELONA (Muslim Capability #M23) are available for hire to give the Muslims considerable military punch on the Zaragoza front.

Taifas of Albarracín and Alpuente



The tiny twin emirates of Albarracín and Alpuente were ruled respectively by Abd al-Malik ibn Razin (from 1045) and Abd Allah II ibn Muhammad ibn Nizam (from 1043). They lay in the southern reaches of the Sistema Ibérico mountain range, between the lands of the wealthy and powerful *taifas* of Zaragoza to their north, Lérida northeast, Toledo west, and Valencia south.

Nominally independent, in the resistance to the Christians they became vassals under protection of the comparatively mighty *taifas* of Zaragoza and Toledo. *Almoravid's* gameboard, for sim-



Almoravid's gameboard map in geographic context: so as to cover the historical campaigns at the greatest resolution, the board leaves Portugal, Galicia, Asturias, much of Navarra, and the Catalan Counties off its edges.

Ethnicities of al-Andalus

Medieval *al-Andalus* may seem to us a monolith for which the adjective “Muslim” suffices to define its inhabitants. But it was a diverse ethnic patchwork, bound as in Christian Spain only by shared religion.

This ethnic variety had its origin in the virtues and challenges of the original Islamic invasion of the Visigothic kingdom of Hispania. The Muslim army that entered the Iberian Peninsula in 711 belonged to the Umayyad Caliphate. This army had Arab troops in its ranks, soldiers from the Arabian Peninsula or nearby. But its main contingents were Berbers from North Africa who had enlisted in the Arab-led army following promises of loot, especially good land to settle on.

Tensions ensued when Arab commanders deployed the Berbers in the most dangerous positions while Arab troops stayed in reserve and when the division of areas to be colonized after the conquest granted Berbers only the worst parcels. When Berbers in North Africa about 740 happened to revolt against the Caliphate, their brethren who had settled in *al-Andalus* took advantage and joined in uprising.

The Iberian Berbers’ rebellion almost succeeded, until a relief army that Caliph Hisham II had sent to Africa and had survived a defeat there unexpectedly arrived on the Peninsula to suppress it. And that created a new problem. The army’s regional contingents from Damascus, Homs, Qinnasrin, Jordan, Palestine, and Egypt after quelling the Berber revolt decided that taking control in *al-Andalus* would be preferable to returning home. It took several military campaigns to foil this attempted coup and reach an agreement. These contingents would distribute across *al-Andalus*, each nationality in its own province and in charge of its administration, tax collection, and—whenever the need came—levy of forces for the conduct of military expeditions.

These resettled contingents became the backbone of the caliphal armies in Iberia. But centuries of settled life, protected status as the local government, and ostentation dissipated their warlike ardor. This decadence, along with a weakness for palace intrigues, undermined confidence in them on the part of the caliphs, who increasingly sought new troops from outside *al-Andalus* who would be efficient and loyal (or at least loyal to the money they were paid). Caliphal commander Almanzor in the late 10th Century, for example, built his army around a nucleus of Berber troops recruited from the tribal confederations of the *Maghreb*.

To this ferment we must add the *Andalusí* and Slav ethnicities. The descendants of the first Muslim colonists, Arab and Berber, over time merged and evolved into their own regional culture as *al-Andalus*. Enslaved Slavs from Eastern Europe, bought as children and trained in military arts, over time achieved freedom or rose up as social elites. (See the Arts of War historical note for Muslim Capability #M15 SAQALIBAH, later in this booklet.)

The distinctions among ethnic origins rooted in the 8th Century diluted over time, especially among commoners. But it became a differentiating feature of the ruling classes, especially in the *taifas* of the 11th Century, whose dynasties suffered tensions along ethnic lines. By 1085, ruling families included non-Berber Abadids, Amirids, and Sumadih and Berber Aftasids, Zirids, Dhunnunids, Qasim, Razin, and Hudids. (See Christian Event #C22 BERBERS.) The ethnic group that finally ended Arab supremacy of the region was the same that formed the muscle of the conquering army of 711 and that was crushed in the revolt of 740: the Berber people, this time mobilized in leadership of the great Almoravid movement.

plicity, consolidates their territories into that of Zaragoza. Their rulers play their part in the game as Vassals who send small troop contingents to serve in the army of Zaragoza’s Lord, al-Mustain.

Taifa of Lérida



Formerly a part of Zaragoza’s Hudid emirate, the northeastern *taifa* kingdom of Lérida was ruled from 1081 by **al-Mundir** al-Hayib Imad ad-Dawla, also of the Banu Hud, brother of Yusuf al-Mutamin, and uncle of al-Mustain II of Zaragoza.

The Emirate of Lérida included the territories of the once independent *taifa* kingdoms of Lérida (Larida or Lleida)*, Tortosa to its immediate south, and the region of Denia along the coast further south beyond Valencia. During the Hudid al-Muqtadir’s reign in Zaragoza (1046-1081), all these territories had been part of his single Zaragozaan kingdom. Lérida as of 1085 bordered the Kingdom of Aragón on its north and, on its east, the Christian Catalan counties including Barcelona. Its *taifa* neighbors were Zaragoza

to the west, Valencia to the south, and (via Denia) the eastern extremes of Sevilla (Murcia and Cartagena).

* A note on place-names in the game: For consistency and familiarity, Almoravid follows the convention of most English-language histories about the period and uses modern Spanish names for places known to their 11th-Century inhabitants by names in older variants of other languages. Thus, the gameboard shows Lérida not Larida or Lleida, Zaragoza not Saraqusta, Valencia not Balansiya, Toledo not Talaytula, Madrid not Mayrit, and so on.

As noted above, al-Mundir had not hesitated to ally himself with the Christians of Aragón and Barcelona in military campaigns to try to conquer territories from Zaragoza and Valencia. In the period portrayed in *Almoravid*, he campaigned in Valencia but this time against León’s recently installed Muslim puppet emir al-Qadir.

In the game, Lérida serves as another front-line Taifa alongside Zaragoza. Al-Mundir has fewer forces and smaller fortifications at hand than his nephew al-Mustain next door, but he is a po-

tentially highly active Lord (Command “3” compared to al-Mustain’s “2”) and also can call upon BARCELONA’s troops (Capability #M23) if the Muslim player wishes to invest the Coin to do so.

Taifa of Valencia



Journeying south along the Mediterranean coast, we reach the great city of Valencia. Valencia’s territory during the period 1064-1075 had been by conquest part of the *taifa* of Toledo. But its local rulers took advantage of the weakness of Toledo’s king al-Qadir (see below) and riots that a faction within the city organized against him to recover their independence. Ruled from 1075 by **Abu Bakr** ibn Abd al-Aziz of the Banu Amir, the Emirate of Valencia would soon become the object of desire of León, Zaragoza, Lérida, and later the Almoravids and finally an exiled Christian lord, machinations that would raise to new heights the name of El Cid.

Valencia in the 1080s alone had not strength to prevail against pressure from León and others and acquiesced in *parias* payments. But an alliance with Zaragoza could prop up the Amirids’ rule and create a force robust enough together to hold the Christian advance. To seal the deal, Abu Bakr oversaw the marriage in January 1085 of his daughter to Zaragoza’s soon-to-be emir al-Mustain. Sadly for this scheme, Abu Bakr was ill and died in the spring; factionalism broke out against his son and heir, Uthman; the anti-Leonese alliance faltered; and—as we shall see—the Amirids’ seat became vulnerable to a Christian arrangement with the weak but covetous al-Qadir of Toledo.

In the game, the Taifa Lord Abu Bakr may help foster anti-Christian resistance through a TAIFA MARRIAGE (Event #M12), may succumb and return Valencia to *Parias* status via ILLNESS OF THE EMIR (Event #C23), or neither!

Taifa of Toledo

West of Valencia across the plains of La Mancha and the great river basins of the Guadiana and the Tajo, the Emirate of Toledo stretched across the heart of Iberia. Ruled from 1075 by Yahya ibn Ismail ibn Yahya bi-l-lah **al-Qadir**, destined to be last notable of the once powerful Berber Dhunnunid dynasty (Banu Dhi l Nun). Toledo shared a long border with the Christian Kingdom of León and therefore its incapable ruler was on the front line of Muslim resistance. Around his territory lay the *taifa* emirates of Zaragoza, Alpuente, Albarracín, Valencia, Sevilla, and Badajoz—meaning that Alfonso’s control of al-Qadir’s central *taifa* would provide León’s Christian raiders ready access to the entire remainder of *al-Andalus*. For Muslims, then, Toledo was the main bastion of defense (alongside Badajoz) against Christian attacks towards the south of the Peninsula.

Beyond that operational consideration, Toledo held deep traditional meaning for the Christians, as it had been the capital of their ancient Visigothic kingdom.

Under the rule of the Dhunnunid Emir Yahya ibn Ismail al-Mamun (1043-1075), Toledo reached its greatest extent, garnering under its control the *taifas* of Valencia and Córdoba. But after his death and succession by his grandson al-Qadir, Muslim Toledo’s decline began.

Al-Qadir would not only lose control of Valencia to the Amirid Abu Bakr and Córdoba to al-Mutamid of Sevilla but would also end up exiled from Toledo by the Emir of Badajoz al-Mutawakkil in an attempted annexation of Toledo’s territory. In that position, al-Qadir asked the Christian Alfonso VI for help and thereby regained his Toledo seat. But this Christian aid had an important economic cost—*parias*—and the handover of various fortresses and castles to León. Discontent would not take long to reappear, so that al-Qadir’s fate hung by a thread as 1085 dawned.

In light of al-Qadir’s enforced, off-and-on collusion with the Christian *Reconquista*—he ends up permanently ceding Toledo to León in a negotiated siege-surrender and installed by Alfonso’s captain Álvaro Fáñez as a puppet emir of Valencia—*Almoravid* denies Toledo a maneuver piece for its Taifa Lord. Instead, al-Qadir makes his appearance in the game via two cards that either dampen or augment local Muslim resistance (Christian Event #C20 and Muslim Event #M11). Toledo’s Taifa tends to serve as a key battlefield between the players—perhaps taken by the Christian side as Reconquista territory, perhaps the scene of a building Jihad against them.

Taifa of Sevilla



To the southwest, at the great river port of Sevilla, the court of poet-king Muhammad ibn Abbad **al-Mutamid** would rule over the most powerful and influential *taifa* of the period. During the mandate of al-Mutamid from 1069, it would achieve its maximum splendor at the expense of the other emirs—and with Alfonso’s military help, in exchange for *parias*. Sevilla in 1070 seized the *taifa* of Córdoba from al-Qadir, then further up the Guadalquivir River won the town of Jaén from Granada, and by 1080 extended al-Mutamid’s dominion across *al-Andalus* to absorb the *taifa* of Murcia and its seaport of Cartagena. (Murcia would maintain some independence within the Kingdom of Sevilla.)

With a northern border stretching from the Atlantic Ocean and Badajoz in the west along Toledo’s south to Valencia, Lérida’s Denia and the Mediterranean Sea in the east, Sevilla taifa sooner or later would have to take the lead in opposing Alfonso VI. Once he had Toledo in his hands, Sevilla would become a front-line state. Al-Mutamid then took that bit in his teeth, rallied the *taifa* kings to their own mutual defense, and risked it all in a call to the Almoravids with the poetic explanation “rather a camel-driver in Africa than a swineherd in Castilla”.

In *Almoravid*, al-Mutamid not only boasts the greatest army and purse of dinars of all the Taifa Lords, he is committed from the outset to the longest military Service (six 40-day Campaigns compared to four for the others) and enjoys the alacrity on Campaign of a “3” Command rating. Without the Taifa of Sevilla and its militarily capable Lord as a spearpoint, the Muslim player will be hard-pressed to stem the Christian tide—even once the Almoravids appear on the scene.

Taifa of Granada



South of the expanse of al-Mutamid's Sevilla *taifa* lay Granada, ruled from 1073 by **Abd Allah** ibn Buluggin al-Muzaffar of the ethnic-Berber Zirid dynasty. Since coming to power, Abd Allah had to deal with the challenges of the Christian Kingdom of León (whose objective was to force Granada to pay *parias*) and the expansionist ambitions of Sevilla and Málaga.

León's aggression paused when Granada agreed to pay *parias* and thereby obtain Alfonso's protection. As noted above, Granada's rival Sevilla had the same arrangement with the Leonese king, so that the spectacle ensued in 1079 of a battle pitting Sevillans under Alfonso's captain Rodrigo Díaz de Vivar against Granadans under another such captain, García Ordóñez. The bellicosity of Málaga, ruled by Abd Allah's estranged older brother Tamim, ended after successful military campaigns that finally fended the Málagaans off from Granadan territory.

By 1086, the strategic situation had changed utterly. After fending off Christian raids out of the now Christian-conquered Toledo, Abd Allah agreed to invite the Almoravids into *al-Andalus* and then belatedly joined Yusuf's army on its march northward at what in a later century would become the Knights Templar stronghold of Jerez de los Caballeros.

The gambit would succeed in securing Granada against Alfonso. But the Almoravids, as feared, would return to conquer the *taifas* for themselves. Exiled and imprisoned, Abd Allah would have the time to compose the memoirs that serve as our principal source today of the Muslim view of the campaigns portrayed in *Almoravid*. Eventually, Granada would regain its independence and—guarded by a ring of mountains like some gigantic walled

city—hold out against the *Reconquista* another four centuries, the Peninsula's last Muslim kingdom to fall to the Christians.

In the game, Abd Allah will serve as a useful reserve to al-Mutamid and the front-line Taifa Lords. He can readily join a strike via Badajoz (as historically), or directly northward into Toledo, or even reinforce the hard-pressed northeast via transport by Sevillian or African fleet.

Taifas of Málaga and Almería

On the seashore southwest of the fastness of Granada and not far from Sevilla's Gibraltar and Algeciras, Málaga in this period hosted the rule of **Tamim** ibn Buluggin ibn Badis of the Ziri dynasty. The Zirid emir of Granada Badis ben Habus (Tamin and Abd Allah's grandfather) had conquered Málaga in 1057, and Tamim had served as governor of the Málaga port within Granada's *taifa*. But, when Tamim's younger brother Abd Allah acceded to Granada's throne in 1073, Tamim declared his independence and the kingdom split in two. This division included an unsuccessful attempt by Tamim on Granada itself in 1082.

Meanwhile, to the east of Málaga, the fortified harbor of Almería (*al-Mariyah*, "Mirror of the Sea") thrived under the independent rule of Abu Yahya Muhammad **al-Mutasim** (1052-1091) of the Arab Sumadhi dynasty. During his reign, Almería achieved its greatest economic and cultural splendor if not any feats of military resistance.



The Almoravid Empire

The Almoravids were first of three waves of Maghreb origin to reunify the Muslims of the Iberian Peninsula into a centralized state that could halt the *Reconquista* (preceding the Almohads and Benimerines). Their arrival there in 1086 followed vast conquests in Africa. They began as a confederation of the Berber Sanhaja, Zanata, and Masmuda tribes of what is now southern Morocco, who subsisted through herding, predation on other tribes, and plunder or escort of commerce across Africa's interior. Their contact around 1035 with literalist Maliki Islam (see Muslim Event #M9) combined religious and tribal authority into a power that expanded to control the main trans-Saharan trade routes and all of what is modern Mauritania, Algeria, and Morocco by 1082.

Following Yusuf ibn Tashufin's 1086 and 1088 Iberian expeditions (see Yusuf Lord History and Campaign History later in this booklet), the Almoravids' conquests there saw three stages.

- From 1090, support from Muslim subjects fed up with taxes to pay *parias* to Christians, contrary to the Koran, enabled spectacular advances against the *taifas*. Numerous

triumphs over Christian arms as well gained the Almoravids the Peninsula's entire south by 1094.

- Thereafter to 1099 the conflict ossified, as the Almoravids stalled at Valencia, now defended by El Cid, whose defeats of the Almoravid host cost it its aura of invincibility.
- Lastly, the decade to 1110 saw the Almoravids after the Cid's death overcome the barrier of Valencia to achieve their empire's maximum extent with the fall of the last *taifa*, Zaragoza, to Yusuf's son and successor.

The Almoravids' inability to restore the Muslims to full rule became evident early on in their failure to recover Toledo—the main call for their 1086 intervention. In 1118, just a few years after completing their takeover of *al-Andalus*, they lost Zaragoza to Aragón's Alfonso I. Meanwhile, discontent at harsh treatment by Almoravid garrisons arose in Muslim cities. Córdoba saw riots in 1120. Back in Marrakesh, a religious scholar named Muhammad ibn Tumart was gaining fame with his message of rebellion. It was the beginning of the Almohad movement that in just three decades would supplant the Almoravids.

The game for simplicity consolidates Málaga and Almería into the Granada Taifa and treats their rulers as Vassals who may send Granada's Taifa Lord Abd Allah a few light units. Historically, Málaga's Tamim did answer Yusuf's call in the summer of 1086 to join the Almoravid army alongside his brother. Almería's al-Mutasim joined in the *taifa's* call to arms to Yusuf; but then, when time came to campaign, he sent only his son (apparently, in lieu of his forces) to make excuses to the Sultan.

Taifa of Badajoz



At last we arrive in the northwest of *al-Andalus*, at the Badajoz *taifa* ruled from 1072 by Umar **al-Mutawakkil** Ula Allah ibn Muhammad ibn Abd Allah ibn al-Aftas—or Umar al-Mutawakkil to his friends.

Badajoz bordered Sevilla to its south and reigned over much of what is today Portugal to the west; however, its challenges in al-Mutawakkil's reign would deal far more with its neighbors to the north—the Christian Kingdom of León—and east—the troubled *taifa* of Toledo.

Al-Mutawakkil (like Granada's Abd Allah, an ethnic Berber) took advantage of the unrest and revolts in Toledo to expel its ruler al-Qadir from power and integrate Toledo into the *taifa* of Badajoz for a time. This move should have allowed him to better organize a defense against the Kingdom of León. But Alfonso VI—after agreeing with al-Qadir to restore the latter to control of Toledo—started a series of attacks on Badajoz that forced al-Mutawakkil to return home and give up his new eastern acquisition. On top of that, Alfonso in 1079 forced from Badajoz the cession of the town of Coria to the *taifa* capital's north.

Come 1086, with al-Mutawakkil's territory along a convenient north-south invasion route for the Almoravids to threaten Coria (the very prize that Alfonso had extracted from him the decade before), Badajoz was destined to play reluctant host to Yusuf's army. That October, just north of Badajoz city, al-Mutawakkil would take part in the great showdown between the *taifas'* supposed Almoravid saviors and their tormentor Alfonso: the Battle of Sagrajas (Zalaqa).

In *Almoravid*, players may see the political and military geography guide campaigns to the same outcome. Naturally, however, with so many Taifa puzzle pieces on the board and in motion, many other stories are on offer!

The Christian Kingdoms

After the 8th-Century Muslim invasion's defeat of the Visigoths at Guadalete, control of almost all the Iberian Peninsula passed into Muslim hands. The entire Peninsula? No. Cornered at its northern limits, a population that decided to escape Muslim rule mixed with local inhabitants. This refuge was a strip of land between the Peninsula's northern mountains and the sea—modern Asturias, Cantabria, and Basque Country. The Muslims, knowing that military action in this rugged area would be costly at best and probably indecisive and prolonged, decided to limit themselves to punitive expeditions, both to obtain loot and to avoid a strengthening of the Christian nucleus.

During the following 300 years, these Christian settlements took advantage of periods of calm brought about by Muslim internal struggles or by those emirs who had little appetite for arduous expeditions to the north. Gradually, the Christians would evolve and strengthen their territories enough to create lasting structures. These small kingdoms and fiefs, despite continuous setbacks, would fight for new territories and establish bases for the future reconquest of the Peninsula.

In addition to this indigenous evolution of Christian resistance, Frankish Carolingian monarchs sought to establish a buffer zone that would prevent future Muslim expeditions beyond the Pyrenees (the north of today's Navarre, Aragon, and Catalonia). A Hispanic Christian culture over time promoted the creation of new Christian kingdoms and counties out of these buffer marches that then gradually escaped Frankish control.

In many cases, the tiny Christian states expanded their territories not only at the expense of the Muslim enemy but also from one another. Alliances, ruptures, and annexations that altered the vassalage and the boundaries among the different Christian zones were frequent. As we shall see, such fighting among Christian lords remained a key ingredient in the emergence of a unified Kingdom of León in the 11th Century as a potent offensive Christian force. By 1085, as with the Muslim *taifa* kingdoms, the geography of the Christian kingdoms would reach a new but unstable balance among the following political actors: The Kingdom of León, the Kingdom of Aragón, and the Catalan counties.

Kingdom of León

The history of León during the 11th Century gives us a leading example of the evolution of a Christian kingdom of the time and the fragility of its position among its neighbors. That history therefore deserves rendition in some detail, in order better to understand the unique opportunity that the Christians would enjoy in 1085 under King Alfonso VI.

In 1037, León under its monarch Bermudo III included the western third of the peninsular north, the regions of León, Galicia, and Asturias. Bermudo's strained relations with his cousin and brother-in-law, Fernando, Count of Castilla, resulted in open conflict. Fernando, with the help of his brother, King García Sánchez III of Pamplona, ended up defeating the Leonese at Tamarón in 1037, where Bermudo died on the battlefield. No descendants survived him, which allowed Fernando to take the throne of León through Fernando's wife Sancha, Bermudo's sister and sole heir.

Seventeen years later, Fernando I, now King of León and Count of Castilla, could compare his forces to those of his brother and old ally García Sánchez III. Fernando revived an old discord over the Castilian territories held by the Kingdom of Pamplona, some of which Fernando himself had ceded in exchange for García's help against the Leonese at Tamarón. The rivalry between the two brothers ultimately led to a war, a victory for Fernando in the Battle of Atapuerca in 1054, and death on the field there of García Sánchez. Fernando approved the proclamation on the spot of García's fourteen-year-old son, Sancho Garcés IV, as successor King of Pamplona—after first obtaining agreement on the recovery of the Castilian territories claimed for León.

From there, Fernando consolidated his power throughout his realm and then dedicated himself to extending his domain at the expense of Muslim territory. In addition to conquering important

holdings such as Viseo, Lamego, and Coimbra, he obtained regular *parias* tribute payments from the *taifa* emirates of Zaragoza, Sevilla, Badajoz, and Toledo.

Fernando I's death in 1065 distributed his wide territorial domains among his children. Sancho, the eldest, inherited Castilla, established from this moment on as a kingdom, along with rights to the *parias* payments from Zaragoza. Next in line, Alfonso received the Kingdom of León and the *parias* of the Toledo *taifa*. Finally, the youngest son, García, took possession of Galicia in the extreme northwest, also elevated to a kingdom, to which accrued the Christian territory in the north of Portugal and the *parias* of Sevilla and Badajoz.

Sancho II's dissatisfaction with this distribution soon became a matter of dispute. After successively defeating his two brothers in war, imprisoning García with Alfonso's help, and then forcing Alfonso to flee to the *taifa* of Toledo to seek its emir's protection,



The feudal host of León, Castilla, and Galicia—Lord mats, Capability cards and markers, Vassal Service markers, and unit pieces representing the military might of a unified Christian kingdom.

Sancho in 1072 proclaimed himself sole king of all the territories that his father had bequeathed. Later that same year, Sancho besieged his sister Urraca's stronghold at Zamora and there met his death by assassination. Alfonso wasted no time in returning to León and crowning himself King of Galicia, Castilla, and León.

The inclusion of Castilla under León that Alfonso achieved was not without friction. As the King of León during the war against Sancho II of Castilla, Alfonso got help from León's nobles, and now, in the distribution of the unified Kingdom's most important positions, he favored those Leonese noblemen who had fought at his side against his brother. In the years of Alfonso's reign to come, these Leonese would provide the King unwavering support. But the Castilian nobility felt left out—resentments that may have affected their eagerness to fight in the coming campaigns against the Almoravids. (See Muslim Event #M17 LEÓN Y CASTILLA.) Separately, just a few months after the defeat at Sagrajas, Alfonso had to put down a rebellion by major nobles of Galicia, who probably sought to free his imprisoned brother García. (See Muslim Event #M16 GALICIAN REVOLT.)

In 1076, an internal conspiracy culminated in the murder of King Sancho IV Garcés of Pamplona in the northeast. Alfonso VI skillfully took advantage of the resulting confusion to achieve new territorial gains, incorporating the holdings of Álava, Vizcaya, La Rioja, and part of Guipúzcoa into Castilla. Simultaneously, the Pamplonese nobles chose to entrust the crown of Pamplona to Sancho Ramírez, King of Aragón, who agreed to take control of the remainder of Pamplona's territory, establishing a union that would last to 1134.

With the Kingdom's internal situation stabilized, Alfonso VI followed in the footsteps of his father and concentrated his attention and efforts on the Muslim kingdoms to the south. Not only did he take sides in several disputes among the *taifa* emirs of Sevilla and Granada, Toledo and Badajoz, he also launched *cabalgadas*—long-range raids—into their territories and a campaign of conquest that in 1079 seized the town of Coria from Badajoz.

The King aimed most of these initiatives at forcing the *taifas* to continue to pay the *parias* that Alfonso then used to finance further military actions, maintain control over his nobility, and, to a lesser extent, develop projects to improve the Kingdom. And there was another important reason to enforce the collection of the *parias*, although it would bear fruit only over the long term: the *taifa* emirates' continuous financial bleeding would weaken them so as to make possible their definitive conquest by the Christians. That situation seemed to have arrived at the outset of 1085 for the *taifa* of Toledo.

In light of Alfonso VI's leading role in warring upon the Muslims in these years, *Almoravid* features numerous representatives from his Kingdom of León, Castilla, and Galicia—

- As Lords with their own mats and maneuver pieces: King Alfonso himself with his royal *mesnada* household troops, the Kingdom's most important counts Pedro Ansúrez of León and García Ordóñez of Castilla, Alfonso's current *alférez*—royal standard bearer—Álvar Fáñez, and Alfonso's most effective captain in prior years before exile and soon again as the Af-

rican Muslim threat became dire—Rodrigo Díaz de Vivar, *El Cid Campeador*.

- As royal Vassals who bring their own forces to augment the armies led by these great lords and captains, several other individual nobles of the period (some as wealthy as Pedro or García): the Leonese Counts Martín Flaínez and Martín Alfonso, Castilians Gonzalo Núñez and Gómez González, Galicians Froilá Bermudez and Vela Ovárez, and the high nobles of Asturias Fernando Díaz and Pelayo Peláez.
- Via the BISHOPRICS Capability card: the ecclesiastical Vassal forces of Bishops Pedro of León, Vistuario of Lugo, and Ede-noro of Orense.
- As Capability cards for the Christian side: lesser nobles who provide local and border defenses against Muslim raiders—CABALLERÍA VILLANA—and paid levies of commoners—MILITES—who add lighter forces, both mounted and on foot, to the feudal armies.

Kingdom of Aragón

Within the growing kingdom that joined León to Castilla, the latter would eventually overshadow the former. And centuries later, a monarch of that Kingdom of Castilla would partner with the ruler of Aragón to finally fully reconquer and reunify a Christian Spain. But in the late 11th Century, Aragón was still but a small kingdom, a tiny strip along the edge of *al-Andalus* and nowhere near the equal of Alfonso VI's León.

The history of Aragón as a kingdom began to take shape with Ramiro, the illegitimate son of King Sancho Garcés III of Pamplona. Known as Ramiro I, son and brother of kings, he ruled from his father's death in 1035 as a *de facto* king of what had been the County of Aragón. While his contemporaries treated him as a sovereign king, he did not call himself such, as Aragón on paper remained a holding of the Kingdom of Pamplona. Taking advantage of the death of his brother Gonzalo in 1044, Ramiro added to Aragón the territories of Sobrarbe and Ribagorza.

Ramiro died in 1063 as a casualty in a frustrated attempt to take the Muslim border fortress of Graus from the *taifa* of Zaragoza, which had the support of a *mesnada* sent by Fernando I of León to help the emir by virtue of his vassalage to the Leonese king.

Ramiro's eldest son and successor, Sancho I Ramírez, made a bold political move to reinforce Aragón's legitimacy as a kingdom and to escape *de jure* vassalage to the Kingdom of Pamplona: he travelled to Rome in 1068 to offer vassalage to Pope Alexander II. The murder in 1076 of Sancho Garcés IV of Pamplona by his own brother incited that kingdom's Pamplonese nobility to offer their crown to Sancho, achieving for Aragón the annexation of the Kingdom of Pamplona. In 1077, Sancho made the town of Jaca the capital of what was by then officially the Kingdom of Aragón.

While King Sancho I's greatest successes thus were at the expense of other Christians, he also carried on and eventually would gain some progress in his father's project of the conquest of territory from the *taifa* of Zaragoza. In 1064, Sancho took the town of Barbastro with the help of Frankish contingents attracted by a call for a crusade from Alexander II, but it re-

turned to Muslim hands the following year. His attempts at *Reconquista* accelerated in the late 1070s. During the early 1080s, Sancho Ramírez participated in a series of campaigns that arrayed Aragón and the Count of Barcelona (more on which below) with the neighboring Emir of Lérida, al-Mundir, on the one side, against al-Mundir's brother al-Mutamin, the Emir of Zaragoza, on the other. Al-Mutamin at this time had in his employ the great Castilian captain Rodrigo Díaz, the Cid, thanks to whom in no small measure the campaigns went badly for the Aragonese and Barcelonans.

In *Almoravid*, Sancho takes the field as an independent Lord on the Christian side but with notably fewer resources than available to León. His role often will be to either hold the line against any Muslim invasion of the Christian northeast or—depending on whether or not Barcelona or Rodrigo are in the field and, if so, on which side—to help press a Leonese offensive into Zaragoza's *taifa*.



Sancho's Lord mat and Vassal markers: Compare Aragón's modest army to the might of León!

The Catalan Counties

Although the *Almoravid* game board does not show the north-east third of the Iberian Peninsula, some of the political entities that inhabited that off-map area, the so-called Catalan Counties (see the context map near the top of this article), had a history of involvement in conflict with either Aragón or Zaragoza. They appear in the game in the form of forces that can augment certain Christian armies. For this reason, it is convenient here to add a little brushstroke on their behalf.

Once the 8th-Century Carolingian Empire had stopped the Muslim expansion beyond the Pyrenees and recovered the Frankish territories under its control, it set its sights on the north of Iberia with the dual objective of probing for new expansion and of consolidating a border region as an advanced bastion that would protect Gasconia, Septimania, and Aquitania against any renewed Muslim attacks.

Carolingian influence in the Peninsula differed in intensity and duration, from the alliance with the native Christian aristocracy (the Velasco in the Kingdom of Pamplona) to military conquests in collaboration with the Spanish-Gothic nobility. In this latter endeavor, the Franks' intervention ended up establishing a set of territories, articulated as counties and governed by Frankish counts or held by related local families. What has traditionally become known as the *Marca Hispanica* began its journey at the outset of the 9th Century with the counties of Aragón, Sobrarbe, Ribagorza, Pallars, Urgell, Cerdania, Conflent, Besalú, Osona, Barcelona, Rosselló, Vallespir, Girona, Perelada, and Ampurias.

Over time, the ties of dependency of these counties to their northern neighbor weakened. The continuing disputes among Charlemagne's successors and their collective inability to effectively assist border counties against the Muslim enemy caused a *de facto* natural evolution toward full autonomy. The marcher counties developed their own internal politics—with vassals, alliances, and internecine conflicts of their own—while trying to exploit their natural path of expansion to the south.

In the last third of the 11th Century, the political core of the Catalan Counties (those that did not render vassalage to others) comprised the counties of Barcelona, Urgell, Roselló, Ampurias, Pallars Jussa, and Pallars Sobirà. Of all these, only the key realms of Barcelona and Urgell appear in the game.

Almoravid represents the potential of the County of Barcelona to take part in the military campaigns of 1085-1086 with paired Event and Capability cards, one in each side's deck (cards #C13 and #M23). Either side can purchase the services of the COUNT OF BARCELONA's hard-hitting armored troops via a Capability card and the expenditure of two Coin. The forces may join only the Lords based in the northeast, near the Catalan Counties: either Sancho I of Aragón or the Burgundian crusader Duke Eudes for the Christians or al-Mustain of Zaragoza (al-Mutamin's son) or al-Mundir of Lérida for the Muslims. The Event on the same card—named for BERENGUER RAMON II, the Count of Barcelona during 1085-1086—should it occur, either leads the Count to abandon the enemy's service or to join up with the playing side at a far cheaper rate! This double possibility represents an inten-

tion on the part of Berenguer Ramon not only to garner pay but also to obtain plunder and land, perhaps at the cost of the *taifa* of Zaragoza as historically (and as noted in the section above), or of Lérida, or perhaps of Aragón.

Finally, the Catalan County of Urgell appears in the game as a Vassal force that Sancho of Aragón may Levy (as pictured just beneath Sancho's Lord mat shown above). In this period, County Urgell hewed closely to the Aragonese Kingdom and participated in many of the military expeditions that Sancho organized, such as the aforementioned siege of Barbastro.

Parias

Parias initially were fees to hire the troops of Christian kings and nobles to fight in the *taifas*' feuds. As *al-Andalus* disintegrated, *taifas* became so dependent on such Christian protection that the payments became an annual tribute, commonly 10,000 to 30,000 dinars. Barcelona's Berenguer Ramon I was the first, exploiting the wars among Zaragoza, Lérida, and Tortosa for gold he used, for example, to buy holdings from neighboring lords to restore Barcelona's previous power.

But the master collectors were León's Fernando I—who bequeathed his children *parias* concessions along with territory—and then Alfonso VI. *Parias* strengthened the King politically, fed commerce as lands along the Camino de Santiago repopulated, spurred introduction of Christian coinage, and built Church influence as it ended up in the coffers of Cluny and Rome. And *parias* would fuel further war against any Muslims who would not pay. (See also Christian Event #C10 DEVALUATION.)

But tribute relations also served as a brake on *Reconquista*, since payment guaranteed protection. Sancho of Castilla in 1063 defended Zaragoza's Graus against Aragón because his father had taken the *taifa*'s coin. At Cabra in 1079, two Leonese contingents sent by Alfonso VI to collect *parias*—one from Sevilla, the other from Granada—faced off against each other as the two *taifas* warred. And some historians note that part of the tribute cycled back into the *taifas* through the enriched noble Christians' demand for luxuries manufactured only by the Muslims.

But, for the Muslims, the tribute mainly added tax burden onto a restive population, while the draining of wealth northward devalued the Andalusian currency. The resulting rebellions contributed to the *taifas*' final downfall—not to their Christian protectors but to the Almoravids. (See Christian Event #C10 DEVALUATION and Muslim Event #M15 PARIAS REVOLT.) The fall to the Almoravids of the last *taifa*, Zaragoza, in 1110 would bring the *parias* age to an end. [AAJ]

Lord Histories

by Albert Alegre Jove

Here we discuss the lives of each Lord in the game before, during, and after the campaigns of 1085-1086.

The Muslims

Al-Mutamid

Muhammad ibn Abbad – Emir of Sevilla



Al-Mutamid ala Allah Muhammad ibn Abbad was born the second son of Sevilla's *taifa* king, Emir al-Mutadid, of the Arab Yemeni-origin Abadid dynasty. From 1052 or 1053 to 1063, al-Mutamid served his father as Governor of Silves and Algarve, where he met the poet Abu Bakr ibn Ammar and an enslaved woman, Rumaykiyya, with whom he fell totally in love. He married her and gave her the name Itimad, derived from al-Mutamid.

That year, 1063, al-Mutamid's future changed radically. His father executed al-Mutamid's older brother Ismail after discovering a plot that the elder son had orchestrated against the father. From that moment, al-Mutamid became the heir to the *taifa*. He returned to and resided in Sevilla as chamberlain and participated in his father's government and military expeditions. The latter included a failed campaign against Málaga, a failure which, it is said, he survived only because he wrote verses imploring his father to forgive him.

Upon al-Mutadid's death in 1069, al-Mutamid inherited rule over Sevilla without opposition. He soon appointed his poet friend Abu Bakr ibn Ammar as vizier. In 1070, al-Mutamid began a prolonged expansion of his *taifa* eastward, taking control of Córdoba—the old capital of all Muslim Iberia—and establishing his son as its governor. But the *taifa* of Toledo attacked and conquered Córdoba in 1075, capturing and executing al-Mutamid's son.

Sevilla counterattacked, and after several campaigns in 1078—by which time the ineffectual al-Qadir sat on the throne of Toledo—finally succeeded in regaining Córdoba as well as seizing portions of Toledan territory between the Guadalquivir and Guadiana rivers.

That same year, al-Mutamid with the advice of his vizier ibn Ammar took advantage of an internal conflict in the *taifa* of Murcia to take it over. After this conquest of Murcia, al-Mutamid made ibn Ammar its governor, but the former vizier soon began a conspiracy to declare himself independent.

This plot came to light, and ibn Ammar had to flee to Zaragoza, where he supported that *taifa* in an attack on Sevillian territory. The attack went awry, and ibn Ammar fell prisoner and was delivered to the Sevillian court. Al-Mutamid, despite the years that he had known and relied upon ibn Ammar, killed him with his own hands.

Al-Mutamid not only reigned over the apex of Sevilla's territorial power but also became known as the Poet King. During these years, he stimulated a flourishing of Arab poetry as the patron of many of the great names of the time, such as Abd al-Jalil al-Mursi. He himself and his wife Itimad were both prolific authors of poetic works.

After Sevilla's consolidation of control over Córdoba and a now semi-autonomous Murcia, al-Mutamid could focus his attention again on the Zirid dynasty's Emirate of Granada, the larger target of his earlier failed attack on Málaga. However, the costly campaigns that ensued achieved nothing but to reduce the strengths of both *taifas*. Net territorial gains were minimal and left both Sevilla and Granada in a more fragile situation against the Christian Kingdom of León.



Al-Mutamid, as imagined centuries later.

In late 1082 or early 1083, al-Mutamid tried to shake off the burdensome payment of *parias* to León. León's expansionist King Alfonso VI had sent an emissary demanding a huge sum. Al-Mutamid in response executed the ambassador. The affront drew a powerful Christian raid that laid siege to Sevilla for three days and reached Tarifa at Iberia's southern tip, forcing al-Mutamid to retract his denial of tribute. That year into the next, al-Mutamid began to look to North Africa for help. With his Sevillian fleet, he supported Almoravid troops in the taking of the African Mediterranean port of Ceuta, beginning a link to the Berber fundamentalists that over the long-term would be fatal to his rule.

When León's Alfonso VI in 1085 took Toledo, al-Mutamid understood that the new geopolitical situation placed Sevilla in a delicate position. It now shared a border with the largest and most powerful Christian kingdom in the Peninsula. The *parias* payments needed to calm this giant would surely increase to an exorbitant amount, perhaps beyond what even the strongest *taifa* could satisfy. Al-Mutamid saw to it that Sevilla secured Toledo's mighty southern bastion of Calatrava. Then, together with the other great *taifa* of the south of Iberia, Granada, he decided to request help from the Almoravid Sultanate.

It is at this moment that legend puts in his mouth his famous comment on this invitation of the Almoravids into Spain, taken it is supposed from a conversation with his son. Per one translation:

"My son, by God, you should not hear me say, ever, that I made al-Andalus a dwelling place for infidels, nor did I leave it to the Christians, so that I would not be cursed from the syrups of Islam, as it happens with others. For God, I'd rather take care of camels [in Africa] than pigs [in León]."

Al-Mutamid, in addition to sharing the expenses of the Almoravid expedition with other *taifas* of the south, relinquished his control of the port of Algeciras on the strait to the Almoravid Yusuf, so that it could become the African army's crossing point and base of operations.

Al-Mutamid welcomed Yusuf's host at Sevilla and joined it on the campaign north to the great clash at Sagrajas (Zalaqa). The victory against the Christians buoyed al-Mutamid's spirit, as that of the rest of the *taifa* lords, who all stopped paying *parias* to Alfonso. But that confidence breathed into the Muslims of *al-Andalus* did not last long.

Some weeks before Sagrajas, a Christian *cabalgada* had seized and rebuilt the strategic castle of Aledo in Murcia. Aledo lay along the route of communications from Sevilla to its easternmost territories and the *taifas* of the northeast. From its new enclave, León launched constant raids on Sevillian and Granadan territory, again highlighting the military inability of these Muslim kingdoms to rid themselves on their own of Christian pressure.

For this reason, al-Mutamid again sought the Almoravids' intervention. Yusuf in 1088 landed again to help retake Aledo castle. But this time, disagreements among the *taifa* lords ruined the campaign. As Sevilla, Granada, and Almería quarreled, Murcia's semi-autonomous ruler al-Rashid played a double game of support to the Muslim recovery of the castle and help to its defenders, in a bid for Christian support for his independence from Sevilla. In the end, it proved impossible for the Almoravids to take the castle because their *taifa* hosts withdrew from the campaign at the news of the approach of Alfonso's relief army.

The disappointment marked a turning point, as the Almoravids now began instead to conquer the Peninsula's Muslim territory. Granada and Málaga fell into Almoravid hands with little or no resistance. Al-Mutamid, in contrast, battled the invasion, losing several of his sons in the defense. But, as in the other *taifas*, subjects who wanted to become part of the Almoravid empire conspired against the emir. Sevilla finally fell to Sir ibn Abu Bakr in September 1091, who deported al-Mutamid and what remained of his family—his wife and daughters—to Agmat in North Africa.

Al-Mutamid survived in exile there, it is said, thanks to his daughters' spinning-wheel work. But, after the death of his beloved Itimad, he fell into melancholy and died, just four years after the fall of Sevilla.

Abd Allah

ibn Buluggin ibn Ziri – Emir of Granada



The ethnic Berber Abu Muhammad Abd Allah ibn Buluggin ibn Badis ibn Habus ibn Maksan ibn Ziri Manad al-Sinhayi was the last Zirid ruler of the *Taifa* of Granada (1073-1090).

Abd Allah inherited Granada as an unintended consequence of a palace plot by the *taifa's* Jewish vizier, Yusuf ibn Nagrela. The vizier intended

Emir Badis ibn Habus Buluggin's second son, Maksan ibn Badis, to inherit the seat. To achieve this, the vizier ordered the death of the elder son, the governor of Granada's southwest stronghold port of Málaga and Abd Allah's father. The vizier failed, however, to obtain Maksan's favor and so decided to look for another pawn, seeing to it that Maksan would fall from grace and be exiled to the town of Jaén in Granada's north. The vizier next attempted to orchestrate a consolidation of Granada by the *taifa* of Almería,

but the conspiracy came to light. The city's Muslim population stormed the palace and killed the conspiratorial vizier and with him a large part of the Jewish population.

The realm's eligible heirs upon Emir Badis's death were his two grandsons Tamim ibn Buluggin (the eldest) and Abd Allah. A later vizier, apparently, had separated their uncle Maksan from the inheritance. The sheikhs at court agreed to enthrone the younger grandson Abd Allah because doing so would enable them to control power through the great Vizier Simaya until Abd Allah's coming of age and in the process earn his trust and so retain their influence.

This decision caused Tamim—already of legal age and governor of Málaga—to declare himself independent and assume power in his region, re-establishing Málaga as an independent *taifa*.

During Abd Allah's minority rule from 1073, Granada under the government of the great Vizier Simaya suffered constant attacks on its borders. Granada refused to pay *parias* tribute to King Alfonso VI of León, who responded by supporting the *taifa* of Sevilla (who was paying him) in Sevilla's campaigns to plunder and conquer the territory of its *taifa* rival Granada. In addition to this front, the *taifa* of Almería took advantage of this delicate situation to seize from Granada the town of Baza and its surrounding fortified places.

In 1078, unable to bear any longer the pressure from Sevilla and León, Granada agreed to pay *parias* to León. And, from 1082 onward, relations between Sevilla and Granada improved, giving Abd Allah—then of age and able to exercise power—a certain respite. Among his first autonomous actions was to dismiss his vizier, Simaya, who left for Almería in a vengeful spirit.

Also in 1082, Emir Tamim of Málaga launched a campaign against his younger brother Abd Allah's realm. Málaga's military venture against Granada fared poorly, cost Málaga possession of many places, and forced Tamim to ask his brother's forgiveness.

After King Alfonso's conquest of Toledo in 1085, Christians increased their ravaging of the *taifas* of the south, including Granada. Abd Allah beat off one such raid with a victorious fight at Nívar near his capital. During this time, Abd Allah attacked the *taifa* of Almería, where Simaya was acting against him; however, after conquering some positions, Abd Allah decided to offer peace.

Abd Allah by early 1086 finally joined the *taifas* of Sevilla and Badajoz to ask the Almoravids of Africa for help against the Christians. As the Almoravid Sultan Yusuf later that year marched his massive army toward the enemy, Abd Allah in turn answered Yusuf's call to arms. Abd Allah led his own army and joined the allied Muslim host on the way north to Badajoz. The resulting Almoravid-led Muslim victory at Sagrajas seemed to relieve Abd Allah of any further need to pay *parias* to León.

But threats to Abd Allah just kept growing. After Sagrajas, he faced not only coup attempts by Tamim but also internal revolts by the Jews of Lucena and by some Zanata Berber troops and dissent over a tax increase necessary to pay Granada's share for Almoravid campaigns on the Iberian Peninsula (Sagrajas in 1086 and a strike on Christian-held Aledo castle in 1088).

The failed Aledo campaign deepened suspicions between Yusuf and the *taifa* lords. Abd Allah—unsure of the Almoravids' intentions—decided to resume paying *parias* to obtain Alfonso's protection. King Alfonso conditioned León's help on Granada making good as well on the *parias* due for the previous years. Abd Allah agreed and paid out of his own coffers for fear of the revolt that yet another tax might provoke.

This arrangement came to Yusuf's attention. In 1090, he returned to the Peninsula, clearly intent on using Granada's submission to León to begin his conquest of the *taifas*. Abd Allah's coexistence with the Christians and the taxes that he earlier had charged for *parias* payments to them made it easy for Yusuf to gain support of local sheikhs and the Muslim population broadly against Abd Allah. Seeing that he had no chance of resistance, Abd Allah surrendered on September 8, 1090, making Granada the first *taifa* to fall into Almoravid hands.

Abd Allah was banished to the Maghreb, held captive in the city of Aghmat, where he would write his memoirs, *al-Tibyan*, an account of the Zirid dynasty of Granada. Although surely intended as propaganda, Abd Allah's written account is the best source we have on the conspiracies among the *taifa* states, their weaknesses, and their relations with the Christians in the immediate pre-Almoravid period.

Al-Mutawakkil

Umar ibn Muhammad – Emir of Badajoz



Umar al-Mutawakkil Ula Allah ibn Muhammad ibn Abd Allah ibn al-Aftas was the last ruler of the Berber-origin Aftasid dynasty of the *taifa* of Badajoz. His reign, like of his fellow Berber Abd Allah of Granada, also was the end result of palatial intrigues. But, unlike the latter case, these were intrigues orchestrated by him.

Umar al-Mutawakkil's father was Emir of Badajoz Muhammad al-Muzaffar (1045 to 1067). But the Emir had another son, Yahya, older than Umar. During his father's reign, Umar was appointed Governor of Évora and other regions of the *Taifa*. When Muhammad died, the kingdom by his decree passed into the hands of Yahya, who reigned as Yahya al-Mansur II.

As had happened before in other kingdoms, Christian and *taifa*, the younger heir Umar disputed the power of his brother and declared the territories he ruled independent. The wars that their father had fought against Sevilla and León and the weight of *parias* payments as the price of peace with the latter kingdom had left Badajoz in a precarious situation that forced the two brothers each to seek outside support to finance his candidacy.

Yahya gained the support of the ruling dynasty in Toledo (the Banu Dhi l-Nun) in exchange for naming its ruler Abul Hassan Yahya ibn Ismail heir to Badajoz. Umar got the support of Sevilla. Badajoz's externally supported civil war would finish grinding the *taifa* and ruining its people, ending only after Yahya's sudden death in 1072. With that, Umar proclaimed himself sole ruler of the *taifa*, adopting the title *al-Mutawakkil ala Allah* (he who relies on God).

Al-Mutawakkil, perhaps seeking to revitalize his realm, during the first years of his reign developed a powerful cultural movement that made Badajoz the seat of the Andalusian literary elite. The poets Ibn Yaje, Ibn Mucana, and the al-Qabturnu brothers and the philosophers Ibn Sidi al-Batalyawsi and Abu al-Walid al-Baji frequented his court. He had *almunias* gardens built in his official residences where he could exercise the art of literature, especially poetry. After some issues with his viziers, al-Mutawakkil decided to rule without such high officials.

As a result, the figure of al-Mutawakkil has come down to us as an extremely educated man. But his oasis of Badajoz did not comport with the reality of what was happening in the Iberian Peninsula. Soon the drums of war woke al-Mutawakkil from his reverie and reminded him of Badajoz's position of border *taifa*.

King Alfonso VI of León had been exploiting the weak character of the ruler of Toledo, al-Qadir, slowly but inexorably to seize power over that *taifa*. Alfonso's growing influence raised opposition in Toledo that sought help from neighboring *taifas* and found it in al-Mutawakkil. Claiming such a request, he entered Toledo in 1080 and exiled al-Qadir.

Al-Mutawakkil's performance in his new position of power over both Badajoz and Toledo is unclear, but the situation that the Toleman kingdom was in could not have helped. It remained polarized between the detractors and followers of al-Qadir's policy of accommodation with Christians. In any case, al-Mutawakkil did not have much time to exercise rule over his new realm. Alfonso, having agreed with al-Qadir to help him regain the throne, began a series of attacks on Badajoz that forced al-Mutawakkil back to his court there to organize a defense, leaving the door open for al-Qadir's return to Toledo.

The loss to León of the strategic city of Coria in the *taifa*'s north—key to control of the borderland between Christian and Muslim territory—added another hard blow to Badajoz.

After the fall of Toledo definitively into Christian hands in early 1085, al-Mutawakkil became one of the promoters, together with the lords of Sevilla and Granada, of the request for help from the Almoravids of North Africa. In the fall of 1086, he would welcome the Almoravid host into his capital city and join it in battle on the plains to its north. The Almoravids' aid and that victory over the Christians at Sagradas, as we already know, brought short-term respite to the Peninsula's *taifas* but ended up signaling the reigning dynasties' end. For al-Mutawakkil, that end would be death.

After Almoravid conquest from 1090 of the *taifas* of Granada, Málaga, and Sevilla and their advance up the eastern coast, al-Mutawakkil attempted to save his emirate by seeking Alfonso's protection while at the same time maintaining relations with the Almoravid Sultan Yusuf. But Badajoz's populace and ruling class opposed the pact with the Christians. In order to keep their realm in the Muslim orbit, they betrayed their monarch, imprisoning al-Mutawakkil and his family and delivering the *taifa* to Yusuf. The Sultan accused al-Mutawakkil of collaboration with Christians and condemned him and his two sons al-Fadl and al-Abbas to execution. A third son, al-Mansur, escaped and resisted briefly until surrendering to Alfonso.

Abu Bakr

ibn Abd al-Aziz – Emir of Valencia



Abu Bakr Muhammad ibn Abd al-Aziz ibn al-Mansur ibn Abi Amir lived from about 1050 to his death in Valencia on June 6th, 1085. He was the second son of Abd al-Aziz ibn Abd al-Rahman, Amirid dynasty Emir (*taifa* king) of Valencia. The Emir died in 1061, passing rule to Abu Bakr's older brother Abd al-Malik ben Abd al-Aziz al-Mansur Modafar. During his al-Malik's reign, Abu Bakr served as his brother's Prime Minister.

Everything changed in 1065. Yahya al-Mamun, Emir of Toledo and al-Malik's father-in-law by al-Malik's marriage to one of al-Mamun's daughters, turned on his son-in-law. Taking advantage of Valencia's weakness after a campaign of resistance against Fernando I of León, al-Mamun conspired with al-Malik's vizier, Ibn Rawbas, to usurp the Valencian throne. After imprisoning or exiling al-Malik (depending on the source), the *taifa* lord of Toledo annexed Valencia's territory and made its former vizier Ibn Rawbas its new governor.

But, for some reason, al-Mamun took no action against the younger Amirid, Abu Bakr, who continued to serve in the government of Ibn Rawbas, albeit not as Prime Minister, for some 10 years.

In 1075, upon al-Mamun's death, his grandson al-Qadir acceded to the throne of Toledo. Al-Qadir was a weak ruler who relied on the complicity of the Christian King Alfonso VI to maintain his seat. Abu Bakr now could use this closeness of Toledo to the Christians to raise sentiment against that *taifa* and, after imprisoning its proxy Ibn Rawbas, take power in Valencia.

Thereafter, Abu Bakr needed his best political skills to avoid continuous threats against his domain. To the south, Governor of Murcia and Sevilla vizier ibn Ammar plotted to betray and become independent from Sevilla. Ibn Ammar tried to attract Abu Bakr to his cause. The latter wisely refused and, it seems, warned al-Mutamid of Sevilla of the treason.

To the north, al-Muqtadir of the great *taifa* of Zaragoza (which included Zaragoza, Lérida, Tortosa, and its recently conquered southern exclave of Denia) had now set his eyes on Valencia. Abu Bakr, with the army of Zaragoza already at his gates, managed to maintain his hold on power, though not without losing part of his sovereignty. After al-Muqtadir's death and the partition of his Zaragoza *taifa* between his two sons, Abu Bakr agreed to the protection of al-Mutamin, the son who had inherited Zaragoza's western half. This move of fealty toward al-Mutamin may have reflected the fact that the other son and now Emir of Lérida al-Mundir quickly showed an interest not only in recovering the entire *taifa* of Zaragoza but also in invading Valencia—an endeavor in which al-Mundir enjoyed the aid of the Count of Barcelona and the King of Aragón.

This new relationship between Valencia and Zaragoza became more evident when Abu Bakr decided to marry off his daughter to al-Mutamin's son and heir, al-Mustain II. The move reinforced Valencia's young alliance with a powerful neighbor, but it would be too little to save the Amirid dynasty. Abu Bakr died in the

spring of 1085, leaving his unpopular son Uthman on a throne vulnerable to internal and external machinations that saw Leon take control via its puppet emir, al-Qadir. (See Campaign History later in this booklet.)

Al-Mustain II

Ahmad ibn Yusuf ibn Hud – Emir of Zaragoza



Abu Yafar Ahmad ibn Yusuf ibn Hud al-Mustain bi-Llah, son of al-Mutamin of the Hudid dynasty, ruled Zaragoza from 1085 until conquered by the Almoravids in 1110. We have little information from him or from his uncle al-Mundir, Emir of Lérida; what we know of his reign is thanks to the events told in the chronicles of the other

kingdoms (especially about events involving the Christians). If there is one characteristic that can define al-Mustain II, it would be his capacity for survival. This ability helped him face a succession of challenges with a specific strategy against each. Proof of this is the different relationships he had with each of the kingdoms bordering Zaragoza.

Toward Lérida to his east, al-Mustain gave up his father al-Mutamin's effort to reunify the territory of Zaragoza, which in the days of al-Mustain's grandfather al-Muqtadir had comprised Zaragoza, Lérida, Tortosa, and Denia. The nephew and uncle *taifa* lords appear to have sealed no express agreement, but the borders between the two realms, beyond some minor border actions, became quiet during al-Mustain's reign. This calm between the *taifas* resulted from the enormous pressure that the Christian Kingdom of Aragón (and, in 1086, León) exerted on Zaragoza's northern border and against which al-Mustain needed to muster all his military, political, and economic resources.

Toward Valencia to his south, al-Mustain had similar aspirations of conquest as those harbored by his uncle al-Mundir of Lérida (see below). But Zaragoza's position between the two Christian kingdoms of Aragón and León would not allow him to embark on a military expedition southward that could weaken the *taifa*'s defenses to the north and west. His alternative strategy was to take advantage of a moment of political weakness in Valencia to seize its territory by dynastic claim.

This possibility came in 1085-1086. Al-Mustain's father al-Mutamin before his death had allied Zaragoza with Valencia via a marriage between his son and the daughter of Valencia's emir, Abu Bakr. When Abu Bakr died soon thereafter, leaving his son Uthman on an unstable throne, the situation became favorable for al-Mustain to assert a claim on Valencia via his union with Uthman's sister. He was ready to act when Alfonso VI of León led one campaign against Zaragoza territory and sent another to intervene in Valencia. The Leonese ravaged the countryside surrounding Zaragoza and put the city itself under siege. The Christian campaigns made it impossible for al-Mustain to take sides in the unrest in Valencia, which fell under the influence of León.

Al-Mustain's relationship with the Kingdom of León to his west changed direction several times during his reign. He first resisted military pressure, including the siege of Zaragoza in 1086, in Alfonso's effort to force him to pay *parias*. But eventually al-Mus-

tain did pay and was then able to add Leonese *mesnadas* to Zaragoza forces for defense against Aragonese incursions including the battle for Huesca in 1097. Finally, al-Mustain for his survival in 1102 submitted to Almoravid power.

Al-Mustain had not answered Yusuf ibn Tashufin's initial call to the *taifas* in 1086, nor did he support the Almoravids in their repeated attacks on Christian-held Valencia over the following years. However, after the Almoravids succeeded in taking every other *taifa* on the peninsula, the most recent to succumb being nearby Lérida in 1102, and after the final fall of Christian Valencia into the hands of the Almoravids that year, al-Mustain knew that he had to act fast. His emirate, the last Muslim realm on the peninsula independent of the Almoravids would soon be absorbed and he very likely would end up dead for his previous agreements with Christians powers. Al-Mustain sent his son to the Almoravid court at Marrakesh to plead Zaragoza's submission. His bet paid off, and Zaragoza became an Almoravid vassal state with some autonomy while al-Mustain still reigned.

El Cid had been one of those Christians with which Zaragoza had treated. It remains unclear whether Rodrigo was still in Zaragozaan service over the short span of time between al-Mustain's accession in 1085 and King Alfonso's first reconciliation with the Cid in late 1086, the period that included Alfonso's siege of Zaragoza city. What we do know is that, after Rodrigo's second exile from León in 1089, al-Mustain became the Cid's main ally, supporting him in those first years in which he acted independently in the *Levante* area (Valencia and Denia). The record is less clear once Rodrigo became lord of Valencia in 1094, but we have no report of any clash between him and al-Mustain. The Almoravids would have been the main enemy common to Valencia and Zaragoza in those years, probably spurring an unwritten non-aggression pact between their Christian and Muslim lords.

Al-Mustain's relations toward the Christian kingdom of Aragón to his north, in contrast to the fluctuating affairs with other neighbors, was one of total war throughout. Al-Mustain lived long enough to face three Aragonese kings in succession—Sancho I Ramírez, Pedro I, and Alfonso I—who little by little conquered key possessions such as Monzón (1089), Balaguer (1096), Huesca (1097), and Barbastro (1101) and besieged Zaragoza itself. Sancho of Aragón would die beneath the walls of Huesca in 1094, and his implacable enemy al-Mustain himself would die on the northern front, near Tudela in the 1110 Battle of Valtierra against the Aragonese troops of Alfonso I *el Batallador*.

Al-Mundir

ibn Ahmad ibn Hud – Emir of Lérida



Al-Mundir Imad ad-Dawla ibn Hud was the son of al-Muqtadir, emir of the *taifa* of Zaragoza of the Banu Hud dynasty. Sources differ on his path to becoming sovereign of the *taifa* of Lérida (formed by the territories of Lérida in its north, Tortosa to the south, and the exclave of Denia further down the coast). The first possibility is that his father

al-Muqtadir at his death in 1081 divided Zaragoza's territory between his two sons, giving al-Mundir the lands that became the

independent *taifa* of Lérida and the remainder to al-Mundir's brother al-Mutamin. The second possibility is that the father actually named al-Mutamin heir to the whole realm, but al-Mundir rebelled and managed to take control of Lérida, Tortosa, and Denia—the regions that al-Mundir had been sent to govern during his father's convalescence.

Al-Mundir's reign would see two distinct periods. The first period lasted from his seizure of power in 1081 to the death of his brother al-Mutamin of Zaragoza in 1085. During these years, al-Mundir decided to agree to pay *parias* to Berenguer Ramon II, Count of Barcelona, to avoid aggression from this powerful Christian state on Lérida's eastern border and to focus the *taifa's* efforts on defense against and attacks upon Zaragoza. The resulting war between the two Hudid brothers led to two important battles:

- In 1082, al-Mundir together with the troops of the Christian Counties of Barcelona, Cerdeña, and Berga faced his brother al-Mutamin at Almenar.
- In 1084, Lérida allied with the Kingdom of Aragón fought Zaragoza in the Battle of Morella.

Unfortunately for al-Mundir's ambitions against his brother, the commander of the Zaragozan army in this period was none other than Rodrigo Díaz de Vivar—El Cid. Al-Mundir and his allies met defeat at both Almenar and Morella, and Lérida had to cede control of the key locales of Escarp, Monzón, and Almenar.

The second period would begin in 1085 after the death of al-Mutamin and the rise to power in Zaragoza of al-Mutamin's son and al-Mundir's nephew, al-Mustain II. This succession marked the end of hostilities, or at least of open warfare, between Lérida and Zaragoza. This respite allowed al-Mundir in 1086 to use a distress call from the governor of the Valencian town of Játiva to invade the Valencia *taifa*. Játiva's governor opposed the newly installed Emir of Valencia, al-Qadir, a puppet of King Alfonso VI of León. Al-Mundir, backed by his ally Berenguer Ramon, put the city of Valencia under siege. However, quick help to al-Qadir from a Christian *mesnada*—sent by Alfonso under command of Álvaro Fáñez—prevented the city's fall.

Later that year, Almoravid Sultan Yusuf ibn Tashufin sent a request to all *taifa* lords to join him in the campaign that would end in the Battle of Sagradas that October. Al-Mundir did not respond. His *taifa* in the northeast of the Peninsula was far off from the southern emirates of *al-Andalus* wrapped up in support of the Almoravids against León. Moreover, it seems that al-Mundir distrusted the Berber Almoravids.

In 1090, al-Mundir again had to face Rodrigo Díaz de Vivar, this time in a campaign that the mercenary captain—exiled from León for a second time—was carrying out in Denia for his own benefit. To try to stop the advance of the Cid, al-Mundir again asked the Count of Barcelona for help. They set off towards the south, but El Cid moved north toward them and promptly defeated them in the Battle of Tévar. As at the Battle of Almenar in 1082, Rodrigo took Berenguer Ramon prisoner. He then forced the Count to yield to him the *parias* gold that al-Mundir had paid the Barcelonan for the defense of Denia. Al-Mundir died soon thereafter, succeeded by his son that year.

Yusuf

ibn Tashufin – Emir al-Murabitin



Yusuf may be the most mysterious character in this story, not so much from his nature as in how such different versions of him appear in the various sources, from the charismatic savior of the faith that Abd Allah of Granada presented us in his memoirs to the Muslim fundamentalist and Berber conqueror that the Christians described. If we stick to facts, at least the sum of individual points that form larger outlines that cannot be misrepresented, history presents us a military leader, superior administrator, and skillful player in the game of politics who not only took control of an empire but expanded it beyond its natural limits.

Yusuf was born into the Lamtuna tribe (Berber *Ilemteyen*) of the widespread Sanhaja (*Iznagen*) people, somewhere in the western Sahara between 1010 and 1020. The Lamtuna held the most power within the Sanhaja confederation of tribes that started the Almoravid movement of reformed Islam (*al-Murabitun*). Of the ruling caste, Yusuf as a young man joined his cousin and Almoravid military chief Abu Bakr ibn Umar on various campaigns in which Yusuf showed great value and energy.

Abu Bakr between 1060 and 1061, now leader of the Almoravids after succession from his brother, had to quell a rebellion by the Masuda, another Sanhaja tribe discontent with the Lamtuna's preeminence. While away, he entrusted Yusuf with government of the Almoravids' Moroccan territories. Although Abu Bakr was away for less than two years, Yusuf carried out a complete military and administrative reorganization of the region, gaining credit for founding the city of Marrakesh, the future Almoravid capital. Yusuf with these acts won enough support to hold onto power upon Abu Bakr's return and effectively exile Abu Bakr to fight other tribes to the south.

From that moment until 1084, Yusuf dedicated his energy to territorial expansion in Africa, finally achieving the unification by force or through pacts of the entire Maghreb under Almoravid rule. During these first years of the 1080s, Yusuf made contact with the Muslim *taifa* emirates of the Iberian Peninsula, who provided naval support in a 1084 Almoravid campaign to conquer the Mediterranean port of Ceuta.

Out of this alliance came the well-known call for Almoravid help from the *taifas* of al-Andalus in 1086. Aged about 70 years, Yusuf led his Almoravid host in person and (as detailed elsewhere in this booklet) triumphed brilliantly over the *taifas'* Christian foes at the Battle of Sagradas that October. Yusuf then departed the Peninsula suddenly (perhaps to fend off his old rival Abu Bakr back home). He returned to Iberia for frustrated stabs at the Christian strongholds of Aledo in 1088 and Toledo in 1090.

We do not know whether Yusuf had harbored any intent before Sagradas to conquer the Muslim emirates of *al-Andalus*. His declaration to the *taifa* lords after their joint victory of himself as *Emir al-Muslimin*—Commander of the Muslims—hints at such ambitions. But what does seem certain is that he saw weakness in the internal intrigues among the *taifa* lords that presented him

opportunity. And he suspected that, despite the *taifas*' ongoing resistance to the Christian enemy and at least sometimes successful military support to the Almoravids, sooner or later this or that emir would again submit to King Alfonso.

Yusuf's conquest of Muslim Iberia began in 1090, after the failed attempt to take Toledo back from the Christians. From then on, one emirate after another across the south of the Peninsula fell into Almoravid hands, as if *al-Andalus* were a house of cards. Military force accompanied the conquest but in many cases was not necessary since the Almoravid movement had the support of the region's Islamic jurists (*faqih*) and of a large part of its Muslim population. The Almoravids benefitted from their military prestige—they won battles—and from a fiscal policy that hewed faithfully to Koranic prescription—no *parias* tribute to infidels. In this way, by 1094, the entire southern half of Iberia turned Almoravid.

The Almoravids would go on to further victories. Yusuf at about age 80 in 1097 won the Battle of Consuegra that saw the death of El Cid's son. Pope Paschal II had to prohibit the participation of Leonese and Castilian knights in the First Crusade to the Holy Land, as they were necessary in defense of their own kingdom. The most effective bulwark against the Almoravid tide over the *taifas* turned out to be a Christian-held strongpoint in Iberia's east: the Valencia of Rodrigo de Vivar, El Cid. After the Cid's death and a valiant defense by his widow Jimena, Valencia in 1102 finally fell into Yusuf's hands, followed by Lérida. Albarracín would follow in 1104 and Alpuente in 1106. Only the Zaragozaans would resist long enough not to fall during Yusuf's lifetime—and they would fall into the hands of his son.

Yusuf died in Marrakesh on September 4th, 1106, somewhere between 86 and 96 years old, having a few years earlier proclaimed his son as legitimate heir. Eventually, recollection of him would reduce to cliché as the righteous and devoted Muslim Sultan with a thin beard, aquiline nose, and black eyes who always dressed in wool and consumed only barley bread and camel's meat and milk. The end of his long and brilliant life would spare him seeing the Almoravids' later decline into decadence—not unlike that of the Andalusian Caliphate that had birthed the *taifas*—only themselves to fall prey to a new wave of Islamic reform under the Almohads.

Sir

ibn Abi Bakr – Lamtuna Chieftain



Sir ibn Abu Bakr (or Syr ibn Abi Bakr) of the Berber Lamtuna tribe was cousin to Yusuf ibn Tashufin as well as husband of one of Yusuf's sisters, Hawa. It is very likely that Sir's close family relationship to the Sultan gave him the initial opportunity to occupy key positions in the Almoravids' government: Yusuf needed people of trust around him. But any nepotism with regard to Sir soon proved itself justified because Sir demonstrated excellent military skills, perhaps even surpassing Yusuf's own.

When Alfonso's knights broke the Andalusian front line at Sagradas in October 1086, Yusuf sent Sir with his Moroccan contingents to bolster al-Mutamid in the front, while Yusuf swung round

with Saharan regiments to attack the Christian camp. Sir not only shone at Sagradas, he would go on to defeat the Christians in other battles and become the Almoravid general to conquer most of the *taifa* kingdoms across the Peninsula's south.

After Yusuf in September 1090 marched on Granada, deposed Abd Allah, and annexed his *taifa*, he returned to Africa, leaving Sir and other Almoravid generals to finish the work of reducing *al-Andalus*. Sir—despite efforts by King Alfonso to help defend *taifa* independence—overran Córdoba the following spring and summer and in September 1091 stormed Sevilla and sent al-Mutamid captive to Africa. The fall of Almería and Iberia's southwest and southeast quickly followed.

In 1093-1094, Sir campaigned against the politically weak al-Mutawakkil, who was by then also under Alfonso's protection. Sir took Badajoz by assault, capturing the emir and his sons, who all were murdered. Sir then defeated a Christian army near Lisboa, adding that territory to the Almoravid empire. As gratitude for Sir's services, Yusuf granted him rule over Sevilla and Badajoz. Sir ibn Abu Bakr died in Sevilla in 1113, on his way to Marrakesh with his wife and daughter.

The Christians

Alfonso VI

King of León



Alfonso VI of León, called "El Bravo", is a monarch who leaves no one indifferent. His reign saw episodes of greatness and of the lowest human nature. Most of all, he knew how to overcome defeat to influence and lead the great nobles of the day, Galicians, Castilians, and Leonese.

Alfonso was born 1040 or 1041, the second son of Fernando I and Sancha of León, but fourth brother of five in line for the Leonese monarchy. He spent much of his childhood in the domains of Ansur Díaz of the powerful Banu Gómez family, who educated Alfonso in both the liberal arts (opposite of servile arts) and war. There Alfonso sealed a great friendship with Ansur's son, Pedro Ansúrez.

By the Gothic tradition followed in León, the entire kingdom should have passed to Alfonso's older brother, Sancho. But King Fernando came from a Pamplona dynasty whose tradition was to hand each male child a part. So, at his *Curia Regia* of 1063, he presented his testament as follows:

- Sancho would receive the County of Castilla, elevated to a Kingdom, plus the *parias* of Zaragoza.
- Alfonso was given the Kingdom of León with the *parias* of Toledo.
- Their younger brother García would rule the region of Galicia, also elevated to Kingdom, and take the *parias* of Badajoz and Sevilla.
- Their sisters Urraca and Elvira gained the income of the royal monasteries and, respectively, the towns of Zamora and Toro.

Fernando died two years later, and Alfonso in January 1066 was crowned Alfonso VI of León. But far from the family harmony in equity that Fernando sought, after his wife Sancha died in late 1067, a seven-year fratricidal war ensued. Alfonso's and Sancho's frustrated aspirations in the division of the kingdom combined with the quest for political supremacy of one nobility over the other, Leonese versus Castilian.

Alfonso VI of León and Sancho II of Castilla met in battle at Llantada in 1068. Some sources say that the brothers organized the showdown as a Judgment of God, in which the victor would take the other's kingdom. Alfonso was defeated but escaped, and the war went on.

In 1071, the Galician nobility rose against King García. Sancho with Alfonso's complicity exploited the unrest to militarily occupy his kingdom, forcing García into exile in Sevilla. The next year, the León-Castilla dispute renews with the Battle of Golpejera, in which Sancho again defeats but this time imprisons Alfonso then sends him and Pedro Ansúrez into exile in Toledo. Sancho II of Castilla was now also King of León and Galicia.

But the Leonese nobles behind Alfonso did not rest, unwilling to see León again trampled by Castilla. (Fernando I had been Count of Castilla before taking over as León's King.) They quickly organize several uprisings, the most important in Zamora, the stronghold of Sancho and Alfonso's older sister Urraca. Sancho besieged Zamora and fell there to an assassin. Alfonso made his way to the scene to obtain the backing of León's bishops and counts, including his faithful friend Pedro, as well as of Castilian nobles such as García Ordoñez to recover the crown of both kingdoms.

García similarly tried to return, but Alfonso captured him in 1073 and locked him up in the castle of Luna until his death in 1090.

For Alfonso, the good times rolled on. 1076 saw the assassination of King of Pamplona Sancho Garcés IV. Alfonso exploited the ensuing power struggle among Pamplona's nobles to place his favorite on the throne and take the holdings of Álava, Vizcaya, Guipuzcoa, and La Bureba for himself.

Having reunified the coercive force that had been available to his father, Alfonso added to these territorial gains his domination of the *taifas*. Giving them the choice of pillage or *parias*, he exercised an indirect control over Iberia's Muslims that the smaller Christian population could not have achieved directly. In a display of his power, in 1077 he took the title *Imperator totius Hispaniae*: Emperor of all the Peninsula's inhabitants regardless of religion.

Alfonso deployed his *parias* and newly won lands to control his nobility with grants of dinars, new counties or other lordships, and *tenencias* (non-hereditary lands). Shrewdly, he alternated royal appointments between Leonese and Castilian magnates. The lack of Galician representation would create later problems. (See Muslim Event #M16 GALICIAN REVOLT.) But in Alfonso's early reign the Kingdom became stable and its nobles ready to embark on what would become their key venture, the 1085 conquest of the *taifa* of Toledo.

Sagrajas in late 1086 forced Alfonso and the Christians onto the defensive. There was the crusade on Tudela in 1087, suppression of Galician revolts in 1088, and a Leonese incursion into the Mus-

lim east of the Peninsula in 1092. But most of Alfonso's remaining campaigns responded to the Almoravids' invasion, conquest of *al-Andalus*, and continual attacks on Toledo.

Despite losing troops in one battlefield defeat to the Almoravids after another—including the loss of the King's son at Uclés in 1108—Alfonso's loss of territory was minimal. Most importantly, Toledo City remained under Christian banners. Alfonso's control over his vassals generated a capacity for resistance: they closed ranks around him, fought, and in many cases died in the field to preserve the Kingdom of León.

Alfonso died in Toledo on July 1, 1109, aged about 70. He had seen to a change in royal inheritance in favor of his eldest daughter, the *infanta* Urraca (niece of the elder Urraca of Zamora), his only male heir having died on the field of Uclés the year before. Urraca's marriage to the Aragonese King Alfonso I "El Batallador" gave hope of strengthening the Christian kingdoms for the difficult years to come. But whether it did so or not is a tale to be told elsewhere.

Pedro Ansúrez

Count of Carrión & Saldaña



Pedro Ansúrez was among the most important Leonese nobles of the 11th and 12th Centuries, the head of the Banu Gómez line (also Beni Gómez or Vani-gómez; from Arabic, the sons of Gómez). He served the Kingdom of León for more than four decades (under King Alfonso VI then Queen Urraca) and helped rebuild the town of Valladolid.

Pedro was born in 1037, the son of Ansur Díaz, a well-positioned Leonese noble in the court of King Fernando I. The King had entrusted Ansur to train his son Alfonso in the art of war, so Alfonso spent time on Ansur's family land and developed a strong relationship with the nobleman and his children, especially Pedro.

The friendship strengthened over time and was rewarded. After the death of Pedro's uncle Gómez Díaz around 1059, Pedro's close personal relationship with the King cemented him at the head of the Banu Gómez, which enabled him to place and protect family members and build his wealth. Alfonso in 1065 became King of León, in 1067 granted Pedro Ansúrez the position of royal *mayordomo*—in charge of managing the royal patrimony, organizing court ceremony, and leading the royal household—and in 1068 made Pedro a count.

As a sign of Pedro Ansúrez's preeminence in the court, we know that over his lifetime he participated in 13 *curias*—the itinerant governing body of the Kingdom—comparable only to grand contemporaries such as the Bishops of León (15 *curias*) and Burgos (13 *curias*). No other noble seems to have participated in so many royal meetings or councils.

Such privileges in a feudal society had its requirements, the most important being fidelity to the King. In this Pedro Ansúrez did not disappoint. Count Pedro fought alongside Alfonso VI against the King's brother Sancho II of Castilla. After Sancho defeated Alfonso in the disastrous Battle of Golpejera in 1072, Pedro fled with his king into exile in the Muslim *taifa* of Toledo. From there,

Pedro continued his efforts on behalf of Alfonso's throne, apparently among the instigators of the revolt that same year against Sancho by the two claimant kings' sister Urraca at Zamora that resulted in Sancho's death and the Alfonso's return to power, this time as *Imperator totius Hispaniae*, that is, as King of Galicia, León, and Castilla.

For his fidelity, the Kingdom entrusted Pedro with several *tenencias*—Carrión in 1074, San Ramon de Entrepeñas y Saldaña in 1077, and Zamora y Toro in 1084. Alfonso, perhaps drawing on his own experience growing up under tutelage of Pedro's father, also gave Pedro custody of the King's daughter Urraca, engaged to Count Raymond of Burgundy but not of age to marry until 1095.

Pedro with his wife in this period began the project of repopulating the town of Valladolid, located in what in earlier generations had been an abandoned zone between Christians and Muslims. They designed and oversaw construction there of the Collegiate church of Santa María la Mayor, the church of Santa María la Antigua, a hospital, a bridge over the Pisuerga River, and a palace for themselves.

All this ruling and building overlapped in time with Count Pedro's participation in León's military campaigns, including that which culminated in the 1085 conquest of Toledo. Although Pedro does not appear among the recorded participants in the 1086 Battle of Sagrajas—other than Alfonso, we know who fell—he is thought at least to have joined in the immediately previous campaign and siege of Zaragoza. There also is evidence of his presence at the 1097 Battle of Consuegra, where El Cid's son Diego Rodríguez perished.

While popular romance presents Pedro as a staunch rival of the Cid, we have no such evidence. In fact, Pedro appears in 1074 as the guarantor of the *Carta de arras* granting wedding tokens (*arrhae*, unity coins) from Rodrigo to his bride Jimena.

Between 1102 and 1108, Pedro had to move his residence to the Catalan Counties of the east (probably at the cost of some of the *tenencias* in León) as guardian to his grandson, Armengol (Ermengol) VI, the new Count of Urgell. Armengol had inherited the County at age seven after the death of his father, husband of Pedro's daughter María Pérez. As regent, Pedro campaigned to conquer for Urgell the Muslim town of Balaguer near Lerida (Lleida) and negotiated alliances necessary to the the military effort's success. He allied Urgell with Count Ramon Berenguer III of Barcelona and with King Alfonso I of Aragón, becoming his vassal.

Pedro's new closeness to Aragón seemed to position him well. When Alfonso VI of León lost his son Sancho Alfónsez at the 1108 Battle of Uclés, he named his surviving child Urraca as his new heir. Perhaps with Pedro's advice, as a way to strengthen the Christian kingdoms against the Almoravid threat, Alfonso VI arranged Urraca's marriage to Aragón's Alfonso I. The wedding took place in 1109 at Pedro's castle Monzón de Campos, and Pedro sponsored the marriage.

But the union failed (for political, religious, and personal reasons) and conflict broke out between factions favorable to each monarch, Urraca or Alfonso I—a conflict lasting in its Galician aspect all the way to 1123. It was a hard setback: Pedro had bet heavily

on the union. His loyalty after the split went to Urraca; but, as Alfonso I's vassal, he saw his honor as compromised. Pedro visited Alfonso I, “dressed in scarlet, riding on a white horse, and with a rope in his hand, to inform him that, although he had put his corresponding lands in the hands of the Queen, he gave him his hands, mouth and body [for] death or torture.” The Aragonese monarch recognized the gesture, forgave the old noble, and let him go.

We know little of Pedro's later activities. His first wife Eylo Alfonso died around 1113. Donation documents record his second marriage in 1117 to Elvira Sánchez. He died September 9th, 1119.

Curias

León's *Curia Regia* was the court of the King and his *Concilium* (council) that saw to the realm's political and military direction, administered its territories, and granted privileges, donations, and confirmations. It comprised the King and royal family, the great nobles (those with title of Count or who possessed great domains), bishops, and those holding royal positions such as *alférez* or *mayordomo*. Alfonso VI's curias often met in large cities such as León, Burgos, or (later) Toledo. But the *Curia* was an itinerant body that traveled throughout the Kingdom to discuss issues in situ and its members varied by its purpose.

Alfonso VI held at least 30 curias, some Grand Curias gathering a larger *Concilium* or dealing with weightier issues. Queens Inés or Constanza took part in 10 of them, *Infantas* Urraca or Elvira (the King's sisters) in 13, the *mayordomo* in 15, and *alférez* in 18. Certain nobles would represent the León region, such as Count Pedro Ansúrez in 13 and Count Martín Alfónsez (represented in our game as a Vassal who can join Pedro's forces) in 10. Others appeared for Castilla, including García Ordóñez during his period as *alférez* and later as Count of Nájera; for Galicia; or for Asturias, such as Fernando Díaz (in the game, a Vassal who can join Álvar Fáñez's command). Finally, the ecclesiastical powers took part, such as Bishop of León Sebastian or Pedro at 15 of the curias. [AAJ]

García Ordóñez

Count of Nájera & Calahorra



If legend unfairly maligns any Christian character from the times depicted in *Almoravid*, it is undoubtedly García Ordóñez. García seems to have been the collateral victim of a marketing campaign 100 years after his lifetime—the romanticization of Rodrigo Díaz de Vivar that cast García as villain. Let us shed a little light on him as he stood at the forefront of the warlords of the day, spearheading military campaigns of the Christian kings' *Reconquista*, until his last breath for the Crown, guarding the heir to León at Uclés.

We have little direct information about García's actions in life, but his name and signature appear abundantly in both curia documents and royal appointments. García Ordóñez de Nájera (also known as de Cabra, el Crespo de Grañón, and Bocatorcida) was

the son of Count Ordoño Ordóñez (*Alférez* to King Fernando I of León in 1042) and Enderquinda. His paternal great-grandfather was Bermudo II, making García a second cousin to King Alfonso VI. His family was rooted in the north and northeast of Castilla, so, in the partition of the kingdom upon Fernando's death that made Sancho II King of Castilla, it joined that court, prominent aside Rodrigo. García served Sancho as Governor of Pancorbo 1067-1070.

Though not written, García's family must have taken part in the war that Sancho II started against his brothers and that ended in defeat of Alfonso VI at Golpejera. Sancho's assassination in 1072 momentarily cut García's career short. But Alfonso—now King of León, Castilla, and Galicia—understood that the stability of his realm called for integration of Castilian and Leonese nobles by giving them positions of trust. García Ordóñez took advantage of the opportunity and at once switched his loyalty to Alfonso. Gradually, he grew in power, as Ayo (in charge of educating the royal heir Sancho Alfónsez) in 1072, *Alférez* (royal standard bearer, see Christian Capability #C15) in 1074, and Count of Nájera by 1080—ruling over lands annexed from Pamplona. García around that time married Urraca Garcés, daughter of King García Sánchez III of Pamplona.

As Count of Nájera, García became one of only three counts of Castilian origin then in Alfonso's kingdom. From then, he appeared still in secondary positions as signatory in documents of the *Curia Regia*. Through service and the death of more senior counts, he climbed in status, receiving the *tenencias* of Calahorra (1085), Griñón (1089), and Madriz (1092). By 1100, García stood among the most prominent of counts, appearing in 63 royal documents and participating in nine royal curias, statistics surpassed only by Pedro Ansúrez.

Locally, García Ordóñez focused his rule on the repopulation of Logroño, with the intention of transferring there the preeminence that Nájera had enjoyed until then. In a sign of its success, Alfonso VI in 1095 granted the town the *Carta Puebla* or *Fuero de Logroño* (see Christian Capability #C20 FUEROS).

As we have seen in the case of Ansúrez, such stature would not be obtained by offers of loyalty alone, it required brandishing a sword for the King. García Ordóñez raised his military arm for Alfonso VI in the Battle of Cabra (1079), the Toledo campaign (1085), and Sagradas (1086). We have no direct evidence of García's presence at the latter defeat by the Almoravids; however, his brother was there, making García's participation highly likely.

This history manifests no enmity between Count García and Rodrigo as the *Cantar del mio Cid* depicts. (García signed the *arras* card of the Cid's marriage.) But two events we have yet to mention could have given pretext to introduce such a rivalry into the romance.

The first was the 1079 Battle of Cabra. This strange clash resulted from Alfonso VI sending Rodrigo and García each on armed delegations to collect the annual *parias*, one to Sevilla and the other to Granada. Abd Allah of Granada paid the tribute and—in an opportunistic attack on Sevilla—called upon the protection that García's Leonese troops then owed him. Unfortunately for Abd Allah, Rodrigo's delegation had reached Sevilla, and there

al-Mutamid likewise took advantage of Christian help. The result was a total defeat by Rodrigo and the Sevillans of Abd Allah's army, including of its Christian complement under García.

The second instance pitting García against the Cid occurred in 1092. Rodrigo, again in exile, was campaigning in Denia and Valencia with the help of al-Mustain of Zaragoza, preparing an assault on Valencia's capital city. Alfonso VI, who also had his sights set on Iberia's eastern coast, gathered an army and, in agreement with Aragón, Barcelona, and a fleet of ships from Genoa and Pisa (see Christian Event #C17), launched a campaign in Valencia and Tortosa. Rodrigo, then in Zaragoza, saw his objective in danger and attacked García's nearby lands of Calahorra and Nájera to force Alfonso to abort his campaign and take his army north to protect his vassal García.

Though these actions tempt us to imbue them with personal animus, they in fact responded to a system of alliances (for Cabra) and feudal duties (in the attack on Calahorra), the driving political forces of the *Reconquista* period.

Regardless, further command roles for García would follow at the *Reconquista* battles of Alcoraz (1096), Consuegra (1097), and Uclés. He met his death at the last, on the May 29th, 1108, protecting the King's heir Sancho Alfónsez, who had had his horse killed and became surrounded by Almoravid troops. Per the chronicles, García dismounted and interposed himself to guard the 15-year old—a brave but useless action, as both died, García first, shielding the boy's body with his own.

Álvar Fáñez King's Captain



Like García Ordóñez and others in the military panoply of León, Álvar Fáñez fell victim to the lionization of El Cid in the *Cantar*, demoted to second in excellence, the faithful squire and executing hand of the charismatic leader. Historical documents present Álvar as an intelligent, capable, and decisive man who shone with his own light. On the losing side of the fratricidal war between Sancho II and Alfonso VI, he won the trust of the new monarch and his court, even though he was not a high-ranking magnate. Never made a count himself, he nevertheless appears in 14 diplomas of the curia aside the great names of the Kingdom, obtained several *tenencias* and lordships, and married Mayor Pérez, daughter of the great Count Pedro Ansúrez.

Álvar's origins are cloudy. We believe he was born around 1047 but have nothing definitive about his ancestry. Legend asserts his kinship with Rodrigo Díaz de Vivar, and the *arras* document that Rodrigo gave his bride Jimena in 1074 appears to confirm that Álvar was Rodrigo's nephew.

Álvar, like Rodrigo and García Ordóñez, belonged to the Castilian side in the war that Sancho II started and initially won against his brothers Alfonso of León and García of Galicia. There is evidence of important actions by Álvar during this initial career, including a brave stand that prevented Alfonso's troops from crossing the Villarente Bridge near León.

Sancho's assassination in 1072 should have spelled the collapse of Álvaro's position, but the opposite happened. We know little of him until 1085, only that he took Medina del Campo in 1077. Somehow, Álvaro knew how to gain the King's trust, perhaps because Alfonso VI needed all the military force he could get. Álvaro emerged as the most important and trusted royal captain, spear of the King's will.

In the period of our game, Álvaro Fáñez held command in the campaign to gain Toledo, was appointed governor of Valencia—where some authors suggest he cemented the tributary and military levy structure that Rodrigo would later use there for his own purposes—and led a wing of the Christian army at the Battle of Sagradas. He went on in the late 1080s and 1090s to command forces at Aledo, in an expedition to punish Granada and Almería for supporting the Almoravids, at Almodóvar del Río (1091)—where he was wounded defending the *taifa* of Sevilla from the Almoravids—Consuegra, and, in 1108, Uclés.

After the fall of Sevilla to the Almoravids in 1091 and the death of Valencia's al-Qadir in 1092, Alfonso ordered Álvaro to center his military operations and administrative work in the region between Toledo, Guadalajara, and Cuenca that became known as “the lands of Álvaro Fáñez”. He appears as *tenente* (lord) of Zorita de los Canes in 1097 and *señor* and *dominus* of Zorita and Santaver. Later military threat to the city of Toledo focused Álvaro on its defense, and he begins to appear in documents as “Duke of Toledo” and “Prince of the Cavalry of Toledo”.

After Alfonso VI died, war for control of the Kingdom arose between Alfonso's daughter Urraca and Alfonso I of Aragón. Álvaro remained faithful to Urraca, regaining Cuenca for León from the Muslims in 1111 and Toledo from Alfonso I in 1113. His last action was in a fight in March 1114 for control of Segovia, which had rebelled against Urraca to the side of Alfonso I. There, Álvaro Fáñez died in combat aged about 65.

Sancho I

King of Aragón & Pamplona



King Sancho I Ramírez of Aragón (also King Sancho V of Pamplona, Antso Ramirez in Basque) was born between 1043 and 1045. His father Ramiro I of Aragón had ruled the lands of Ribagorza, Sobrarbe, and Aragón as a vassal of Pamplona and slowly garnered independence by exploiting the latter kingdom's growing weakness.

Young Sancho probably sensed his kingdom's vulnerability as a vassal shaking off a liege. A strong new Pamplonese king might appear and enforce his claim on Aragón. From the west, León or Castilla might take up the sword to reunify what Pamplona had held. From the east, the Catalan counties of Barcelona and Pallars competed with Aragón for expansion into the *taifa* of Zaragoza.

We can differentiate two periods of Sancho I's reign, each with clear objectives that marked the monarch's central policies and actions.

Solidification. First, the Aragonese sealed an alliance against the Catalans. Sancho and his father during 1061-1064 arranged Sancho's marriage to Isabel, daughter of Count Armengol III of Urgell, a county that lay to the other side of Pallars. Armengol at the same time married Sancho's sister.

Then, in 1064, Pope Alexander II called a crusade—the first of which we know—to wrest the city of Barbastro from Zaragoza's rule. (See Christian Event #C14 POPE GREGORY.) The call to arms attracted a mostly Frankish army from Poitou, Normandy, Champagne, and Italy. Count Armengol's forces joined in. Such power to summon crusaders made the Pope a tempting ally for the new King Sancho I, both for intended conquests of Muslim territory and to cement Aragón's independence within Iberia.

Sancho in 1068 traveled to Rome to meet the Pope and offer himself as vassal. Aragón instantly became the Papacy's ally and bastion in Iberia. As for any feudal vassal, there would be costs, in this case spiritual and earthly:

- Rome sought to implement its own ecclesiastical ritual across all Christian kingdoms as a seal of its dominion. Sancho in 1071 prevailed upon the Aragonese church to supplant the Mozarabic rite (of Visigothic origin) with the Roman liturgy.
- Aragón beginning in 1087 would owe its liege in Rome a tax of 500 gold coins annually. To pay, Sancho in 1085 or 1086 began to mint his own gold coin, the first King of Aragón to do so.



Gold coin from Sancho's Jaca, bearing the cross-and-staff heraldry of Aragón's early rulers.

Sancho next added to his allies by uniting his line with nobility beyond the Pyrenees. He repudiated his marriage to Isabel of Urgell and in 1070 or 1071 took another wife, Felicia de Roucy. In 1086, his heir Pedro (Isabel's son) married Inés of Aquitania (stepsister of the Queen of León).

Best of all, Sancho I in 1076 achieved annexation of much of Pamplona after the assassination on a hunt of its king, Sancho Garcés IV. Internal dispute over inheritance of the throne gave Alfonso VI an opening to claim several of its western lands for León. Pamplona's remaining nobles in response swore loyalty to Sancho. The next year, he consolidated his augmented realm by making Jaca, which lay along the pilgrims' way from France to Santiago in Galicia, the episcopal seat and his capital. Construction of a cathedral there would bring money and artisans into the city and develop Aragón's industry and mercantile economy.

Reconquista. From 1083, Aragón began a systematic conquest of Zaragoza territory, its natural target for expansion. Zaragoza had been among the most powerful Muslim *taifas*, encompassing the regions of Zaragoza, Lérida, Tortosa, and Denia. But the death of al-Muqtadir in 1081 led to partition of his *taifa*, Zaragoza in its west to his son al-Mutamin and its east to al-Mundir. Sancho exploited the resulting dispute between the brothers, siding with al-Mundir of Lérida. Aragón shaved off Graus and Ayerbe from Zaragoza in 1083 and Naval and Arguedas in 1084. (It would

have gained more, were it not for the service from 1081 of the exiled Rodrigo Díaz de Vivar on Zaragoza's behalf.)

The advent of the Almoravids in 1086 offered Sancho a double opportunity: Sultan Yusuf posed a threat to León above all, forcing Alfonso's recall of Rodrigo from Zaragoza's defense. Alfonso acquiesced in Aragonese expansion in eastern Iberia, in exchange for help in Leonese campaigns against the Almoravids (Sagrajas in 1086 and Toledo in 1090), while Zaragoza lost its military ace in the hole. Aragón's conquest of Estad in 1087 and Monzón in 1089 resulted.

Rodrigo, exiled again from 1088, began operating independently in Valencia and Denia. Sancho, taking advantage of the Almoravids' continuous attempts to conquer the area, in 1090 sealed a non-aggression pact with the Cid. Rodrigo, who had maintained his good relations with Zaragoza, would no longer stand in the way of Aragonese predation. Sancho gained the fortification of Castellar (adjacent to Zaragoza) in 1091 and Almenar in Lérida in 1093.

In early 1094, Aragón prepared for siege of the key and well-defended fortress city of Huesca. The fighting to take it finally cost Sancho I his life, on June 4th, 1094. His eldest son, by Isabel, became King Pedro I of Aragón. And when Pedro died in 1104, another son of Sancho I, this one by Felicia de Roucy, Alfonso I "the Battler", would rule Aragón until 1134, when his brother Ramiro II would succeed him.

Eudes I

Duke of Burgundy



Eudes I, or Odo, nicknamed "the Red", was a lesser character in the story of Alfonso VI's campaigns against the *taifas* and the Almoravids. Eudes's appearance on the Iberian Peninsula did not itself yield any Christian military advantage. Rather, it represented the heightening of Cluny monastic and Gregorian papal influences in Hispania, opening the doors of the Christian kingdoms to foreign dynasties.

Eudes was born in 1058, second son of Duke Henry of Burgundy and thus outside the line of succession and condemned to seek his own fortune, such as by renting his sword. But fate smiled on him: his older brother Hugh I after two years of rule abdicated (some sources say after battle wounds) to become a monk of Cluny, where he would end up as Prior.

Eudes seems to have done everything possible to earn the nickname Red, as the chronicles describe him as violent and brutal, a brigand *qui rançonnait ceux qui traversaient ses états* (who demanded ransom from those who crossed his lands). It may have been this aggression that spurred him to the two expeditions that would mark his life.

The first answered a request for help from Alfonso VI after the 1086 defeat at Sagrajas. The King of León under threat had played the Cluny card: both he and his father Fernando I had long paid tributes to Cluny in the hope that, when the need came, they could in effect call a crusade. The call to arms also offered Alfonso the opportunity to reinforce alliances beyond the Pyrenees, just as

Aragón was doing. (León's Queen Constanza was the daughter of Eudes's grandfather, Richard I of Burgundy.)

In response, Eudes and other Frankish nobles and followers of Cluny traveled to the Peninsula with a crusader spirit, bent on finishing off the Muslims. After gathering arms and supplies and marching across the Pyrenees, they finally arrived in the spring of 1087. Yusuf after Sagrajas had already long retired to Africa. The threat receded, Alfonso saw that it would not do to have an idle army along his border, so went to meet the crusaders to suggest they take the Muslim fortress of Tudela.

Although the attack was an abysmal failure militarily, it succeeded diplomatically in weaving stronger alliances. Alfonso's daughter Urraca wed Raymond, fourth son of William I of Burgundy. The couple would become the parents of the future King Alfonso VII of León and Castilla.

After his failed campaign, Eudes decided in 1101 to embark on crusade to the Holy Land. He never reached it, dying en route through Asia Minor, at Tarsus, Cilicia, in 1102.

El Cid

Rodrigo

El Cid Campeador



Rodrigo Díaz de Vivar comes to us as the exalted border lord and pious Christian warrior out of a need during the 12th and 13th Centuries to attract *infanzones* (low-ranking nobles) to Reconquest and in more recent periods to idealize Castilla in the political framework of the Peninsula. His fame may be deserved, but we must wash away layers of legend to see his real role in the time of Almoravids.

Origin and Service to Sancho. Studies clarify the Rodrigo of myth, the Castilian frontier *infanzón* who rose through sheer cunning and military skill. We now know that his genealogical tree rooted at the center of Leonese power—a contrast that sheds light on his later ability to gather such a powerful *mesnada* (household troops). Rodrigo's mid-10th-Century great-grandfather Munio Flaínez, grandfather Flaín Muñoz, and uncle Fernando Flaínez II all appear as counts in León's royal court. The latter held the office of Governor of León. But when he prohibited the newly made King Fernando I from entering the capital for a year, as revenge for the death of the Governor's old lord, the monarch dispersed the Flaínez family to the border and, after a Flaínez son (Rodrigo's cousin) rebelled, seized the family's inheritance.

Our scant information suggests that Rodrigo, born about 1048, began his career in the entourage of the future Sancho II of Castilla and fought with him at the Battle of Graus (1063), with the troops of al-Muqtadir defeating the Aragonese. Loyal service to the *Infante* Sancho made Rodrigo into a great king's captain. He championed Sancho in duels and proved his military skills in the Battles of Llantada (1068) and Golpejera (1072) that gave King Sancho II control of the Three Kingdoms and probably in siege operations at Zamora where an assassin killed the King.

Service to Alfonso and First Exile. Rodrigo's fame as a warrior saw him into the new King's court, as Alfonso VI promoted Castilians and Leonese to stabilize his reunified kingdom. Rodrigo served as a judge or procurator and in 1074 married Jimena Díaz, who some believe to have been a cousin of King.

Rodrigo in 1079 took part in *parias* collection from Sevilla that led to the Battle of Cabra in which he defeated Granada's Christian troops under Castilian Count García Ordóñez (see the earlier section on García). Some say that Rodrigo's victory humiliated García personally, but that seems unlikely, since the fighting fell within the vassalage called for under *parias*—it was business.

But in 1081 Rodrigo showed not only how great a warlord and strategist he could be but also how impulsive and prone to act independently—characteristics that could at once derail the King's long-term strategy and earn Rodrigo enemies at court. Claiming illness, he failed to answer his King's levy to join a campaign into Muslim territory. While the King campaigned and Rodrigo stayed home, a Muslim *al-garada* (raid) sacked the great Castle of Gormaz. Rodrigo assembled his *mesnada* and pursued the Muslim raiders into their homelands of Toledo and there he carried out a retaliatory *cabalgada*—devastating lands and villages and taking a wealth of goods and captives as loot.

Rodrigo's initiative blew up in his face. Toledo had paid *parias* and so was under León's protection. The transgression added to rival magnates' complaints about Rodrigo as an uncontrolled upstart from a rebellious lineage. Alfonso had to act and exiled Rodrigo (though apparently without confiscating his land). Rodrigo left with those of his *mesnada* vassals obligated to follow. Jimena either accompanied him or moved to Asturias.

Now a roving captain-lord, Rodrigo would have to earn his followers' keep by renting out his lances, as many Christian knights and Muslim warriors had done. Rodrigo first sought a Christian employer. But either a lack of need or a fear of reprisal from Alfonso VI denied Rodrigo stable work with any Christian court. (Berenguer Ramon II of Barcelona was among those who declined.)

Rodrigo next tried his luck in Zaragoza, then besieged on several fronts—by Aragón, Lerida, and Barcelona—and that paid off. In the service of al-Mutamin and then from 1085 al-Mustain II, Rodrigo found a refuge and reliable source of resources to build his forces. There also he learned the Muslim art of war and incorporated it into his campaigns (see Capabilities #C25 EL CID and #C26 AL-FARAJ) and built direct contacts across the Peninsula's Muslim east. Rodrigo in this period became known by the Arabic appellation *al-Sayyid*—El Cid. Commanding the *taifa's* army, Rodrigo won clashes at Almenar against Barcelona and Lérida (1082) and Morella against Lérida and Aragón (1084), among others.

We do not know if Rodrigo remained in al-Mustain's service by the time of Alfonso's 1086 siege of Zaragoza city that preceded the Sagrajas campaign. El Cid may well have been among the besieged: there is nothing to indicate otherwise. If so, he came close to a line that in the event he never did cross: raising his arm directly against his lord and King (not just his vassals).

Reconciliation and Second Exile. After Alfonso's defeat at Sagrajas, he called Rodrigo back to defend the Kingdom. Sent in early 1087 to protect Valencia's al-Qadir, Rodrigo took up the position that Álvaro Fáñez had built there (see the earlier section on Álvaro). Rodrigo took charge not only of disrupting attacks from al-Mustain, al-Mundir, or Berenguer Ramon but also of collecting tributes and launching *cabalgadas* into neighboring *taifas*.

But new strife with Alfonso bubbled up in 1089. Rodrigo on a campaign to relieve Aledo Castle of an Almoravid-Andalusian siege had again ignored his King's orders and acted on his own initiative. The consequences for the upstart could have been worse had not the Almoravids withdrawn without fighting. Alfonso, probably beset with complaints from his high nobles, exiled Rodrigo again and this time went further to expropriate his lands and imprison his wife Jimena and their three children.

A Seat of His Own. Rodrigo now saw that he needed a realm of his own for the income to pay his soldiers and survive. Pressure from the growing Almoravid empire was weakening León's grip on its protectorate of Valencia, so El Cid focused his gaze there. In *cabalgadas* and battle, Rodrigo backed by al-Mustain in 1091 again bested al-Mundir and Berenguer Ramon. Rodrigo thereby established as the only local guarantor of protection won *parias* from Valencia as well as Albarracín and Alpuente.

Alfonso the next year sought to regain his Valencian protectorate through a counterattack with Sancho I of Aragón, Berenguer Ramon, and a Genoese-Pisan fleet. But the Cid preempted the scheme by raiding Nájera and Calahorra, diverting Alfonso to their defense. The targeted estates belonged to García Ordóñez, but again the matter appears business rather than personal, merely the closest Castilian lands of one of the King's most important vassals.

During Rodrigo's devastation of the Castilian Rioja, Valencia fell through revolt into the Almoravids' orbit. El Cid responded by allying with Aragón and besieging the great city from 1093. The siege lasted over a year and involved the total depredation of surrounding settlements and sale of their inhabitants into slavery. After complicated negotiations, the Valencians with no way out handed their city over to Rodrigo in June 1094. El Cid in the first years of rule there lived outside its gates and governed it by Islamic law.

The Almoravids immediately attempted to recover the city to Muslim rule, but the Cid defeated them in the Battle of Cuarte—a rare victory for Christian arms against the Africans. Jimena and the children rejoined Rodrigo at this time, possibly a gesture from Alfonso VI in recognition of Rodrigo as a cork in the Almoravid bottle. More Almoravid attempts on the city would follow, and Rodrigo would thwart them all on the battlefield. But Rodrigo would lose his firstborn, Diego Rodríguez, sent to support Alfonso's army, at the Battle of Consuegra in 1097.

Rodrigo's last action would be the siege and conquest of Murviedro on his north flank in 1098. He died in Valencia of natural causes in 1099, leaving Jimena to rule a domain with more or less stable borders. She would defend them against Almoravid challenge until 1102, when Alfonso asked her to leave Valencia so that he would not need to allocate more resources to its defense.

Campaign History

by Albert Alegre Jove

Here we provide, in fuller political context, the historical course of the military-operational campaigns depicted in the game's scenarios.

Toledo Beset

Spring 1085. The situation for al-Qadir, Emir of the *taifa* of Toledo, was unsustainable. His payment for the aid received from King Alfonso VI of León to recover the throne of Toledo a few years earlier—cession of several castles and the payment of *parias* tribute—had revived internal opposition to his mandate. Above all, because this *parias* payment to a Christian king did not come out of the royal purse but rather fell through higher taxes on the inhabitants of Toledo, his subjects had to bear not only financial pressure but also the ignominy of seeing this money sent directly to the coffers of an Infidel—an act prohibited by Islamic laws. This popular unrest in Toledo spurred the factions opposed to al-Qadir to seek external allies to dethrone their puppet emir.

The rebels in Toledo drew hope from a newly forged alliance between the neighboring *taifa* kingdoms of Zaragoza and Valencia via the union of the son of al-Mutamin, Emir of Zaragoza, with the daughter of Abu Bakr, Emir of Valencia. These dynasties' probable objective was to join forces and stop the bleeding of Muslim territory—until recently, stanching only by the mercenary services of the Castilian exile El Cid—from constant attacks out of the Christian Kingdom of Aragón and the Muslim *taifa* of Lérida, each in collaboration with the Christian County of Barcelona, fighting in return for *parias* from Lérida.

The military strength that this marriage alliance would provide signalled the will of Zaragoza and Valencia to decline to pay any more *parias*—and probably to do so even without al-Mutamin's continued employment of the Cid.

Sources diverge on what happened next.

In one version of events, al-Qadir's opponents asked the emirs of Zaragoza and Sevilla to intervene, and they launched an attack on Toledo from the east and south. Al-Qadir, seeing that his position was already unrecoverable, decided to seek a deal with Alfonso VI on the handover of his *taifa* to the Christian king.

Other versions give greater weight to the siege of Toledo city which Alfonso VI joined in person to pursue in earnest in March 1085. The siege granted al-Qadir a last attempt at resistance by asking for help from the rest of the *taifas*, but they did not answer. It seems that Valencia's Abu Bakr fell ill while the southern *taifas* remained as yet unprepared to confront Alfonso. The absence of any Muslim relief army forced al-Qadir after many weeks of siege to capitulate, surrender his capital city, and with it his entire territory.

Whichever was the case, al-Qadir and Alfonso seem to have sealed surrender terms on May 6th. Finally, on May 25th, 1085, over 300 years after the Arab conquest of Iberia's Visigothic kingdom, Christian Leonese troops with their king Alfonso VI enter the Visigoths' ancient capital of Toledo.

Quelling of the Tajo

Summer 1085. During the summer that followed his historic conquest of Toledo, Alfonso VI had to face two different challenges, one of a civil nature and the other of a more military nature.

The first was to consolidate control of the city of Toledo without causing the uprising of its non-Christian majority population (Muslim *Mudéjares* and Jews) as well as keep the rites of the Christian *Mozárabes* (Moorish Christians). Alfonso's policy had the potential to set the future of Christian expansion, since that expansion from then on would aim toward the Muslim territories with the largest urban populations. (Most Muslim cities were much larger than the capital of any Christian kingdom on the peninsula.) These areas had been under Muslim rule for a longer time than the northern extremes reconquered so far, so coexistence was a prevailing need, at least until the military situation allowed otherwise. (The Christian kingdoms' populations were not yet large enough simply apply force everywhere.)

Due to this need for coexistence, the conditions for the city's surrender sought to express benevolence to Muslim and Jewish citizens. The terms guaranteed protection of their communities, their possessions, and their freedom of worship. What is more, Toledo's largest mosque remained in Muslim hands. Finally, Alfonso VI installed as mayor of the city Sisnando Davídez de Coimbra, a *Mozárabe* with great diplomatic experience and knowledge of *taifa* politics, having served in the courts of Sevilla and Coimbra.

The second focus of Alfonso's attention was the consolidation of the rest of the Toledo *taifa*'s territory. At the time of al-Qadir's surrender, he already had possessed minimal effective control beyond the walls of his city, both because of the prolonged Christian siege and because much of the outlying population had rebelled against him. This lack of political control of the former emirate made the military consolidation of the *de jure* capitulation a necessary step.

During the summer, numerous expeditions sought to secure the maximum possible territory throughout the former *taifa*. Alfonso already had gained control of some areas previously as payment for his support to al-Qadir in the recovery of Toledo from Badajoz or in preparation for the siege of the capital. And, upon Toledo's surrender, most of the Tajo valley area capitulated without any extra action. But, towards the south, military expeditions proved necessary.

All these actions won the Leonese *de facto* control south across the Tajo to Albacete. However, the south-central area around the great fortress of Calatrava fell into the hands of Sevilla's al-Mutamid, who annexed it when, according to some sources, rebels against al-Qadir asked the *taifas* for help.

While all this was happening in Toledo's north and south, the de-throned al-Qadir relocated to its eastern city of Cuenca. Alfonso had allowed al-Qadir to retain this possession until able to conquer the nearby Emirate of Valencia—again with Alfonso's help. So specified terms of the signed agreement for the capitulation of Toledo: al-Qadir was to become a puppet king again, this time with his seat in Valencia.

Alfonso VI knew that al-Qadir had supporters in Valencia *taifa* and wished to use that fact to expand his gains, again at the expense of the Muslims.

And it seemed that fate was on their side, as untimely deaths would disrupt the marriage alliance of Valencia and Zaragoza. On June 4, Abu Bakr of Valencia died after several months of convalescence, leaving the Emirate in the hands of his son Uthman. Abu Bakr's ally al-Mutamin of Zaragoza soon afterwards would follow him to the grave, leaving this important realm in the hands of his son al-Mustain II, husband to Abu Bakr's daughter and so Uthman's brother-in-law. But Uthman would prove unable to resist Alfonso and al-Qadir's advances on Valencia.

Curias and Winter

Autumn 1085. Alfonso VI's taking of Toledo and conquest of its maximum possible territory had required a much greater war effort than raising just the troops under the King's direct command. The campaign had required the call of contingents of Counts and lesser nobles from all over his kingdom (León, Castilla, and Galicia) as well as troops of the Archbishops of Santiago, Ourense, and Burgos and troops from Coimbra. To all these were added contingents of Franks, thanks to Alfonso's wife Constanza of Burgundy, daughter of the deceased Duke Robert I of Burgundy and niece of the powerful abbot of Cluny, to which Alfonso VI (just like his father Fernando I) had given large sums of money.

This "service" by the great nobles and powerful characters of the time, as in all other campaigns, had to be paid with the delivery of new lands, castles, or money. These expeditions had to be lucrative enough to the participants now to guarantee their support and rendering of such resources to the king in future campaigns that the monarch might like to carry out.

Alfonso typically could delegate to scribes and trusted individuals the administration of such awards; in this case, however, he may have dictated them personally, both because the profits were huge and because it was critical to maintain a perfect balance. Any misstep in dispensing possessions on the Toledan plains to the counts and nobles eager to collect their share of loot could jeopardize not only what the Kingdom had won so far but also future campaigns that Alfonso already had in mind. For this reason, it was probably not until September 1085, once the structure of the new province was fully charted or at least the foundations laid, that Alfonso could return to his royal seat at León for the usual business of reigning via curias, periodic assemblies of nobles, priests, and other notables.

In this regard, the King's return home responded not only to the custom of freezing any major action of war for the winter but also to the need at this momentous juncture to convene a Great Curia, the governing body of the Kingdom entire.

Winter 1085/1086. The Great Curia probably held at León in or about February 1086 served to confirm the agreements signed with the nobles in Toledo for the handover of land, castles, and other possessions. In addition, it appointed both a new Bishop of León, Sebastián, and an Archbishop for the newly conquered Toledo, the Cluniac monk Bernard de Sédillac.

As we saw, the *taifas* of Valencia and Zaragoza had in early 1085 sealed an agreement through a wedding, with the idea of strengthening their position against aggression from the Christians of León, Aragón, and Barcelona (as well as against another *taifa*, Lérida). As a next step, Zaragoza and Valencia had declined to keep paying *parias* to León. The collection of such gold dinars in *parias* was the main source of resources for Alfonso's war effort and, internally, to keep his nobles under control. Valencia and Zaragoza's act of defiance meant that substantial sums would cease to enter León's treasury.

So, it was agreed at the Curia that action against the upstart *taifas* would be necessary. In the case of Zaragoza, the Curia decided to make a punitive expedition in 1086, in which the *taifa's* countryside would be razed and the capital besieged—probably not with the intention of taking the city but rather to press the Emirate to return to payment of *parias*.

The *taifa* of Valencia required another type of action. As we have seen, part of al-Qadir's surrender agreement at Toledo was that he would receive the support of Alfonso VI to seize power over the *taifa* of Valencia and then agree to pay *parias* to León. Abu Bakr, Emir of Valencia, had died during the summer of 1085 and been succeeded by his son Uthman. This succession was not as peaceful as expected, and two opposing factions emerged within the city. One faction backed al-Qadir and his accommodation with the Christians. The other faction instead sought to hand over control of Valencia to Uthman's brother-in-law, al-Mustain II, ruler of Zaragoza. The great city of Valencia was ripe to fall to the first military force to gather in front of its walls.

The Great Curia therefore decided that Álvaro Fáñez at the head of a *mesnada* (household troops) would escort al-Qadir to Valencia in the spring to claim the city. In this way, the planned attack into Zaragoza also would serve as a way to block its influence over Valencia and thereby allow al-Qadir to take the city without problems.

Finally, the new position of power that Alfonso's conquest of Toledo had given the Christians persuaded the King to put more pressure on the southern *taifas*. The Curia decided to send several expeditions and ambassadors into Sevilla, Granada, and Almería in an attempt—through intimidation of these emirs and placement of Christian "advisers" in their palaces—to tighten León's political control over them and thereby force continued *parias* payments.

Parias Wars

Spring 1086. With the arrival of good weather at the end of February or beginning of March, all these actions agreed during February's Great Curia in León commenced.

Alfonso VI led an army toward the Emirate of Zaragoza. He probably arrived near the capital city in mid-March and encamped on its outskirts, not only to besiege the city but also to loot the nearby towns.

Some sources say that Sancho Ramírez, ruler of Aragón north of Zaragoza's plain, either participated in Alfonso's siege or, having earlier put the city under siege, had decided before the arrival of

the Leonese troops to raise it. Other sources have King Sancho at that time instead besieging Tortosa.

What of El Cid, so recently in Zaragoza's employ? Did Rodrigo defend Zaragoza against his estranged king, Alfonso? It is difficult to answer this question since there is no clear record.

Some sources say that, after the marriage between the children of Abu Bakr and al-Mutamin in summer 1085, the latter decided to dispense with the Cid's services (implying that Rodrigo remained too close to or even had represented Alfonso VI in the *taifa*). El Cid's service to al-Mutamin had been vital to thwart several offensives against the Emirate, and the threat from Aragón, Barcelona, and Lérida remained. So, for the young Emir al-Mustain II to get rid of his best asset entirely cannot have been an attractive option.

The absence of reports of raids by El Cid during this time may be the best clue to this question. Rodrigo led a *mesnada* that had to be fed and paid. Had the Cid not served a lord who would provide such food, he would have had to achieve the maintenance of his troops by other means. It therefore seems likely that al-Mustain at least kept Rodrigo on a retainer.

Moreover, Rodrigo might well have been aware that the likely object of Alfonso's siege was merely to intimidate al-Mustain into resuming *parias*, not to conquer the city. Even had Alfonso's siege continued long enough to break the Zaragozans' resistance (rather than lifted later in the year as the Almoravids arrived to pose a dire threat to León), El Cid's presence among the defenders would not have forced the captain come to blows with his true king.

That spring, to the south of Zaragoza, Álvaro Fáñez with a substantial Christian force escorted al-Qadir to the gates of Valencia and managed to obtain the city's surrender without need of an assault. Al-Qadir became Valencia's new emir. But not all of the *taifa* surrendered immediately: al-Qadir had to besiege the important town of Játiva, whose governor not only rebelled against the newly installed ruler but also called to al-Mundir of nearby Lérida for help.

As well, the Christians launched offensive actions all along their new frontier south of Toledo. A noble named García Jiménez seized and fortified the castle of Aledo in the southeast, a small but key Muslim stronghold connecting the *taifa* capital of Sevilla to its possession of Murcia (see Christian Capability #C24). *Cabalgadas* (long-range raids) sought to ravage the territories of Córdoba, Granada, and Almería. The offensive aimed to demonstrate to the *taifa* lords the Christians' new position of total superiority and that the most sensible thing to do would simply be to agree to pay *parias* to León.

And, indeed, Alfonso VI's staged show of strength worked ... all too well. The remaining dynasts of the lost Caliphate of *al-Andalus* at last could see that they stood totally at the mercy of the Christian King. Knowing that their populaces would not forgive a surrender to the Christians, several of the *taifa* lords joined in the decision to appeal for help to a Muslim ally whom they had cultivated for some time and had themselves supported by sending ships to help take the key North African port of Ceuta. Yusuf ibn Tashufin, Sultan *al-Murabitun*, accordingly began to prepare his army's landing on the Peninsula.

Summer 1086. As spring turned to summer, it seems that al-Qadir felt strong enough after the departure of his Christian military escort to break his word and refuse to pay *parias* to Alfonso. But al-Qadir soon would realize the precariousness of his position. Alfonso had taken Valencia's deposed emir Uthman under his protection as a deterrent to al-Qadir: Alfonso could always return Uthman to the throne in al-Qadir's place. Moreover, al-Qadir not only proved unable to advance his siege of Játiva but also had to lift it entirely, as al-Mundir's force out of Lérida responded to the governor of Játiva's appeal, invaded Valencia, and marched to besiege al-Qadir's new capital.

Consequently, al-Qadir again had to ask for Alfonso's help. And that service again would fall to Álvaro Fáñez, who set out in command of a relief force to lift the siege of Valencia. In that he succeeded easily, as the besieging Muslim army avoided a battle and withdrew before Álvaro's troops arrived. But Fáñez did not stop there: he chased the invaders northeastward into al-Mundir's *taifa* and devastated his possession of Burriana. After this campaign of retribution, Álvaro Fáñez returned to Valencia and stayed as its garrison to ensure its stability (and Christian control of al-Qadir).

Arrival of the Africans

While all this was happening in the east, the south of the Peninsula was abuzz with logistical activity, as Yusuf ibn Tashufin disembarked at Algeciras on July 30 (or possibly beginning on June 30). While Yusuf organized his force in Algeciras (perhaps 1,500 or more Berber horsemen and some 5,000 infantry), he sent calls to all the *taifa* kingdoms to join him in a campaign against the Christian aggressors and to assemble for that purpose in Sevilla in the coming weeks. Leaving his own garrison in Algeciras—his entry and exit route from the Peninsula—Yusuf set off for al-Mutamid's Sevilla in command of his Almoravid host of African troops.

News of this landing probably reached Alfonso's ears in mid-August, with the King still in midst of his siege of Zaragoza. Alfonso decided to lift the siege and start marching towards Toledo, as he believed that the Almoravids' main objective was the recently conquered *taifa* capital city. The new threat forced Alfonso to release the exhausted forces that had served in front of Zaragoza since March and levy new contingents from his nobles throughout León, Castilla, and Galicia. The King ordered some of them to Toledo and the rest to wait until he had more information on the enemy's movements. At the same time, he ordered a gathering of supply in Toledo for the coming campaign. Finally, he also sent notice to Álvaro Fáñez to leave Valencia and join him in Toledo, and he requested reinforcement from the Kingdom of Aragón. Alfonso himself would arrive in Toledo toward the end of September.

Meanwhile, across Spain, Yusuf arrived at Sevilla where he was received by al-Mutamid. During his stay in Sevilla, the Sultan received answers to his call from the *taifas* of Badajoz, Granada, Málaga, and Almería that, depending on their varied capacities and enthusiasm, would send either substantial or minimal contingents to support the campaign. Zaragoza and Lérida—unsure of Yusuf's intentions and not party to the *taifas'* appeal for his help—did not answer his summons to Sevilla, and neither did Alfonso's puppet Valencia.

Autumn 1086. From Yusuf's arrival in Sevilla until his departure, near the end of September, the Muslims settled their campaign plan. They decided not to go to Toledo (knowing that the city's defenses would prohibit a rapid assault) but rather to attract Alfonso to Muslim territory so as to stretch his supply lines and then to provoke him into a pitched battle. To that effect, they would march north-west toward Badajoz, staying west of Toledo, and lead Alfonso to believe that the combined Almoravid-Andalusian army's objective was the Christian-held town of Coria not far north of the border between al-Mutawakkil's Badajoz Emirate and León.

As well during September, Yusuf saw his army reinforced with the troops that arrived from Murcia (the eastern part of al-Mutamid's expansive *taifa*) and Almería. Once the recent arrivals were integrated with the troops from Sevilla, the army began its march toward Badajoz.

During the journey from the first emirati capital to the second, the *taifa* troops of Granada under command of their emir Abd Allah joined Yusuf, while a portion of those of Badajoz met and escorted the swelling host to al-Mutawakkil's city.

At this time, between the end of September and the beginning of October, Alfonso at Toledo may have gotten a better image of the impressive force that the Muslims were gathering and that its immediate destination did not seem to be Toledo but rather Coria, as reports of the march of the Muslim army towards Badajoz would have implied.

Taking advantage of this fact, Alfonso ordered that the levies mustered in the Kingdom's outer regions of Portugal and Galicia, should march to Coria, where he and the rest of the royal army also would go. Orders also went out to set up a supply depot in Coria and strengthen garrisons in the area. The march out of Toledo City toward the west would be shielded by the Tajo River and through friendly territory, allowing the main Christian force to forage reliably and avoid harassment of its long march column.

At some unclear point before Alfonso's departure from Toledo, a final seizure of Toledo City from the Muslims took place. Depending on the source, either the Cluniac faction led by Alfonso's Queen and Toledo Archbishop Bernard de Sédillac initiated the action without the King's knowledge, or a plan set during a curia in Toledo had the approval of the King from its outset and merely used as a covering excuse the idea that the Queen and her relatives were behind it.

Whichever the case, the moment seemed propitious to reverse the soft policy toward the Muslim citizenry (*mudéjares*) that seemed to have been unsuccessful. Muslims with resources had left Toledo as refugees to await recapture of the city by Islamic forces. Now, the threat of the Almoravid landing required a signal from the Leonese that would galvanize the Christians' will to fight. It came with the taking of Toledo's Great Mosque—in betrayal of the city's surrender agreement that guaranteed it for the *mudéjares*—and the announcement of its planned consecration to Santa Maria as the Cathedral of Toledo.

Its political and logistical bases secured behind it, the Christian army gathered in Coria and from there advanced southward, entering the territory of the *taifa* of Badajoz, as Alfonso sought to keep the initiative and defeat the enemy in their own lands.

Meanwhile, the Muslim army rested near Badajoz, aware of Alfonso's advance. Yusuf decided to press just a little to the north, onto suitable terrain for his mode of war. There on a plain his army camped, awaiting the Christians' arrival. At last, on the 22nd of October, the two hosts faced off, just a few miles apart. The next day, the great Battle of Sagrajas (Zalaca or Zalaqa in Arabic) resulted in the defeat of Alfonso's army. (For details on this historic battle, see "Battle of Sagrajas Minigame" below.)

After the battlefield defeat, Alfonso withdrew to Coria, retreating through enemy territory without suffering any other attacks. After gathering surviving forces and preparing Coria's defenses, he returned to Toledo in anticipation that it might be the next place that Yusuf would attack. Once there, he organized the defense of the city and province's territory as a whole.

But Yusuf's forces after the battle retired on Badajoz and from there returned to Sevilla. This reverse movement may have been because the Christian defeat seemed less than total and because the time of year, at the gates of winter, argued against initiating an offensive military campaign.

Once in Sevilla, however, Yusuf wasted no time in profiting politically from his battlefield victory and the admiration that it won him. To impress the Muslim populace with his victory, the Almoravids carted severed heads of the Christian fallen across *al-Andalus*. Before the three most important of the *taifa* kings (the rulers of Sevilla, Granada, and Badajoz), Yusuf proclaimed himself Defender of the Faith and Commander of the Muslims (*Emir al-Muslimin*). And Alfonso VI's defeat at Zalaqa had another major impact: not one of the *taifa* kingdoms would now pay him the *parias*.

Winter 1086/1087. At year's end, the Kingdom of León held another Grand Curia, this time in Toledo. Along with important religious issues such as the formal consecration of Bernard of Toledo and of the new Cathedral, appropriate provisions were made for the protection of the city and of the Kingdom, among which would be to request the support of the Franks from beyond the Pyrenees.

Another crucial moment of this Curia could have been that of the reconciliation of Alfonso VI with Rodrigo Díaz de Vivar. The King called an end to El Cid's exile and granted him Castilla's border fortress of San Esteban de Gormaz y Dueñas.

It was at year end of 1086 also that Yusuf ibn Tashufin left for Morocco. Rebellion had erupted in his domain, and his son had been killed. Behind him he left a sizable contingent of cavalry so as not to give up an Almoravid presence in Andalusian territory broadly and to maintain control of his port bastion of Algeciras in particular.

The beginning of 1087 saw a response by the Franks—the formation of a powerful host by Duke Eudes I of Burgundy and Guillaume le Charpentier, Viscount of Melun. Upon the arrival of this news, Alfonso VI already knew that Yusuf had departed for Africa. He decided to adopt a less belligerent posture toward the Peninsula's Muslim population and so repositioned northward and invited the Burgundians and French to direct their efforts against Zaragoza's northern fortress of Tudela, far from Toledo

and from León's southern frontier. This Eudes and his army did, besieging Tudela to little effect before returning home.

The two years of heavy campaigning from one corner of *al-Andalus* to another had seen a jumpstart to the Christian *Reconquista* followed by quick reversal to Muslim counteroffensive. Yusuf and his Almoravids would return in 1088 to answer the *taifas*' call a second time, this time in an attempt to recover the castle of Aledo, only to find an environment of mistrust among *taifas* bad enough to prevent a successful siege. This failure made clear to Yusuf he would first have to conquer the unready *taifas* before launching any general *jiḥād* on León or Aragón. Though checked, Alfonso would retain the prize of Toledo—the base for future Christian kings to drive ever deeper into Muslim Spain.

Battle of Sagrajas Minigame

Here we recount in game terms the campaign maneuvers that led to the climactic clash between Alfonso and the Almoravids as well as the course of the battle itself on 23 October 1086 that resulted in a severe defeat for the Christians. Then we recreate the historical massed battle as a brief and self-contained competitive game—for either two players or one person playing both sides—a great way to learn how an Almoravid Battle works before having to risk combat in a full scenario!

The Historical Campaign and Battle

Levy, March, and Approach. In the late Autumn of 1086, Sultan Yusuf's joined Almoravid-*taifa* army stood massed and ready at Badajoz with the Muslim Lords Sir, al-Mutamid, al-Mutawakkil, and Abd Allah. From there, with León's main forces still at Toledo, the Muslims threatened the Christian town of Coria or to advance into Toledo's territory to ravage or conquer there.

King Alfonso VI at Toledo had consolidated his political and therefore logistical control of the city, symbolized by the conversion of its great mosque into a Cathedral. There as well he had levied new contingents from across his kingdom, recalled his captain Álvaro Fáñez from occupation of Valencia, and bade King Sancho I of Aragón to send help. Most likely, Counts Pedro Ansúrez and García Ordóñez would have joined the King at Toledo, while with a partial commitment of Aragonese forces arrived, probably led by Sancho's son Pedro. French crusaders also may have joined.

The Christian army marched out of Toledo via Talavera along the Tajo to Coria, where added contingents may have joined it, then turning south into enemy land, probably besieging the river-crossing stronghold of Alcántara.

Alfonso's movement toward Badajoz would surely have made Yusuf aware at this point that the Christian King's intent was not merely defensive. The Almoravid chose to bide his time, probably building up supplies and other capacity of his newly formed alliance of Muslim forces just outside Badajoz City. As the Christians secured Alcántara, Yusuf ordered his army northward in the direction of enemy, to await them on the open plain of Sagrajas (Zalaqa). Alfonso would oblige, and so the great battle was joined.

Battle Array and Arts of War. There is no record of the positions of lords and their troops in the Christian array. As we know that the first round of combat at Sagrajas saw the Christians' characteristic frontal charge of their heavy horse, we can guess that King Alfonso and his highest nobles Pedro Ansúrez and García Ordóñez would have led their knights in front, perhaps with Álvaro Fáñez and the Aragonese in a second line, all no doubt inspired by the color of pennants and the songs of *cantadores*. As likely, Álvaro Fáñez as the King's *alférez* standard bearer may have led the initial Christian charge.

We know that Sultan Yusuf arrayed his *taifa* allies in front, so that would have been the Andalusian hardcore of Sevillans under al-Mutamid, Abd Allah's Granadans and Tamim's Málagaans, plus al-Mutawakkil's troops from Badajoz and its vassals.

The Almoravids under Yusuf, his kinsman Sir ibn Abu Bakr, and probably Almoravid general Dawud ibn Aisha (who we know to have been active in the campaign to this point) formed a compact defensive second line. The African foot deployed in a spear wall behind their oversize hide shields, with archers just behind, and African horse behind that.

Strikes, Rout, and Retreat. It seems to have been the Almoravid Sultan's plan to have his allies absorb the first blow and wear down Alfonso's strength to set up an African counterblow. And so it played it out. The Christian knights' frontal charge quickly broke the *taifa* line, which routed toward the safety of Badajoz. One historian, Joseph O'Callaghan, proposes the Muslims practiced a favored tactic of feigned retreat, but most seem to take that the rout of the *taifa* lords as quite genuine.

The Christians next tried to break the far sturdier Muslim second line but themselves broke against the African hedge of spears as arrows showered the knights from the rear of the Almoravid phalanx. Either Yusuf or Sir led the African horse in a flank attack of the faltering Christians while Dawud attacked the Christian camp further behind.

Encompassed by the counter-attackers, Alfonso conceded the field and made good his escape, albeit with a severe wound to the leg. His army, perhaps with the aid of a baggage parapet as a rallying point, retreated north toward Alcántara, suffering massive losses but less than complete destruction.

Aftermath. Alfonso rallied his remnants at Coria. Worried about the fate of Toledo in the face of a now vastly superior enemy, he probably marched there. Certainly, his main activity for the rest of 1086 was somehow to prepare the defense of his recently conquered territory against Yusuf.

The Sultan, however, declined to pursue. He had the severed heads of Christians who fell at Sagrajas carted around the *taifas* to inspire the Muslims, then led his army back south to Sevilla. After some proclamations, he left his Andalusian allies and sailed back to the Maghreb to see to matters there.

Sources. You can find English-language discussion of the Battle of Sagrajas/Zalaqa from historians Almond [IA p44], Catlos [BC p254], Lomax [DL p70], O'Callaghan [JOa p209 & JOB pp141-144], and Reilly [BRa pp88-89 & BRb chs9-10]. See Selected Sources later in this booklet.



*“Battle of La Sagra, Sagrajas or Zalaca”,
engraving by Carlos Luis Ribera, 1845.*

Recreating Sagrajas

Proceed as follows to refight the historical Battle of Sagrajas as a self-contained minigame.

Lords, Vassals, and Capabilities. Each player prepares listed Lord mats (1.5.2), all starting Forces and all Vassal Forces Mustered (1.6, 3.4.1); ignore Assets as they will not affect the Battle.

Christians:

- Alfonso, Pedro Ansúrez, García Ordóñez, and Álvar Fáñez have all their starting units plus all their starting Vassal Forces.
- Sancho has his starting Forces units but not any of his Vassals.
- Christians add one Bishop Vassal marker and its units to each Alfonso, Pedro, and García (in a full scenario, the Christians would have the BISHOPRICs Capability card C22 at their map edge).
- Any two Christian Lords each add three units (four Light Horse and two Militia total) from the MILITES card (C18, in play at the map edge).
- Each of any two Christian Lords has one copy of ARQUEROS Bowmen (cards C4 and C5) at his mat.

Muslims:

- Yusuf, Sir, al-Mutamid, al-Mutawakkil, and Abd Allah have all their starting units plus all their Vassal Forces, EXCEPT that Abd Allah removes his Light Horse Vassal marker and unit (Almería—historically, its emir answered Yusuf’s call to war with only token forces). Yusuf and Sir each have a Javelins marker on their mat for their African Horse.
- Each of two Muslim Taifa Lords (not Yusuf or Sir) has ALRAMA Bowmen (cards M4 and M5).
- The Muslims are Holding Event card M7 SPEAR WALL to play at the outset of Battle (with the two SPEAR WALL markers nearby).

Who Attacks? The Christian player decides whether to Attack or Defend. If the Christians choose to Attack (the historical case), they add the following to their army:

- Two French Crusaders Vassal markers and their units (four Knights units total) on any Christian Lord mat(s).
- The JABALINAS Capability card (C7) with a Javelins marker and the SLINGERS card (C9) at any Christian Lord mat(s).
- CANTADOR (card C8) as a Held Event, to play at the outset of Battle.

If the Christian player chooses to Defend (Alfonso waits for the Muslims to attack and, as the season is wasting away, Yusuf attacks), instead the Muslims add:

- The SAQALIBAH Capability card (M15) at al-Mutamid’s mat, adding two Men-at-Arms units to his Forces area.
- HARBAH (card M3) with a Javelins marker at the mat of any Taifa Lord (not Yusuf or Sir).
- ANDALUSIANS (M10) in play to one side of the Muslim Array (as if at the Muslim board edge), giving all Muslim Light Horse Evade Protection.
- Muslims are Holding FEIGNED RETREAT (card M6, in addition to SPEAR WALL).

Fighting the Battle. Give each player a foldout and refer to the Battle and Storm sheet and the Forces table during play. Open the Rules of Play to section 4.4 Battle. Begin with the Attacker Arraying Lord mats as described at rules section 4.4.1. The Attacker must put that side’s Marshal (Alfonso or Yusuf) at front center.

Proceed through the Battle Procedure sequence along the left half of the Battle and Storm sheet, referring to the Forces table and Rules section 4.4 as needed. Whoever wins the Battle wins the game.

ARTS OF WAR

This section details each side's Arts of War Events and Capabilities with their texts, the Lords they affect, tips on implementing them, and historical background. See Selected Sources in English for expansion of the abbreviated references given here in brackets. The back of this booklet lists all Arts of War cards at a glance.

Christian Events

(top half of card)

C1. HILLS

Hold: May play if Defending in Battle – Christians' Slingers are x1½ and their other Missiles are x1 (not x½)

Lords. All Christians.

Tips. Play HILLS at the outset of Battle (4.4.1 Events), not in Storm and only if Defending. It increases the Hits from all of your side's Slingers, Bowmen, and Crossbowmen throughout that Battle. It does not affect Javelins, which are already x1, nor does it affect Melee.

History. Armies of the day typically sought level open ground to deploy for battle. But Spain's topography offered ample opportunities for a defender to take high ground, including to extend the range and view of missile troops. Javelins, however, relied on closer approach and withdrawal tactic so would be less helped by heights.

C2. CAMP ATTACK

Hold: May play in Battle – Round 1, take 2 Assets from each Enemy Lord there as Spoils, then remove 2 more Assets from each

Lords. All Muslims.

Tips. Play CAMP ATTACK at the outset of Battle (4.4.1 Events), not Storm. Take and remove Enemy Assets as specified on the card at any one time during Round 1, distributing taken Assets among Friendly Lords at the Battle (4.4.3) even if Conceding the Field. See also Capability #C25 EL CID.

History. See Muslim Event #M2 CAMP ATTACK. Christians too would attempt such deep flanking tactics, which receive mention in *El cantar de mio Cid*. [MW p34]

C3. SWOLLEN RIVER

Hold: Play to block March on a Command card OR to block Avoid Battle

Lords. All Muslims.

Tips. Play of SWOLLEN RIVER after an enemy Lord begins a March Command blocks any March by him for the rest of his current Command card; he may use the cancelled March action(s) for other Commands. Play after an enemy Defender declares Avoid Battle instead results in Battle; any discard of Assets to Avoid Battle does not occur. SWOLLEN RIVER cannot block Withdrawal into a Stronghold. See also Capability #C25 EL CID.

History. While few rivers in Spain had reliable enough flow for boat commerce, they could flood and overflow their banks, impeding armies. Bridge crossings were inadequate in number for Spain's long rivers. Roads, while good compared to much of Europe, could suffer from poor maintenance and in wet weather turn to mud. In the game, SWOLLEN RIVER represents any such cases in which terrain difficulties enabled one army to surprise and catch another. [DWL p95]

C4. ARID TERRAIN

Hold: May play as Muslims March – Unless Muslims discard CAMELS, they immediately Feed 2 Marching Lords

Lords. Any Muslims.

Tips. Play Arid Terrain at any time from just before to just after an Enemy Lord undertakes a March action, including from Bypass (4.3.6). That Lord or any two Lords Marching as a group (4.3.1) immediately Feed, including expenditure of Assets and shifts if necessary (4.8.1). Neither Pay nor Disband occurs until the end of the card, as usual (4.8.2). If the Muslims have Capability #M16 CAMELS, they may discard that card to avoid these effects of Arid Terrain, which is also discarded.

History. The movement and sustainment of armies in medieval Spain called for care to ensure access to sufficient water, not only for troops and handlers but for horses, mules, and livestock. Armies often moved along or lingered at rivers because terrain in between one river and another was dangerously dry. Strongholds had to stockpile water along with other provisions. [BRa Ch10 p3; JOB p135] In the game, the Christian and Muslim Events ARID TERRAIN and DROUGHT represent occasions when something regarding provision of water went awry.

C5. DROUGHT

Unless Muslims discard CAMELS, they immediately Feed 2 of their Lords not at Friendly Gardens or Seat

Lords. Any Muslims.

Tips. When a side draws DROUGHT, the other side immediately to the degree able selects any two of its own Lords on the map who are not at Gardens (Fortress or City) or any Seat Friendly (not Neutral or Enemy) to that side. Those two Lords immediately Feed, including expenditure of Assets and shifts if necessary (4.8.1). Neither Pay nor Disband occurs until those segments of Levy (3.2, 3.3). If the Muslims have Capability #M16 CAMELS, they may discard that card to instead discard DROUGHT without effect.

History. See Event #C4 ARID TERRAIN, above.

C6. SURPRISE

Hold: May play upon March to Enemy Stronghold where no Lord – Place 2 Siege there, then Storm with Walls –1

Lords. Any Christians.

Tips. Marching Lord(s) must enter an Enemy Stronghold Locale where neither Enemy nor Friendly Lords already. Place two Siege markers instead of the usual one (4.3.5). Immediate Storm for at least one Round is mandatory, costing no actions. Walls –1 means

treat Walls 1-4 as Walls 1-3. Siegeworks with two markers will count as Walls 1-2 for the Attackers (4.5.2). See also Capability #C25 EL CID.

History. A medieval force, if it approached an enemy stronghold quickly or stealthily enough or with the help of traitors inside or other local assistance, might seize it through sudden attack, a *coup de main*—perhaps by scaling the walls in dark of night. [JOB p135; JM p6] The speed of the Christian conquest of the linchpin stronghold of Aledo in 1086 suggests such a rapid action:

García Jiménez, thanks to a daring *cabalgada* took the fortress of Aledo ... more than 300 km from the border of Castilla [i.e., León]. ... So spectacular a conquest ... could not have been sustained had it not had the support of the abundant *Mozárabe* population ... in the region of Murcia. [Maderuelo.com]

On Aledo, see also Christian Capability #C24 GARCÍA JIMÉNEZ. On *Mozárabe* assistance to Leonese conquest of strongholds, see Event #C21 MOZÁRABES.

C7. BAGGAGE PARAPET

Hold: May play in Battle

Cancel Muslim CAMP ATTACK

If Christians Retreat, pay 1 Asset per Lord to skip Spoils and Service shift

Lords. Any Christians.

Tips. Play BAGGAGE PARAPET at the outset of Battle (4.4.1 Events) Attack or Defense, not Storm. If the Christians play BAGGAGE PARAPET first, Muslims may not play #M2 CAMP ATTACK in that Battle; if Christians play BAGGAGE PARAPET after Muslims play CAMP ATTACK, discard CAMP ATTACK without effect. See also Capability #C25 EL CID.

History. Historian Bernard Reilly reasons that the Christians at Sagradas formed a baggage parapet around their camp as a standard precaution:

There are no sources to prove that the carts themselves were arranged to form a rough, fortified precinct but it would be strange if they were not. Very little tactical sense is requisite to suggest placing a solid obstacle between one's self and a potential attacker or to create a continuous line of barriers by placing the shafts of one cart on the body of the next. [BRa Ch10 p3]

If they did, it was not enough to prevent the Almoravids' flanking attack on the Christian rear sealing the rout of Alfonso's army. But it may have played a role in enabling the wounded king to escape and in keeping his losses to just half his field army. [BRb p89]

C8. CANTADOR

Hold: May play on a Lord in Battle or Storm

Round 1, up to 4 of his Knights AND Sergeants Melee Strike +1

Lords. Any Christian.

Tips. Play CANTADOR at the outset of Battle or Storm Attack or Defense (4.4.1 Events). Slide the card under the top edge of a Christian Lord's mat while in effect. Up to four of that Lord's

Knights and Sergeants units when Striking in Melee during Round 1 cause one added Hit—three Hits each for Knights in Battle or two Hits each in Storm or for Sergeants. Missiles and Hits against Christians are unaffected. After Round 1, discard the card. See also Capability #C25 EL CID.

History. *Cantadores* in medieval Spanish armies were troubadours who rode ahead of the troops, singing heroic tales (such as, later, that of El Cid) in order to strengthen morale and fighting spirit. [DNc p9; JM pp 12, 40]

C9. BETRAYAL OF TERMS

Hold: Play upon Surrender to take Spoils as if Sack, OR take double and Muslims add 1 Jihad

Lords. Any Christians.

Tips. Play BETRAYAL OF TERMS only at the moment that a Muslim Stronghold Surrenders per 4.5.1 (not in a Sack after Storm, 4.5.2). The Christian player immediately opts to receive either the Spoils shown on the Strongholds table for that Stronghold type or twice that amount of Spoils. If twice the amount, the Muslim player then immediately adds one Jihad marker to the map per 1.4.4, if able.

History. Terms of surrender, particularly of Muslim towns and cities to Christian attackers, became standard in the latter 11th Century: if defenders gave up after a period, they would be spared; if they resisted too long and had be stormed, many would be killed or enslaved. [DWL p54] However, sometimes the temptations of betraying such terms upon surrender tragically proved too great, particularly for religiously zealous crusaders from outside Iberia who were less used to routine interaction with Muslim neighbors. This occurred most famously in 1064 when the northeastern Muslim town of Barbastro capitulated under the usual terms after a 40-day siege by a force of Frankish knights, Norman warriors, and Catalan troops, only to suffer murder, rape, torture, enslavement, and loot of immense booty. [DWL p58; JOa p197; JOB pp 26-27; BRb pp 37, 69] See also Muslim Event #M22 MASSACRE.

C10. DEVALUATION

Muslims reduce their Coin among Taifas box and Lords to $\frac{2}{3}$ of the total (rounded up)

Lords. All Muslims.

Tips. Count up all Coin among Muslim Lords plus those in the Taifas box. The Muslim player must immediately remove Coin from Muslim mats and/or the box until the sum is $\frac{2}{3}$ of the original total, rounded up. For example, if the Taifas box has four Coin and just one Muslim Lord has one Coin, the Muslim player would select and remove any one Coin.

History. The economy of *al-Andalus*—and therefore the splendor of the *taifa* lords' palaces and gardens as well as their capacity to hire mercenaries—depended not only on the fading Muslim trade monopoly across the Mediterranean Sea but also on the flow of gold from Niger through the Maghrib. That gold went into the vaunted dinar coins that the *taifas* then paid so profligately as *parias* to Spain's Christian kings and counts. The constant movement of wealth towards the north favored the devaluation of Andalusian currency as its proportion of gold diminished and that

of silver increased, becoming whitish gold. This Event portrays a shock to this fragile Andalusian financial system from an Almoravid demand of dinar bribes for themselves or their blockade of African gold to sharpen the emirs' dependency on the Maliki Sultan. [AAJ; DWL p18; BC p260; BRb pp 102-105] See also Muslim Event #M14 DEVALUATION.

C11. INDULGENCES



An Unbesieged Christian Lord immediately Musters 1 Crusader

Eudes, if Unbesieged, immediately Musters all Ready Vassals

Lords. Any Christian, Eudes.

Tips. See 3.4.2 ARTS OF WAR. If a Crusader Service marker is available (not already Mustered), immediately add it with two Knights units to any one Mustered Unbesieged Christian Lord's Forces area. If Eudes is on the map and Unbesieged, all his Ready Vassals (if any) immediately Muster. These Musters cost no actions and may not be declined. Do not put Crusaders on the Calendar even if using the Vassal Service advanced rule 3.4.2: they are immune to Vassal Service limits.

History. While Christian expeditions against Muslims had been going on a long time, the late 11th Century saw the first patronage by the Church of such fighting as Holy War, including the granting of spiritual privileges to the volunteers. Frenchmen journeying from Burgundy, Champagne, or Normandy to fight the Muslims of *al-Andalus* over these decades became Europe's first official crusaders. The invention under Pope Alexander II (1061-1073) of indulgences, in which the Pope authorized anyone to substitute crusading in Spain for whatever penance they had been ordered to perform to help obtain forgiveness of sins, became an effective means of mobilization. French knights probably were among Alfonso's forces at Sagrajas in 1086. [AAJ; DWL pp 58-61; JOB pp 24-25] See also Events #C12 SONG OF ROLAND and #C14 POPE GREGORY.

C12. SONG OF ROLAND

An Unbesieged Christian Lord immediately Musters 1 Crusader
Eudes, if Unbesieged, immediately Musters all Ready Vassals

Lords. Any Christian, Eudes.

Tips. See Event #C11 INDULGENCES, above. Although the two Events have different titles and history, they work the same.

History. Official religious endorsement of crusading in Iberia stimulated the growth and popularity of minstrels' songs and epic stories about Christian heroes who fought the Muslims. Toward the end of the 11th Century, these tales increasingly featured hatred of Muslims as a theme and at least implicit urging of Frenchmen to go kill them in Iberia. The most famous of these recruiting songs were the *Song of Roland*, about Charlemagne's defeat at Roncesvalles in 778, and the *Song of St. William of Orange*, about a count of Toulouse who had bravely fought Muslims. As an epic story to increase the fervour of the crusades, the *Song of Roland* romanticizes Charlemagne's campaign of 300 years earlier to give it a heroic anti-Muslim character. Epic poems began to give

St. James a role in inspiring Charlemagne against the Muslims and thereby intertwined with the already popular pilgrimage to the Saint's shrine in Spain. French crusaders had a ready road to follow and could even visit the warrior Roland's tomb or the scene of his battle death along the way. [AAJ; DWL pp 62-63; BC p240; JM p12] See also Events #C11 INDULGENCES and #C14 POPE GREGORY.

C13. BERENGUER RAMON

If COUNT OF BARCELONA with Muslims, they discard card

If not, a Lord may Levy this card and its units now for 1 Asset

Lords. Al-Mustain or al-Mundir (Sancho or Eudes).

Tips. See Christian Capability #C13 COUNT OF BARCELONA: if in play with an Enemy Lord, discard will remove Forces from him. If not, Levy of the Capability for this side is immediate and, if taken, costs any 1 Asset (Sharing applies, 1.5.2) instead of 2 Coin but otherwise follows 3.4.4, including limiting eligibility to a Lord indicated, who must be at a Friendly Locale free of Siege (3.4 Important).

History. See Geography—The Catalan Counties earlier in this booklet. [AAJ]

C14. POPE GREGORY

Hold: Play on Sancho or Eudes any time to Muster him from Calendar, OR shift his Service 2 boxes, OR for Lordship +2

Lords. Sancho or Eudes.

Tips. See 3.4.1 ARTS OF WAR. Muster of Sancho or Eudes may be from anywhere on the Calendar without rolling or using any Levy action (for Sancho) or counting as a Call to Arms (for Eudes), but otherwise per 3.4.1 or 3.5.1, as appropriate.

History. Pope Gregory VII (1073-1085) carried on his predecessor Alexander's expansion of papal interest and influence in Spain and support of Christian war on Muslims of *al-Andalus*. Alexander had sent the first known papal legate to Spain in the 1060s around the time of the French proto-crusade to Barbastro that he had helped organize (see Event #C9 BETRAYAL OF TERMS). King Sancho I Ramírez of Aragón in 1068 made himself a vassal of the Pope, sealing an anti-Muslim papal alliance. Gregory followed up this diplomacy with active backing of Cluniac involvement in Spain and attempts to organize further French expeditions to advance the *Reconquista*. [DWL pp 58-60; BRb pp 68-69; JOB pp 24-25] Gregory died in 1085. This Event represents the effects of Gregory's policies beyond his death in 1085 into the following year as the Almoravid threat arrived and spurred yet more Christian intervention, such as the expedition led by Duke Eudes of Burgundy in response to Alfonso VI's call. See also Events #C11 INDULGENCES and #C15 CLUNIACS.

C15. CLUNIACS – Monastic network

Hold: Play on a Lord any time to Muster him from Calendar, OR shift his Service 1 box right, OR for Lordship +2

Lords. Any Christian.

Tips. See 3.4.1 ARTS OF WAR. Muster of a Christian Lord may be any with a cylinder anywhere on the Calendar without rolling, using any Levy action, or counting as a Call to Arms, but otherwise per 3.4.1 or 3.5.1, as appropriate to that Lord.

History. Benedictine monasticism emanating from the Burgundian monastery of Cluny spread to Castilla and then León after about 1025. Cluniac monks who were from or had studied in France grew in influence, became bishops, and oversaw a reform of church life. Alfonso VI favored this order as a counterweight to the Pope and became the most important patron of the Cluniac monastery. As well, his wife was a niece of the Abbot of Cluny. Cluniacs gained important positions in the Leonese Kingdom. This influence included a transformation during Alfonso's reign of the *Reconquista* into a crusade—a holy endeavour worthy of the support of all Christendom. [AAJ; DWL pp 56-57; JOB p24; JOa pp 203-204] See also Events #C14 POPE GREGORY above and #C16 BERNARD DE SÉDIRAC below.

C16. BERNARD DE SÉDIRAC – *Aggressive bishop*

Shift a Lord's Service 1 box right OR Muster a Lord from Calendar now

Levy CATHEDRALS (this card)

Lords. Any Christian.

Tips. See 3.4.1 ARTS OF WAR. The Christians must immediately choose shift or Muster. Muster of a Christian Lord may be any with a cylinder anywhere on the Calendar without rolling, using any Levy action, or counting as a Call to Arms, but otherwise per 3.4.1 or 3.5.1, as appropriate to that Lord. The Christians then tuck the card under their board edge for no action: CATHEDRALS is in effect.

History. French Cluniac cleric Bernard de Sédillac (de Sauvetot), powerful Abbot of Sahagún and from 1086 Archbishop of Toledo, in alliance with King Alfonso VI's French-born queen, Constanza, led reaction within León against Alfonso's initially accommodating policies toward newly conquered Muslims. In particular, he pressed for and during the 1086 military campaign against the Almoravids achieved Alfonso's conversion of Toledo's great mosque into a cathedral. See also Christian Event #15 CLUNIACS and Capability #C16 CATHEDRALS. [BRa Ch9 p12; DWL pp 56, 66, 98; JOa pp 203-204, 206; BC pp 232-233]

C17. GENOA & PISA send fleets to harass al-Andalus



Place Ravaged at 2 Unravaged Enemy Ports where no Muslim Lords

Lords. None.

Tips. Put one yellow Ravaged marker at each of two Strongholds with Port symbols that are currently Friendly to the Muslims (not Neutral, 1.3.1, 1.4.1) and have no Muslim Lord (even one that is Besieged) and no Ravaged marker already. The two markers add a total of +1 Christian VP (5.1). This is not a Ravage Command action and so does not add Loot or Provender or shift any Service (4.7.2).

History. For centuries, the western Mediterranean had been a Muslim lake and the domain of Muslim pirates and coastal raiders. By the late 11th Century, however, the balance of seapower was swinging toward the merchant republics of Italy, feeding Christian ambitions. Genoa and Pisa had been striking African Muslim shores for decades. In 1092, Alfonso VI contracted a Genoese and Pisan naval expedition as part of an attempted joint attack by sea and land against Valencia and the Muslim port of Tortosa. The next century would see major support from these fleets to the *Reconquista* in the Balearic islands and the on the Catalan coast. [AAJ; DWL pp 59, 82; JOB pp 35-36; BRb pp 72, 91] GENOA & PISA in the game explores the eventuality of a mid-1080s expansion of Christian sea raids from Algeria to Iberia.

C18. RUNAWAY SLAVES

Hold: Play in Muster for each Unbesieged Christian Lord to restore all Lost Foot units and add 1 Transport

Lords. All Christians.

Tips. See 3.4.2 ARTS OF WAR. The Christian side may play RUNAWAY SLAVES during its Muster segment. All Christian Lords who are on the map and Unbesieged (even if Bypassed or at Neutral or Enemy Locales) add Foot units (Men-at-Arms, Militia, and Serfs) to their Forces equal in number and type to those lost from their starting Forces and Mustered Vassals. Determine lost units by comparing the Lord's current Forces units to the sum of those pictured on the mat plus pictured on his currently Mustered Vassal Service markers (including Bishops). Then choose and add either a Cart or a Mule to each Unbesieged Christian Lord on map.

History. During this period of rapid Christian advance, as King Alfonso had consolidated control of Toledo, besieged Zaragoza, seized Aledo, and intervened in Valencia, Christian armies could be refuges for enslaved Muslims. The army of Álvaro Fánhez on its 1086 campaign through the *taifa* of Valencia grew daily as runaway slaves renounced Islam and joined in the plunder of the countryside. [DWL p66]

C19. FITNA – *Emirs fractious*

Choose 2 Taifa Lords

Shift Service of each by 1 box left

This Levy, no Muster of or by them

Lords. Taifa Muslims.

Tips. The Christian player selects any two Taifa Lords (1.5.1). If they are currently Mustered, their Service markers shift a box left on the Calendar (as do, if using the Advanced Vassal Service advanced rule 3.4.2, their Vassals). Those two Lords this Levy may neither become Mustered nor take Levy actions themselves. Keep the FITNA card near the Muslim mats area for the current Levy; the card's Capability is unavailable this turn (3.1.3).

History. *Fitna*—a general term for upheaval and strife within Islam—refers also to the spike in ethnic and dynastic frictions that led to the breakup of the Iberian Caliphate into many small *taifa* states in the first half of the 11th Century, contrasted also with the unity of the Almoravid Empire that replaced the *taifas* at Century's end. As detailed in the geographic and Muslim lord histories

earlier in this booklet, dynastic rivalries among *taifa* lords at best only briefly submerged in the face of the threat from Alfonso VI of León and resurfaced almost immediately after the Sagrajas victory eased Christian pressure. See also Event #C22 BERBERS. [BC pp 201, 219, 236; WM p13]

C20. AL-QADIR – *Puppet emir*

Hold: May play if a Reconquista or Parias Taifa is free of Muslim Lords

Remove 2 Jihad there

Lords. None.

Tips. The Christian player may play at any time and select any two Jihad markers within a single eligible Taifa.

History. As part of the arranged surrender of Toledo to Alfonso VI, its emir al-Qadir received residence in Cuenca until Alfonso could aid his conquest of the throne of Valencia to become a *parias taifa*. When Valencia's possession Játiva revolted, al-Qadir besieged the town. In response to Játiva's call for help, al-Mundir invaded Valencia from Tortosa, until Alfonso sent a Christian army under Álvaro Fáñez to intervene on his protectorate *taifa's* behalf. [AAJ; BRa chapter 9 pp8-9] See also Geography – Taifa of Toledo earlier in this booklet and Muslim Event #M11 AL-QADIR BALKS AT PAYMENT.

C21. MOZÁRABES – *Arabized Christians*

Hold: Play for a Surrender roll in a Reconquista Taifa to succeed automatically

Lords. None.

Tips. Play only at the moment of making a Surrender roll via a Siege action (4.5.1).

History. The fall of Toledo put three major religious communities under Christian protection: *Mozárabes* (Christians who had lived under Muslim rule, were Arabized, and followed a different Christian rite than the Christians of León), *Mudéjares* (Muslims now living under Christian rule), and Jews. (See also Muslim Event #M20 MUDÉJARES.) Toledo, along with Sevilla, Córdoba, and Valencia was home to the largest groups of *Mozárabes* (from Arabic *must'arib* or *must'arab*, "would-be Arab"), half of some regions' inhabitants and perhaps 30 percent of the overall population of *al-Andalus*. While religious coexistence within the *taifas* was generally peaceful, *Mozárabes* and Jews under Muslim custom and law had to pay a tax to keep their faith. In some cases of Christian siege, such as Toledo in 1085 and Valencia in 1086, *Mozárabe* citizens appear to have helped seal surrender negotiations. Later, during the Almoravid conquest, coexistence became more difficult and forced *Mozárabes* to side with either Christians or Almoravids, typically the former. [AAJ; LPT; Reilly pp 20-21; IA 18; BC pp 104, 258]

C22. BERBERS – *Arab & Slav mistrust*

Shift Service of al-Mutawakkil, Abd Allah, Yusuf, OR Sir by 1 box

This Levy, no Muster of or by any of them

Lords. al-Mutawakkil, Abd Allah, Yusuf, or Sir.

Tips. See Christian Event #C19 FITNA above. BERBERS works the same but applied to the Christian player's choice of either al-Mutawakkil, Abd Allah, Yusuf, or Sir for the Service shift and all four of them for the ban on Muster.

History. Muslim Iberia was an ethnic polyglot of African, Mid-eastern, and European nationalities—see "Ethnicities of al-Andalus" earlier in this booklet—and tensions among elites of different ethnic groups contributed to the breakup of the 11th-Century Caliphate into *taifas*. Arabs and *Andalusí* often despised Berbers, while Berbers and Slavs were dynastic rivals. Sevilla, including under al-Mutamid, led an anti-Berber alliance of *taifas* against the Zirids' Granada. And Spain's Christians knew of and sought to exploit these tensions among Muslims. Ethnic mistrust surely contributed to the frictions between the Berber Almoravids and the mixture of *taifa* dynasties even before Yusuf began his conquest of them, and they carried on in relations between the African Almohad rulers who succeeded the Almoravids in the next century and their Andalusian subjects. [DWL pp 17, 49-52; BRb p13; IA p34; JM p34; BC pp 176-177, 201, 252, 281; DNm p20]

C23. ILLNESS OF THE EMIR

On Calendar, shift cylinder OR Service of Abu Bakr OR al-Mustain by 1 box

This Levy, no Muster of or by him

Lords. Abu Bakr or al-Mustain.

Tips. See Christian Event #C19 FITNA above. ILLNESS OF THE EMIR works the same but applied to the Christian player's choice of either Abu Bakr or al-Mustain for both the Service shift and the ban on Muster.

History. See Geography – Taifa of Valencia earlier in this booklet. [BRa chapter 9 p6]

C24. ABU BAKR IBN UMAR – *Almoravid rival*

On Calendar, shift Service of Yusuf AND Sir each 1 box left

This Levy, no Muster of or by either

Lords. Yusuf and Sir.

Tips. See Christian Event #C19 FITNA above. ABU BAKR IBN UMAR works the same but applied only to Yusuf and Sir both.

History. The Almoravids' African empire spread under the leadership of a succession of Lamtuna tribal chiefs, from 1056 Yusuf ibn Tashufin's cousin Abu Bakr ibn Umar. The latter, to free himself up to suppress a civil war in a desert corner of the empire, in 1070 ceded power to Yusuf until his return. But when Abu Bakr did return, Yusuf had gained effective power over the empire and banished him. The cousins remained rivals until Abu Bakr's death in 1087. This Event postulates that a political challenge from Abu Bakr was among the reasons for Yusuf's precipitate departure from Iberia at the end of 1086. [AAJ; BRb p101; WM p67]

C25. DE VIVAR

Hold: Play as Christian Call to Arms if Rodrigo al-Sayyid is on map

Reconcile with Rodrigo (3.5.1) for just 1VP to Taifas box

Lords. Rodrigo al-Sayyid and Rodrigo Campeador.

Tips. The Christians may not play the Event unless (green) Rodrigo al-Sayyid is on map. Play must be during Christian Call to Arms, during which the Christians may do nothing else. Reconcile with Rodrigo per the procedure in 3.5.1 but add only 1VP to the Taifas box regardless of Rodrigo's current Service.

History. While Rodrigo Díaz de Vivar's career alternated in service to Alfonso and to Muslims potentially in conflict with León, the Cid managed to avoid fighting his Christian King directly (at least during the 1080s). That history suggests a deeper loyalty to Alfonso, and when Alfonso in his time of need after defeat at Sagradas offered Rodrigo reconciliation, the latter immediately accepted and re-entered Leonese service. [AAJ; BRa chapter 10 page 4] See also Lord Histories – El Cid earlier in this booklet.

C26. FREEBOOTER

Disband Rodrigo al-Sayyid as if at Service Limit (3.3.2)

If desired, Reconcile with Rodrigo (3.5.1) now for just 1VP to Taifas box

Lords. Rodrigo al-Sayyid and Rodrigo Campeador.

Tips. Disband of (green) Rodrigo al-Sayyid is immediate and mandatory (if he is on map). Reconcile works the same as for Christian Event #C25 DE VIVAR above, except that it occurs immediately rather than during Call to Arms.

History. Rodrigo Díaz's matchless reputation as a victor on the battlefield put his services as mercenary in high demand on all sides. He could suffer repeated exile from Alfonso's realm and still manage to find employment with the emirs, then return to his King once Alfonso got over any perceived offense by his famous erstwhile captain. See Lord Histories – El Cid earlier in this booklet.

Christian Capabilities

(bottom half of card)

C1. BATTERING RAM

This Lord at Siege counts as 2 Lords and may reroll 1 Surrender die per Christian Siege action

Lords. Any Christian.

Tips. Any Lord with BATTERING RAM at a Siege Locale affects the Enemy Stronghold's Walls; it need not be the Lord taking the Siege action. Counts as 2 Lords regards only the number of Lords outside the Stronghold needed to place Siege markers per 4.5.1. For example, two Lords, one of whom has Battering Ram, Besieging an Enemy City (Capacity ③) could add Siege markers.

History. Battering rams were a key piece of equipment to smash a besieged stronghold's walls and thereby force surrender. [JOB p138] One of the Christians' most important conquests from the Muslims before Toledo was Coimbra in 1064, a major town that resisted only until battering rams broke its walls (except for some of its citizens who held a redoubt that the Christians then stormed). [DWL p54]

C2. BALLESTEROS – Crossbows

This Lord's Men-at-Arms and Militia have Missiles $\times \frac{1}{2}$ that select target units, –1 to target's Armor

Lords. Any Christian.

Tips. Crossbow units Strike with both Missile and Melee. The side using Crossbows selects which individual unit piece of the Enemy Lord or Garrison involved will roll Protection against and take each Crossbow Hit. "–1 Armor" means, for example, 1-3 Armor becomes 1-2 Armor. Militia using both Crossbows and Javelins get the benefits of each ($\times 1$, target selection, and –1 to Armor). When Crossbowmen units and other Missile units Strike together, any Hit that includes at least $\frac{1}{2}$ a Hit from Crossbowmen gains the targeting and 1 Armor. That is, when rounding units with Archery, round in favor of Crossbowmen (4.4.2 Mixed Missiles).

History. Crossbows, not yet as complicated or powerful as the models of the High Middle Ages, were just entering widespread popularity among 11th-Century Iberian Christian and Muslim armies. Sometimes used mounted but in greater numbers by light infantry, they would prove particularly valuable for sniping from confined, protected positions in siege warfare. [DNc pp 9, 14; DNm p21; JM pp 10, 14-15, 42-44, 55; JOB pp 128-130]

C3 & C10. ADALIDES – Royal guides

This Lord may Bypass without stopping AND ignores SWOLLEN RIVER

Lords. Not Eudes.

Tips. Bypass without stopping means that a Lord with ADALIDES may Bypass an Enemy Stronghold and then use a March action on the same Command card (4.3.4). If the Muslims play Event #M3 SWOLLEN RIVER at any Locale where this Lord is present, whether or not himself Marching, discard SWOLLEN RIVER without effect. A Lord may have only one ADALIDES card (3.4.4).

History. Iberian Christian armies used commanders holding a special office by royal appointment called *adalid*, from Arabic *al-dalil*, guide and leader of the first attack on an enemy. *Adalid* referred to one whose knowledge of roads and passages enabled him to lead troops safely through difficult terrain. The Capability in the game also represents Christian use of militia auxiliary scouts, *atalayeros*. [AAJ; JOB p133; DNc p10]

C4 & C5. ARQUEROS – Bowmen

This Lord's Foot and Light Horse have Missiles $\times \frac{1}{2}$

Lords. Any Christian.

Tips. Bowmen units Strike with both Missile and Melee. Note that even Serfs can be Bowmen. A Lord may have only one ARQUEROS card (3.4.4).

History. Bows and arrows were common across Christian and Muslim Iberia, and bowmen on both foot and horse remained popular in Spanish armies into the early 12th Century, even as the crossbow proliferated. Christians used servants as auxiliary bowmen deployed behind their spearmen. [JOB pp 128-130; JM pp 14-15] As Reilly explains for Alfonso's host at Sagradas:

In an age when any healthy man could draw a bow to some effect and even may have had rudimentary training in handling a spear, the army was automatically supplied with skirmishers. [BRa chapter 9 p2]

C6. SIEGE TOWERS

This Lord at Storm from Round 2 on weakens Enemy Stronghold to Walls -1

Lords. Any Christian.

Tips. Any Lord with SIEGE TOWERS at a Storm Locale affects the Enemy Stronghold's Walls; it need not be the Lord taking the Storm action. On Round 1, there is no effect. For Round 2 and all later Rounds, Walls -1 means treat Walls 1-4 as Walls 1-3. The Attackers' Siegeworks are unaffected (4.5.2).

History. All sides in the *Reconquista* used various types of siege engines, including building and pushing towers on wheels or greased wooden rollers up to the enemy's walls to rain missiles down on them and ultimately get attackers onto the battlements. Christians were using siege towers among their siege engines by the 1050s, and they were present at an Almoravid and Andalusian siege of Aledo in 1092, for example. [AAJ; JOB p138; B&F p49; History of Aledo at https://murciatoday.com/the-history-of-aledo_11116-a.html]

C7. JABALINAS – Javelins



Up to 4 of this Lord's Unarmored units have Missiles x1 on any 1 Battle Round, Missiles x½ if Storm (mark)

Lords. Any Christian.

Tips. Puts a Javelins marker on this Lord's mat. In each Battle or Storm with this Lord, the owner may declare at one Missiles step of any one Round only that Lord's use of Javelin Missiles per the Capability (4.4.2 Javelins). After use, flip the Javelins marker to the side with the X (used). Flip it back to the front side after the Battle or Storm. For a Lord with more than four Unarmored units, it is not necessary to designate which four have Javelins: if reduced to four or fewer Unarmored units, they retain Javelins. Units with both Javelins and Bowmen or Crossbows are Missiles x1 on the Battle Round of Javelin use and Missiles x½ on other Rounds. Javelin units Strike with both Missile and Melee.

History. Iberian Christian troops of the 11th Century still favored javelins and throwing spears, the most renowned javelinists being Basque light foot. [JM pp 13-16, 54-55]

C8. HUESTE – Offensive expedition

This Lord Marches as a Marshal to or from Locales in Taifas, not with Alfonso

Lords. Pedro Ansúrez, García Ordóñez, Álvar Fáñez, or Rodrigo Campeador.

Tips. A Lord with HUESTE counts as a Marshal when he undertakes March actions to or from any Locales in any Taifas, not from one Kingdom Locale to another. He may not use that ability to take Alfonso along in his Marching Group (1.5.1 Marshals, 4.3.1). He may act as a Marshal even if already a Lieutenant; he

remains a Lieutenant and his Lower Lord stays with him (4.1.3). If he is a Lower Lord, he may not undertake actions and so cannot make use of HUESTE.

History. The tradition of noble service in the Christian Reconquest included joining an army known as a *hueste* formed by *mesnadas* and formally summoned for some specific purpose such as a major campaign of conquest or to raid enemy territory. [AAJ; DWL p100; DNc p10; Job p125]

C9. SLINGERS

Up to 3 Militia of this Lord have Missiles x1 in Battle, Missiles x½ in Storm

Lords. Any Christian.

Tips. Slinger units Strike with both Missile and Melee. Units with both Missiles x1 and Missiles x½ are Missiles x1. For a Lord with more than three Militia, it is not necessary to designate which three have Slingers: if reduced to three or fewer Militia, they remain Slingers.

History. Slingers remained common on Iberian battlefields of the 11th Century. [AAJ; JM pp 15, 43] Christians used them in the 1050s, for example, to storm a town defended by skilled Muslim archers. [B&F p49]

C11 & C12. MESNADA – Private troop contingent

This Lord with Knights Command +1

Lords. Not Eudes.

Tips. Command +1 means that a Lord with a Command rating of "4" instead could take five Command actions on his card, for example (1.5.3, 1.4.1). A Lord with MESNADA receives the added Command with even a single Knights unit on his mat. A Lord may have only one MESNADA card (3.4.4).

History. *Mesnadas* were the pool of troops that a count, a bishop or a lesser noble could gather from his dominions to form an offensive or defensive force. Great counts' and bishops' private contingents drew from three tiers—the magnate's closest relatives and thus richest and best equipped and trained in military arts, lower families who were his direct vassals and provided heavy cavalry and captains of troops and garrisons, and the farmers who were at least well off enough to have some wherewithal for campaigning and forming the bulk of soldiers for garrison, light horse, and infantry (*milites*). *Mesnada* also referred to the elite corps of knights out of that highest tier, acting as the great lord's bodyguard and providing the offensive nucleus of the army. This Capability represents the efficiency granted to an army's operations through leadership from that essentially professional military cadre. [AAJ; DWL p99; JOB pp 125-127] See also Capability #C18 MILITES and Muslim Capability #M18 HASHAM.

C13. COUNT OF BARCELONA

Unless COUNT OF BARCELONA with Muslims, this Lord pays 2 Coin (once) to Muster 2 Knights, 2 Men-at-Arms until card discarded

Lords. Sancho or Eudes.

Tips. See 3.4.2 ARTS OF WAR. Either indicated Lord with this Capability during any Muster segment in which he is eligible per 3.4 “Important” may pay for the units, for no actions. Sharing applies (1.5.2). Discard removes the same number of units from that Lord’s mat. See also Christian and Muslim Events #C13/M23 BERENGUER RAMON.

History. See Geography—The Catalan Counties earlier in this booklet. [AAJ]

C14 & C17. CABALGADAS – *Long-range raids*

This Lord may pay 1 Prov to use entire card to Ravage across up to 2 Ways, not at or past any Unbesieged Enemy Lord

Lords. Any Christian.

Tips. The Lord must have or Share (1.5.2) one Provender and use all actions on his Command card to use this Capability. Expend the Provender and Ravage a Locale up to two Locales distant. Neither the intervening Locale nor the target Locale may have an Unbesieged Enemy Lord, even if Bypassed. Place a Ravaged marker, gain Loot or Provender, and shift a Taifa Lord’s Service normally (4.7.2). A Lord may have only one CABALGADAS card (3.4.4).

History. Self-financed marauding raids were a frequent *Reconquista* military activity by both sides, particularly for the Christians as they pressed south of the northern sierras and onto the central Iberian plains in the 11th Century. Small raiding parties of 50 to 300 men on horseback might make swift strikes to seize livestock and whatever else they could in a day or two in the target area. Alternatively, larger armies with horse and foot might raid deep into enemy territory for several weeks. [AAJ; JOB p134; DWL pp 52, 100; DNc p4]

C15. ALFÉREZ – *Standard bearer*

This Lord may use 1 Command to become or stop being a Lieutenant

Lords. Pedro Ansúrez, García Ordóñez, Álvar Fáñez, or Rodrigo Campeador.

Tips. A Lord with ALFÉREZ may use a Command action to immediately stack as a Lieutenant on top of another Christian Lord at the same Locale, or may use an action to unstack and no longer be a Lieutenant (4.1.3). He may do so multiple times during a single card. ALFÉREZ alters the restrictions on when Lieutenants are designated; other rules regarding Lieutenants remain in effect, including that Alfonso may not be a Lower Lord because he is a Marshal.

History. The *alférez* (“signifier”) was a prominent position in the curia hierarchy. The *alférez* bore the royal standard, commanded the royal bodyguard, and led the king’s army in the monarch’s absence. The Cid had been named *alférez* by Alfonso’s predecessor Sancho II. [AAJ; JOB p133; BRb p56]

C16. CATHEDRALS



Alfonso at Conquered City may place Cathedral Seat if none there yet

When he does, Muslims add 1 Jihad

Lords. Alfonso.

Tips. Although only Alfonso can Levy and use this Capability, put the CATHEDRALS card at the board edge not at his mat (3.4.4). The marker is both a Seat marker and worth 1VP. If both are already on the map, the Christians can relocate one of those. Later discard of the card does not alone remove the marker(s). The Muslims decide where to add the Jihad per 1.4.4 “Important”.

History. Upon his conquest of Toledo in 1085, King Alfonso VI set forth protections for the city’s Muslims, including their continued access to Toledo’s great mosque. However, in the heat of the Almoravid invasion the next year, and under pressure from Queen and her French Cluniac confessor Bernard de Sédillac—who as Bishop of Toledo had eclipsed the more Muslim-sympathetic governor, Sisnando Davídez—Alfonso reversed his policy. In Toledo on his way from the failed siege of Zaragoza to the showdown with Yusuf near Badajoz, in part to help rally his forces ahead of the confrontation with the Almoravids, the King ordered the mosque’s conversion into a cathedral. See also Christian Capability #C21 SISNANDO DAVIDEZ and Event #16 BERNARD DE SÉDIRAC. [AAJ; BRa Ch9 p12, BC pp 232-233; DWL p66, JOa p206] Emblematic of León’s Christian consolidation of the former *taifa* capital, CATHEDRALS in the game provides the Christian side both victory score and logistical benefit.

C18. MILITES

Put 2 Militia and 4 Light Horse on this card

Christian Lords pay 1 Asset to Muster up to 3 of them per Lord

Discard removes card from game

Lords. Any Christians.

Tips. See 3.4.2 ARTS OF WAR. Put the MILITES card at the board edge, not at a mat (3.4.4). Any Christian Lords during any Muster segments in which they are eligible per 3.4 “Important” may pay for the units, for no actions. Sharing applies (1.5.2). Discard leaves units in place. Because discard removes the card from the game, it removes Event #C18 RUNAWAY SLAVES with it.

History. A great lord’s *mesnada* would include a third social tier of vassal soldiers from local lower aristocracy, townsmen, and farmers who did 40 days or other brief periods of armed service for economic compensation—those people with just enough income to maintain basic war equipment, sometimes including a horse. This establishment could make up the most numerous contingents, including the main infantry force. [AAJ; DWL p99; JOB p128] See also Capability #C11/C12 MESNADA.

C19. CABALLERÍA VILLANA *patrols the frontier*



Muslim Ravage in Kingdoms must roll 1-3 for effect (mark)

Block AL-MAGHAWIR

Lords. Any Christians.

Tips. Put the CABALLERÍA VILLANA card at the board edge, not at a mat (3.4.4). Place one reminder marker within the borders of León Kingdom and the second in Aragón. The Capability affects Ravage Command actions, not placement of Ravaged markers by Event. Muslims roll as they expend each action.

History. As the Christians resettled the deserted band of territory between the old Christian north and Muslim south, free farmers and other settlers there developed as a distinct class of troops. To promote resettlement and to tie these new and otherwise independent communities to the king, León and Castilla especially granted them privileges, charters of autonomy (*fueros*), and exemption from taxes in exchange for royal military service in times of need, in addition to taking charge of their own defense. Poorer people who could not maintain a horse served as *milites*. Those with enough wealth for a horse formed the *caballería villana* (“villein knights”), also known as *caballería pardos* for their brown leather wear. These in theory responded directly to the king rather than as part of the feudal *mesnadas* of the counts and bishops and could quickly form town militias and large forces of light horsemen for local defense such as against Muslim raiders. [AAJ; DWL pp 99-100; DNC pp 10-11] See also Capability #C20 FUEROS below.

C20. FUEROS – *City codes of law*

Each Levy, remove up to 2 Jihad from a Reconquista Taifa Locale to which Alfonso is closer than any Muslim

Lords. Alfonso.

Tips. Although only Alfonso can Levy and use this Capability, put the FUEROS card at the board edge not at his mat (3.4.4). The Christians may remove the Jihad at any one moment of each Levy, for no actions. They choose which eligible Jihad markers to remove, possibly removing Siege or Bypass (1.4.4). Closer means by the shortest chain of adjacent spaces away. Alfonso in the same Locale as a Muslim Lord is not closer, regardless of who is Sieging or Bypassing.

History. The original common law of Christians particular to León and its recently conquered towns was called the *Fuero Juzgo*. As Christians resettled previously depopulated and now conquered central Spain, the king gave each city a code of law, *fuero*, to set its new social, civic, and military organization and thereby give it autonomy. This included the localities’ military obligations, such as militia service, provision of castle guard, and upkeep of the castle and castellan (see also Capability #C19 CABALLERÍA VILLANA above). This Capability in the game also represents the practice of King Alfonso VI when he conquered new territory from a *taifa*, especially the vast territory of Toledo in 1085, to grant Muslim populations property and religious rights in return for a special tax to him, mirroring the rights granted to Christians under Muslim rule. [AAJ; DWL pp 54, 99; BRb pp 57, 85]

C21. SISNANDO DAÍVEZ – *Mozarab count*

Each Levy, remove up to 1 Jihad from a Locale where no Lord of either side

Lords. Alfonso.

Tips. Although only Alfonso can Levy and use this Capability, place it at the board edge not his mat (3.4.4). The Christians may remove the Jihad at any one moment of each Levy, for no actions. They choose which eligible Jihad marker to remove. A Besieged or Bypassed Locale is not eligible.

History. Sisnando Davídez, Count of Coimbra, was a Christian of northwestern Iberia who had been carried away in a Sevillian slaving raid and then educated in Sevilla, where he rose to the station of general of militia and royal councillor. He eventually entered the service of Leonese kings as ambassador to *taifas*, advisor on strategy against them, and governor of newly won cities or provinces. When Alfonso VI conquered Toledo, Sisnando Davídez was the natural choice to govern it in a manner that would keep the Muslim citizens at peace. [DWL pp 54, 64, 66; JOa p206; BC pp 224, 231-233; IA p43] On relations between rulers and rules of different faiths, see also Christian Event #C21 MOZÁRABES and Muslim Event #M20 MUDEJARES.

C22. BISHOPRICS



Add 1 Bishop each as a Ready Vassal to up to 3 Christian Lords other than Sancho

If card discarded, remove all Bishops

Lords. Not Sancho.

Tips. See 3.4.2 ARTS OF WAR. Put the BISHOPRICS card at the board edge, not at a mat (3.4.4). Add Bishops to any Mustered Christian Lords at any time, no more than one Bishop per Lord. Bishop Vassals then may Muster like other Vassals. Do not put Bishops on the Calendar even if using the Vassal Service advance rule 3.4.2: they are immune to Vassal Service limits.

History. Bishops in Iberia’s Christian north were royal rather than church appointees and, in addition to their religious authority, they saw to defense of their towns, administration of justice, and oversight of their markets. In times of war, bishoprics like counties (about 14 of each across Alfonso’s kingdom as of 1086) would send contingents of troops (*mesnadas*) to the royal army (*hueste real*), including a perhaps a squadron of knights per bishop who mustered. [AAJ; BRb p55; BRa chapter 10 p2; JOB p126]

C23. FONSADEIRA – *Payment in lieu of service*

Your Unbesieged Lords during Muster may exchange Ready non-Bishop Vassals for 1 Coin OR 3 Transport each

Lords. Any Christians.

Tips. Put the FONSADEIRA card at the board edge, not at a mat (3.4.4). See 3.4.3 EXCHANGE VASSAL FOR ASSETS. Any Christian Lords during any Muster segments may make the exchange any number of times, for no actions. They may be Bypassed or at a Neutral or Enemy Locale. Set exchanged Vassal Service markers aside until that Lord Disbands and re-Musters (3.4.1).

History. A failure to fulfil general military service obligations in Christian Spain would incur a fine called *fonsadera* that gradually evolved into a tax payable in coin, pack animals, or supplies in lieu of military service in person (*fossateria* or *fossataria*, scutage). These revenues became highly useful in underwriting campaigns, such as by using them to pay professional soldiers. [AAJ; DWL p100; BRb p57; BRa Ch9 p5; JOB p129; DNc p10]

C24. GARCÍA JIMÉNEZ – Conqueror of Aledo

This Lord's Storm may go 2 extra Rounds

Lords. Pedro Ansúrez, García Ordóñez, Álvar Fáñez, or Rodrigo Campeador.

Tips. The Storm must be on this Lord's card, not just where he is present. Go 2 extra Rounds means, for example, his Storm with one Siege marker could go three Rounds (4.5.2).

History. We know that a noble of León named García Jiménez, probably in early 1086, achieved a daring seizure of Aledo, a spot deep in Muslim territory near Murcia, the loss of which effectively cut southern from eastern *al-Andalus*. (See Christian Event #C6 SURPRISE.) But we know nothing else about this clearly effective commander. García Jiménez from his captured stronghold, which he probably had improved, then raided the Muslims' rich surrounding countryside. Yusuf later led his Almoravids on a second expedition to Iberia to reclaim Aledo. Christian Aledo held Yusuf's siege but took enough damage to convince the Leonese to leave on their own. [Maderuelo.com; BRa Ch9 p10; BRb pp 87, 91; DWL pp 66, 71]

C25. EL CID

This Lord on his Command card may play SWOLLEN RIVER, SURPRISE, CAMP ATTACK, CANTADOR, or BAGGAGE PARAPET from deck

Lords. Rodrigo Campeador.

Tips. EL CID enables the owning player at one moment only during each of Rodrigo's Command cards to search the Arts of War deck (not cards Held or already in play) for one of the listed Events (only) and immediately play it. It may not instead be Held. The Event must at that moment be applicable.

History. Whatever the exaggerations of medieval poetry, the fact that El Cid Rodrigo indeed won all his battles—whether against other Christians, *taifa* armies, or the Almoravids—demonstrates some enormous talent as strategist, tactician, and individual warrior. Indeed, he commanded the only 11th-Century Christian army to defeat the Almoravids in the field, with a surprise attack in the Battle of Cuarte near Valencia in 1094. [Lomax p74] See also the section on El Cid earlier in this booklet.

C26. AL-FARAJ – El Cid's Muslim lieutenant

This Lord may use Command card at or adjacent to Muslim Lord to cause Muslims to discard 1 random Held card

Lords. Rodrigo Campeador.

Tips. Rodrigo with AL-FARAJ may use all actions on his own Command card while in the same Locale as or adjacent to any Enemy Lord for the player with Rodrigo to blindly draw, inspect, and discard one of the other side's Held cards.

History. As the Almoravids from 1091 began to depose one *taifa* emir after another, Alfonso would dispatch Rodrigo's Muslim lieutenant al-Faraj and a small Christian garrison to Valencia to represent the Cid's power to the Muslim populace and thereby back up the rule of the unpopular al-Qadir. In 1092, a pro-Almoravid faction finally overthrew al-Qadir and arrested al-Faraj. Rodrigo over the next two years campaigned against the city and in 1094 took it, garrisoned it with Arabic-speaking Christian troops, and installed al-Faraj as city administrator. With Valencia's Muslim citizenry thus secured, the Cid turned back a massive Almoravid effort to retake the city. [BC pp 246-247] The AL-FARAJ Capability represents Rodrigo's apparent genius, having by the mid-1080s already served with both Christian and Muslim warriors, to fuse, exploit, and counter the best tactics of each.

Muslim Events

(top half of card)

M1. HILLS

Hold: May play if Defending in Battle – Muslims' Slingers are x1½ and their other Missiles are x1 (not x½)

Lords. All Muslims (including Rodrigo al-Sayyid).

Tips and History. See Christian Event #C1 HILLS.

M2. CAMP ATTACK

Hold: May play in Battle – Unless BAGGAGE PARAPET, Round 1, take 2 Assets from each Enemy Lord there as Spoils, remove 2 more from each

Lords. All Christians.

Tips. See Christian Events #C2 CAMP ATTACK and #C7 BAGGAGE PARAPET. See also Muslim Capabilities #M8 DAWUD IBN AISHA and #M25 EL CID.

History. At Sagradas, Yusuf sent Moroccan regiments to support al-Mutamid in the front line while Saharans possibly led by Dawud flanked it to attack Alfonso's camp from the rear. As Álvar routed from the Christian front, Yusuf committed his black African guard to press in on Alfonso defending the camp. As the Africans overran the laager, Alfonso barely made his escape, suffering a serious wound and the slaughter of as much as half of his field army. [AAJ; DWL p70; BRa chapter 10 p3; BRb p89] See also Muslim Capability #M8 DAWUD IBN AISHA and Christian Event #C7 BAGGAGE PARAPET.

M3. SWOLLEN RIVER

Hold: Unless a Lord there has ADALIDES, play to block March on a Command card OR to block Avoid Battle

Lords. All Christians.

Tips and History. See Christian Event #C3 SWOLLEN RIVER. Any play at a Locale where a Christian Lord has Capability #C3/C10 ADALIDES is canceled; if SWOLLEN RIVER played, discard it without effect. See also Muslim Capability #M25 EL CID.

M4. ARID TERRAIN

Hold: May play as Christians March – They immediately Feed 2 Marching Lords

Lords. Any Christians.

Tips and History. See Christian Event #C4 ARID TERRAIN. (The only difference is that Christians have no CAMELS.)

M5. DROUGHT

Christians immediately Feed 2 of their Lords not at Friendly Gardens or Seat

Lords. Any Christians.

Tips. See Christian Event #C5 DROUGHT.

History. See Christian Event #C4 ARID TERRAIN.

M6. FEIGNED RETREAT

Hold: May play in Battle – On Round 2, all Muslim Melee Strikes before all Christian Melee

Lords. All Muslims.

Tips. Play FEIGNED RETREAT at the outset of Battle Attack or Defense (4.4.1 Events), not in Storm. The Event alters the Initiative order during Round 2 only of that Battle. After Missiles as usual, instead of Defending then Attacking Horse then Defending then Attacking Foot (4.4.2 Initiative), all Muslim Horse and Foot Melee Strike, then all Christian units Melee Strike, regardless of which side is that Attacker. See also Muslim Capabilities #M8 DAWUD IBN AISHA and #M25 EL CID.

History. We do not know whether the Muslims feigned a retreat in any engagement during 1085-1086. Most historians judge that the rout toward Badajoz of the Muslim first line of *taifa* forces in the face of Christian heavy horse at Sagrajas was quite genuine. Joseph O’Callaghan in *Reconquest and Crusade in Medieval Spain*, however, suggests that Yusuf’s generalship and overconfidence on the part of Alfonso played out in a feigned Muslim retreat that helped decide that battle:

The Muslim tactic of giving way and feigning retreat evidently fooled the Christians at Zallaqa [Sagrajas] and Alarcos [a battle in 1195], who were then surrounded as the enemy swept around their flanks. [JOb p143]

In a feigned retreat, a large portion of an army would pretend to be running away in order to fool and lure an attacker into a pursuit that would over-extend and disorder him and enable a counter-strike with surprise. This stratagem is not to be confused with *tornafuye*—evasion tactics rather than a deception, used by individual light cavalry units, especially Berbers (see Muslim Capability #M10 ANDALUSIANS).

M7. SPEAR WALL



Hold: May play in Battle – Any 1 Round 2 Muslim Lords’ Armored Foot units have Armor +1 against Horse Melee (mark)

Lords. Any Muslims.

Tips. Play SPEAR WALL at the outset of Battle Attack or Defense (4.4.1 Events), not in Storm. The Muslim player puts one Spear Wall marker each on the mats of two Muslim Lords in the Battle. At any time during any one Battle Round only, the Muslim player declares Spear Wall to be in effect. For the rest of that Round only, those two Lords’ Men-at-Arms and African Foot units have Armor +1 when rolling Protection against Melee Strikes from Christian Horse (4.4.2 Initiative). Armor 1-3 becomes Armor 1-4, Armor 1-2 becomes 1-3, for example. At the end of that Round, flip the Spear Wall markers to Used. See also Muslim Capabilities #M8 DAWUD IBN AISHA and #M25 EL CID.

History. Contemporary writer Abu Bakr al-Turtushi describes Muslim drilled-infantry tactics to withstand knights’ charges, probably those used by the Almoravids at Sagrajas:

The infantry with their shields, lances, and iron-tipped and penetrating javelins are formed in several ranks. Their lances rest obliquely on their shoulders, the shaft touching the ground, the point aimed at the enemy. Each one kneels ... on his left knee and holds his shield in the air. Behind the infantry are the elite archers, whose arrows can pierce coats of mail. Behind the archers are the cavalry ... When the enemy comes near, the archers let fly against them a shower of arrows, while the infantry throw their javelins and receive the charge on the points of their lances. Then infantry and archers ... open their ranks to right and left and the Muslim cavalry [charges] through the open space ... [JOb p141]

No doubt as an aid to the stoutness of such a phalanx, the Almoravids’ African foot carried tall, thick shields (*lamt*) of layered hides of the oryx (desert antelope) or of hippopotamus. [DWL p70; DNm pp 18, 23; JM pp 16, 25, 27, 48, 51]

M8. AHMAD IBN RUMAYLA – *Ascetic faqih of Córdoba*

Hold: Play in Taifa with Yusuf, Sir, or al-Mutamid to remove Conquered from empty Town OR add 2 Jihad

Lords. Yusuf, Sir, or al-Mutamid.

Tips. Empty Town means where no Lords of either side. The Muslim player may add the Jihad to any eligible Locale(s) per rule 1.4.4 “Important” that are within the same Taifa as Yusuf or Sir.

History. With the arrival of the Almoravids in *taifa al-Andalus*, Islamic jurists (*faqih*s) played their part in ensuring that the spirit of holy struggle (*jihad*) against the Christians would root and grow. See Events #M10 FATWA and #M21 AL-SUMAISIR below. On the night before Sagrajas, with Muslim and Christian armies encamped three miles apart, *faqih* and ascetic Abu al-Abbas Ahmad ibn Rumayla of Córdoba, in the camp of his emir al-Mutamid, got up in joy, saying that he had seen the Prophet who had announced to him victory and his martyrdom on the following morning. He made ready for it, praying and perfuming his hair. Al-Mutamid promptly passed the good omen on to Yusuf. [AAJ; BC pp 246, 251-252]

M9. MALIKI ISLAM

Hold: Play to add 2 Jihad if Yusuf or Sir in a Reconquista Taifa OR 4 Jihad if in a Kingdom

Lords. Yusuf or Sir.

Tips. The Muslim player may add the Jihad to any eligible Locale(s) per rule 1.4.4 “Important” regardless of which Reconquista Taifa or Kingdom Yusuf or Sir occupies.

History. The Berber tribal confederacy that grew into the Almoravid Empire first encountered the Maliki school of Sunni Islam that defended literal interpretation of the Koran around 1035. The union of Maliki thought as a religious base with a tribal political force spurred and enabled the Almoravids’ imposition of their beliefs on vast territories. In *al-Andalus*, the pure and victorious Almoravids could appeal to the religious scholars and devout subjects of the corrupted *taifa* emirs to fight for their faith and resist Christian unbelievers. [AAJ; BC pp252-253; BRb pp100-101; DWL p68]

M10. FATWA

Hold: Play to add 1 Jihad OR add 1 Jihad for each—Yusuf and/or Sir in any Kingdom, Eudes plus each Crusaders on map

Lords. Yusuf or Sir; Eudes.

Tips. The Muslim player may add the Jihad to any eligible Locale(s) per rule 1.4.4 “Important”. The maximum number of Jihad markers added would be four: one if Yusuf or Sir is in a Kingdom, plus one if Eudes is on map, plus one for each of two Crusader Vassals Mustered with any Christian Lords.

History. From the moment that the Almoravid army landed on the peninsula, Islamic authorities there began to appeal to Yusuf and against the *taifa* emirs in the cause of resistance to Christian conquest. Islamic judges (*qadi*) and legal scholars (*faqih*) condemned the emirs and issued religious justifications (*fatwa*) for Yusuf’s actions, such as his seizure of Algeciras from Sevilla. In 1090, Andalusian *faqih* would craft a *fatwa* to annul all Yusuf’s treaties with the *taifa* emirs and confirming his duty to depose them. [BRb pp 103-104; BC pp 232, 255] See also Events #M8 AHMAD IBN RUMAYLA and #M21 AL-SUMAISIR.

M11. AL-QADIR balks at payment

Hold: Play to add 1 Jihad OR— if Yusuf or Sir in any Reconquista or Parias Taifa or Kingdom—3 Jihad

Lords. Yusuf or Sir.

Tips. The Muslim player may add the Jihad to any eligible Locale(s) per rule 1.4.4 “Important” regardless of which Reconquista or Parias Taifa or Kingdom Yusuf or Sir occupies.

History. The puppet emir al-Qadir while under protection of Álvaro Fáñez in Valencia in the late spring and summer of 1086 refused to pay for the maintenance of the Christian forces. It was not just a dismissal of a mercenary captain but an abortive attempt at a policy independent of his overlord King Alfonso. Since al-Qadir proved unequal to his ambitions, his effort proved insignificant. But it did move Alfonso to take the deposed son of the late Abu Bakr under his protection as insurance against possible repetition of such an attempt. [AAJ; BRa Ch9 p9] See also Geography—*Taifa* of Toledo earlier in this booklet and Christian Event #C20 AL-QADIR – PUPPET EMIR.

M12. TAIFA MARRIAGE

Hold: Play to shift 2 Taifa Lords’ cylinder or Service by 1 Calendar box each OR for one to use Lordship +2

Lords. Taifa Muslims.

Tips. The Muslim player may play at any time to select up to two Taifa Lords in the game and, for each, shift his cylinder left if on the Calendar or Service right if the Lord is on the map. For Lordship, play during the Muslim Muster segment (3.4).

History. See Geography—Taifa of Valencia earlier in this booklet. [AAJ; BRa Ch9 p5; BRb p86]

M13. SEVERED HEADS

Hold: Play as Ravaging to shift 1 Taifa Lord’s cylinder or Service 2 boxes OR add 2 Jihad

OR play if Christians Retreat or Sacked for 2 Lords OR 4 Jihad

Lords. Taifa Muslims.

Tips. The Muslim player may play the card at any moment that a Muslim Lord succeeds in a Ravage action (4.7.2, not placing Ravage by Event). Ravage that has no effect because of Christian Capability #C19 CABALLERÍA VILLANA does not allow SEVERED HEADS. Alternatively, the Muslim player may play the card for the greater reward listed at any moment that any Christian Lord(s) are forced to Retreat from Battle (4.4.3, including elimination for failure to Retreat but not including Withdrawal into a Stronghold) or that a Christian Stronghold is Sacked (4.5.2). Shift Taifa Lord cylinder(s) left or Service right. Add Jihad markers per 1.4.4 “Important”.

History. After Sagradas, the Almoravids loaded piles of heads from the Christian dead onto carts and sent them around the cities of *al-Andalus* and to Africa to amplify to the faithful the completeness of the victory. Whether from that or other propaganda, it became increasingly perilous for *taifa* emirs to pay *parias* to infidel kings. [JOa p209; DWL pp 70, 105; BRa chapter 10 p4; BC p254; IA p44]

M14. DEVALUATION

Each Locale where Christian Lords have Coin, they reduce their total there to half (rounded up)

Lords. All Christians.

Tips. Total the Coin of all Lords at each Locale separately. The Christian player immediately removes Coin from Christian mats until the amount at each Locale is half of the original total, rounded up. For example, if Alfonso has two Coin and Pedro at the same Locale has one, the Christian player would remove any one Coin from one them.

History. The Christian kingdoms’ economy originally lacked much coin and so relied on exchange of goods or favors. With the influx of Arab coin via *parias*, the Christians created their own albeit inferior coin as well. Alfonso VI issued pennies of *vellón* copper and silver alloy, while Sancho I originated the silver *jaqueses* coinage of Jaca. Coinage increased efficiency of trade and military preparations, but the diminishing weight and decreasing amount of gold relative to silver in the *taifas*’ alloyed dinars led to devaluation. Moreover, Alfonso VI’s father Fernan-

do I had begun annual gold payments to his Cluniac allies and the enlargement of their French monastery, and Alfonso upped these amounts until they used up the greater part of incoming *parias* tribute—all to the discomfort of the Christian counts and their economy. [AAJ; BRb pp 58-59; JOB p152; IA p37] See also Christian Event #C10 DEVALUATION.

M15. PARIAS REVOLT – *Subjects resent tax*

Hold: Play to add 1 Jihad in Parias Taifa, OR 2 Jihad at Jihad there, OR 3 Jihad if Yusuf or Sir there

Lords. Yusuf or Sir.

Tips. For adding Jihad, see 1.4.4 “Important”. At Jihad means at a Stronghold that already has at least one Jihad marker.

History. Instability and intrigue characterized the *taifas*, and revolts were frequent against weak emirs. One nettlesome issue between lord and subjects was the taxes that had to be imposed to make good the exorbitant *parias* payments to Christians. *Parias* revolts were rocking Muslim cities by the mid-1070s. Resentment over the tribute to Alfonso and the presence and expense of Christian garrisons almost certainly played a role in a revolt against al-Qadir in Toledo in 1082. And the prospect of a resumption of *parias* probably did the same in the case of Játiva’s rebellion in early 1086 against al-Qadir as the newly installed Emir of Valencia. The Almoravids in contrast offered financial relief along with moral purity: as they later conquered the *taifas*, they would abolish all non-Koranic taxes. [IA p37; BRa pp 81, 87; DWL p70]

M16. GALICIAN REVOLT

Shift Service of Ansúrez, Ordóñez, OR Fañez by 1 box left

This Levy, no Muster of or by Alfonso

Lords. Pedro Ansúrez, García Ordóñez, or Álvaro Fáñez; Alfonso.

Tips. The Muslim player selects one Mustered Lord from among the three listed (if any); his Service marker shifts one box left on the Calendar (if using the Advanced Vassal Service advanced rule 3.4.2, his Vassals’ markers too). Alfonso this Levy may neither become Mustered nor take Levy actions himself. Keep the card near the other side’s mats area for the rest of the current Levy; its Capability is unavailable this turn (3.1.3).

History. On the heels of his defeat at the hands of the Almoravids, Alfonso in 1087 suffered a serious revolt in the northwest. See Geography—Kingdom of León earlier in this booklet. [AAJ; BRa chapter 10 p6; BRb pp 90-91] Had resentments there bubbled over earlier, they surely would have drawn off from his campaigns in Toledo, Zaragoza, and Badajoz.

M17. LEÓN Y CASTILLA – *Rivalry*

Shift Service of Ansúrez, Ordóñez, Fañez, OR Rodrigo Campeador 1 box left

This Levy, no Muster of or by them

Lords. Pedro Ansúrez, García Ordóñez, Álvaro Fáñez, or Rodrigo Campeador.

Tips. See Muslim Event #M16 GALICIAN REVOLT above. LEÓN Y CASTILLA works the same but applied to the Muslim player’s choice of one of the four listed Lords for the Service shift and all four of them for the ban on Muster.

History. See Geography—Kingdom of León earlier in this booklet. [AAJ; BC p229]

M18. REFUGEES

Hold: Play in Muster for each Unbesieged Taifa Lord to restore all Lost Unarmored units and add 1 Transport

Lords. Taifa Muslims.

Tips. See 3.4.2 ARTS OF WAR. The Muslim side may play REFUGEES during its Muster segment. All Taifa Lords who are on the map and Unbesieged (even if Bypassed or at Neutral or Enemy Locales) add Unarmored units (Light Horse and Militia) to their Forces equal in number and type to those lost from their starting Forces and Mustered Vassals. Determine lost units by comparing the Lord’s current Forces units to the sum of those pictured on the mat plus pictured on his currently Mustered Vassal Service markers. Then choose and add either a Cart or a Mule to each Unbesieged Taifa Lord on the map.

History. Alfonso’s seizure of Toledo brought sudden Christian rule over a massive Muslim population. Despite the King’s initially tolerant policies, many artisans and common people and most of Toledo’s intellectual elite migrated south to the benefit of *taifa* manpower and civil capacity. [BC p232]

M19. AFRICAN FLEET



Hold: Play for a Lord to use his Command card to March between two Ports where no Christian Lord

Lords. Any Muslim.

Tips. The movement counts as a March for Group March (4.3.1), Laden (4.3.2), and Feed (4.3, 4.8.1) but takes up all actions of a Command card and moves directly between any two Ports free of Enemy Lords rather than across a Way (4.3.3). If the destination is an Enemy Stronghold, Besiege or Bypass it normally (4.3.5). See also Muslim Capability #M25 EL Cid.

History. From the 9th Century on, North Africans led in naval warfare (including, among many innovations, the first effective beach-landing horse transport in history, called *tarida*). [DNm 19-20] In 1083, Yusuf’s army by land with the help of al-Mutamid’s Sevillian fleet from the sea captured Ceuta (*Sabta*), just across the water from Iberia. This fortified port came with a substantial fleet that would make the Almoravids’ later intervention in *al-Andalus* and conquest of an empire there operationally and logistically feasible. [AAJ; BRa chapter 9 p4; BRb pp 102-103; JOa p208; BC p274]

M20. MUDÉJARES – *Subject Muslims*

Hold: Play to add 1 Jihad in Reconquista Taifa, OR 2 Jihad at Jihad there, OR 3 Jihad if Yusuf or Sir there

Lords. Yusuf or Sir.

Tips. For adding Jihad, see 1.4.4 “Important”. At Jihad means at a Stronghold that already has at least one Jihad marker.

History. The fall of Toledo put a large population of Muslims under Christian rule, known as *mudéjares*. Such Muslim communities in Christian Spain became second-class citizens and later would occasionally rebel against imposition of Christian laws, such as occurred in the Guadalquivir valley in 1264. Alfonso in 1085 initially pursued a tolerant and protective policy over the *mudéjares*. But Cluniac influence as demonstrated in the seizure and conversion of Toledo’s great mosque, other pressures to Christianize the reconquest such as the budding spirit of crusade seeping in from France, and the fundamentalist call of the Almoravids already in 1086 raised the prospect of subject Muslim unrest. (See also Christian Event #C21 MOZÁRABES and Christian Capability #C16 CATHEDRALS.) [AAJ; JVB; BC pp 265, 297, 318-320, 328-330]

M21. AL-SUMAISIR – *Poet reproaches emirs*

Hold: Play to Muster Taifa Lord from Calendar OR add 2 Jihad in Parias Taifa—4 Jihad if Yusuf or Sir there

Lords. Yusuf or Sir; Taifa Muslim.

Tips. For Muster of a Taifa Lord, see 3.4.1 ARTS OF WAR: it may be any Lord with a cylinder anywhere on the Calendar without rolling or using any Levy action, but otherwise per 3.4.1. For adding Jihad, see 1.4.4 “Important”.

History. Muslim poetry burgeoned in the political tumult of *taifa al-Andalus*, and Andalusian poets voiced politics. Their thrust and effect in the late 11th Century was to steel the faithful against the Christian onslaught. Ibn al-Gassal (Ibn al-Assal al-Yahsubi) warned after the fall of Toledo:

O people of al-Andalus, spur on your mounts;
It is nothing but a blunder to stay on here.
A robe unravels from its edges,
But I see the robe of the peninsula unravelled from the center.
We are caught up with an enemy who will not leave us alone:
How can one live in a basket together with snakes?

Taifa poets celebrated Sagradas with victory odes. As Almoravid intervention increasingly offered a devout alternative, poets and jurists would urge resistance to any emirs still paying *parias*. The poet al-Sumaisir wrote:

To revolt against you is a duty, for you make common cause
with the Christians. To withdraw from your allegiance is not
a crime, for you yourselves have withdrawn your allegiance
to the Prophet.

[IA p24; JOa pp 208, 210; MW p14; DWL pp 70-71; BC pp 232, 254; DNm p11] See also Events #M8 AHMAD IBN RUMAYLA and #M10 FATWA.

M22. MASSACRE

If Eudes or Crusaders on map, Muster a Taifa Lord from Calendar OR add 3 Jihad

If not, add 1 Jihad

Lords. Eudes; Taifa Muslim.

Tips. For adding Jihad, see 1.4.4 “Important”. For Muster of a Taifa Lord, see 3.4.1 ARTS OF WAR: it may be any Lord with a cylinder anywhere on the Calendar without rolling or using any Levy action, but otherwise per 3.4.1.

History. See Christian Event #C9 BETRAYAL OF TERMS. The sack and massacre of Muslim Barbastro by Christians from across the Pyrenees in 1064 was a harbinger of an increasingly zealous nature to fighting between Christians and Muslims on the Peninsula. The news shocked Andalusians, who recruited an army to retake the town and slaughter the Christian conquerors there in return. [BC p241; IA p26] The advent of crusade and the fundamentalism of Almoravid intervention fed one another. After the Muslim victors of Sagradas paraded off heads of the Christian fallen (see Muslim event #13), Christians would mimic the grisly practice to celebrate victories of their own. [DWL p105] Had the early 1087 French-Burgundian crusade that answered Alfonso’s call actually succeeded in taking a Muslim stronghold, atrocities and further escalation would have been highly likely.

M23. BERENGUER RAMON

If COUNT OF BARCELONA with Christians, they discard card

If not, a Lord may Levy this card and its units now for 1 Asset

Lords. Sancho or Eudes (al-Mustain or al-Mundir).

Tips. See Christian Event #C13 BERENGUER RAMON.

History. See Geography—The Catalan Counties earlier in this booklet. [AAJ]

M24. AL-MAGHAWIR – *Frontier raiders*

Unless CABALLERÍA VILLANA, place Ravaged at 2 Unravaged Enemy Locales adjacent to Friendly Locales

Lords. None.

Tips. If CABALLERÍA VILLANA is in play, discard AL-MAGHAWIR without effect. If not, put one green Ravaged marker at each of two Locales that are currently Friendly to the Christians (not Neutral, 1.3.1, 1.4.1), are adjacent to at least one Locale Friendly to the Muslims (even if Besieged), and have no Ravaged marker already. The two markers add a total of +1 Muslim VP (5.1). This is not a Ravage Command action and so does not add Loot or Provender (4.7.2).

History. While the *taifa* period saw the advantage in raiding warfare pass to the Christians, the Muslims had centuries of tradition of doing the same (*al-garada*) against the Christian north. The name of the later famous Christian *almogáveres* light guerrilla infantry probably derived from the Arabic term *al-maghawir*, meaning “rioter” or “raider”. [AAJ; RBS p14]

M25 & M26. FREEBOOTER

Disband Rodrigo Campeador as if at Service Limit (3.3.2)

If desired, remove 1VP from Taifas box to replace him on Calendar with Rodrigo al-Sayyid

Lords. Rodrigo Campeador and Rodrigo al-Sayyid.

Tips. If (yellow) Rodrigo Campeador is on map, his Disband per 3.3.2 is immediate and mandatory, placing his cylinder two boxes ahead on the Calendar. Then, if Rodrigo Campeador's cylinder is now somewhere on the Calendar (however that occurred), the Muslim player may expend one Taifas Box Conquered/1VP marker (adjusting score, 5.1) to replace the yellow Rodrigo cylinder with the green Rodrigo cylinder in the same Calendar box.

History. See Christian Event #C26 FREEBOOTER and Lord Histories – El Cid earlier in this booklet.

Muslim Capabilities

(bottom half of card)

M1. BATTERING RAM

This Lord at Siege counts as 2 Lords and may reroll 1 Surrender die per Muslim Siege action

Lords. Taifa Muslim or Rodrigo al-Sayyid.

Tips and History. See Christian Capability #C1 BATTERING RAM. Andalusian armies featured siege engines in the same fashion as those of Christian armies. [DNc p9]

M2. AQQARA – Crossbows

This Lord's Men-at-Arms and Militia have Missiles x½ that select target units, –1 to target's Armor

Lords. Taifa Muslim or Rodrigo al-Sayyid.

Tips and History. See Christian Capability #C2 BALLESTEROS. Historian David Nicolle deems the crossbow in a simple form called *aqqara* as already the most important infantry weapon of the *taifas*. [DNc p14; DNm p21]

M3 & M6. HARBAH – Javelins



Up to 4 of this Lord's Unarmored units have Missiles x1 on any 1 Battle Round, Missiles x½ if Storm (mark)

Lords. Taifa Muslim or Rodrigo.

Tips. See Christian Capability #C7 JABALINAS. Javelin use is by Lord; if a Lord with Harbah and another with African Horse are in the same Battle or Storm, each may use his Javelins on a different Round (4.4.2 Javelins). A Lord may have only one HARBAH card (3.4.4).

History. Andalusian troops used a variety of javelins, the most common being a heavy, bladed type called *harbah*. [DNm p12; JM pp 41-44] Almoravid light horse included javelins for rapid strike and withdrawal tactics, and African foot carried them as well (called *mizraq*), represented in the game by the inherent Missile abilities of African Horse and Foot units rather than a

Capability card. [AAJ; JM p51; JOB p141; DNm p23] See also Christian Capability #C7 JABALINAS.

M4 & M5. ALRAMA – Bowmen

This Lord's Foot and Light Horse have Missiles x½

Lords. Taifa Muslim or Rodrigo al-Sayyid.

Tips. See Christian Capability #C4 ARQUEROS. A Lord may have only one ALRAMA card (3.4.4).

History. Muslim armies made great use of archers. Foot archers with large composite and semi-composite Arab bows had constituted a military mainstay for 10th-Century *al-Andalus*. [DNm p43] The later Andalusian *taifas*' light horse used bows as well as javelins. [JM p41] Interestingly, the Almoravid army may have had several hundred female archers, traditional among forces from Ghana [MW p21]; the game represents them among the bowmen inherent to African Foot units rather than via Capability cards.

M7. SLINGERS

Up to 3 Militia of this Lord have Missiles x1 in Battle, Missiles x½ in Storm

Lords. Taifa Muslim or Rodrigo al-Sayyid.

Tips and History. See Christian Capability #C9 SLINGERS. Andalusian militias employed slingers, especially from the Balearic Islands, as skirmishers. Berbers had a tradition of using massed slinger infantry against enemy horse, so the Missile abilities of the African units in the game probably would include a portion of slingers. [JM p42; DN *Moors* p17]

M8. DAWUD IBN AISHA – Almoravid general

This Lord's Supply adds 1 extra Prov

In Battle, play FEIGNED RETREAT, SPEAR WALL, or CAMP ATTACK from deck

Lords. Yusuf or Sir.

Tips. To benefit from extra Provender, a Lord with DAWUD IBN AISHA must carry out a Supply action (4.6.1) and so may not be Besieged. Add +1 Prov means that, if the Supply action were out of reach of any Source, it would add one Provender instead of zero. The Lord gains an extra Provender each of his Supply actions; that may be several per card. In each Battle (not Storm) involving this Lord, the Muslim player at the moment of playing Battle Events (4.4.1 Event) may search the Muslim Arts of War deck (not cards otherwise in play) for one of the listed Events (only) and immediately play it. It may not be Held.

History. The Almoravid army in mid-1086 began landing on the Iberian Peninsula at Algeciras ahead of the arrival of Yusuf himself. Dawud ibn Aisha commanded this advance force and bid its governor, al-Mutamid's son al-Radi, to evacuate it, which he did. Yusuf then ordered Dawud to move towards *Sevilla* to concentrate *taifa* allies. Dawud fought at Sagrajas that October, possibly at the head of the flanking maneuver that helped rout the Christians or, alternatively, helping to steady the center as the Sevillans were close to breaking. [AAJ]

M9. EMIR AL-MUSLIMIN

This Lord is closer than any Christian to Jihad-eligible Locale (1.4.4) may use his Command card to add 1 Jihad there

Lords. Yusuf.

Tips. Closer means by the shortest chain of adjacent spaces away. Yusuf in the same Locale as a Christian Lord is not closer, regardless of who is Sieging or Bypassing. Placing Jihad requires Yusuf's entire Command card. See rule 1.4.4 "Important" for what is Jihad-eligible.

History. Almoravid leader Yusuf declared himself *Emir al-Muslimin*—Commander of the Faithful—a universal sovereign with authority over all the Muslims, whether under taifa, Christian, or already Almoravid control. The title would legitimize Yusuf's subsequent campaign to conquer the *taifas* and put the Almoravids' new Iberian empire in direct challenge to Alfonso, who had earlier with similar ambition declared himself *Imperator totius Hispaniae*—emperor over Iberians of all religions. [BC p255; AAJ; JM p47]

M10. ANDALUSIANS – Nimble horses

All Muslim Light Horse Evade 1-3 (vs Melee in Battle)

Lords. Taifa Muslims and Rodrigo al-Sayyid.

Tips. ANDALUSIANS goes at the board edge, not at a mat (3.4.4). While this Capability is in play, all Light Horse of all Taifa Muslim Lords and of Rodrigo al-Sayyid (only) have Evade 1-3 Protection against Melee Hits in all Battles (4.4.2 Evade). Note that ANDALUSIANS combined with ALRAMA or JAVELINS turn Muslim Light Horse in effect into even better African Horse.

History. The Iberian Muslims' agile Arab horses were ideal for the *tornafuye* (or *torno fuya*, Arabic *karr wa farr*)—a light-horse unit tactic of closing with enemy heavy cavalry or infantry, loosing projectiles (typically javelins), and then pulling back before the knights or infantry could respond. (This tactic is not to be confused with the larger feigned retreat deception or the flanking maneuver against the enemy camp, each of which also took advantage of nimble horses and characterized Muslim warfare; see Events #M6 FEIGNED RETREAT and #M2 CAMP ATTACK.) Separate from the ANDALUSIANS Capability, the game grants all African Horse inherent Evade and Javelin abilities, representing the standard tactics of the Almoravids' numerous and maneuverable Maghrebi cavalry. [JM p37; DNc pp 4-5; AAJ]

M11 & M21. HASHAM – Elite guard

This Lord with Horse Command +1

Lords. Any Muslim.

Tips. Command +1 means that a Lord with a Command rating of "2" instead could take three Command actions on his card, for example (1.5.3, 1.4.1). A Lord with HASHAM receives the added Command with even a single Horse unit of any type on his mat. A Lord may have only one HASHAM card (3.4.4).

History. Muslims lords cultivated warrior elites and bodyguards called *hasham*, similar if less class-differentiated than the *mesnadas* of Christian magnates. Towns were the main source of Mus-

lim manpower, and infantry became more important as the *taifas* went on the military defensive. But the most prestigious troops remained cavalry, and their skills, organization, equipment, and ideals were near comparable to the Christian knights. Across the sea, Almoravid Yusuf ibn Tashufin reorganized what had been a tribal military structure to create a personal force of foreigners and black Africans, a *hasham* guard of 500 non-Berber horsemen and some 2,000 African infantry or possibly cavalry. [DNc pp 14-15; DNm p22; JM p51] See also Christian Capability #C11/C12 MESNADA.

M12. AL-YAZIRAT AL-HADRA – Almoravid bastion



Flip Yusuf and Sir Seat markers to 2 Seats

If card discarded, flip back to 1 Seat

Lords. Yusuf and Sir.

Tips. AL-YAZIRAT AL-HADRA goes at the board edge, not at a mat (3.4.4). While this Capability is in play, Yusuf's and Sir's Seat markers whenever and wherever on the map, use their two-Seat side. The Locale serves as two Sources for Supply actions by that Lord (4.6.1).

History. As Yusuf answered al-Mutamid's call to arms, he would not only borrow the emir's port of Algeciras to disembark his army, he would seize it for himself as what would become a permanent base for Almoravid operations on the Peninsula. Part of the reason it took some three months for Yusuf's great host to get from there to Badajoz and the field of Sagradas was that the Sultan first ordered the port to be fortified to ensure a logistical base and refuge under secure friendly control. [BRa chapter 10 p1]

M13. SIEGE TOWERS

This Lord at Storm from Round 2 on weakens Enemy Stronghold to Walls –1

Lords. Taifa Muslim or Rodrigo al-Sayyid.

Tips and History. See Christian Capability #C6 SIEGE TOWERS.

M14 & M18. RIBAT MONKS patrol the frontier



Christian Ravage in this Lord's Taifa must roll 1-3 for effect (mark)

Lords. Taifa Muslim.

Tips. Place a reminder marker in the affected Taifa. The Capability affects Ravage Command actions, not placement of Ravaged markers by Event. Christians roll as they expend each action. A Lord may have only one RIBAT MONKS card.

History. Alfonso's advances against the *taifas* fed a sense among Muslims that they needed to take defense into their own hands. Many stepped forward to serve in the traditional monastic forts (*ribat*) that were now springing up all along the northern frontier. (The term "Almoravid" derives from the Arabic *al-Murabitun*, meaning the volunteers who dwelled in such small *ribat* border fortresses, because *ribat* in the southwestern Sahara served as early bases for the movement.) [BC pp 252-253; IA p39; DWL p68; Reilly p101; DNm pp 10, 14]

M15. SAQALIBAH – *Slav troops*

This Lord may Muster 2 Men-at-Arms (once, free)

If card discarded, remove them

Lords. Taifa Muslim.

Tips. See 3.4.2 ARTS OF WAR. The Taifa Lord with this Capability during a Muster segment in which he is eligible per 3.4 “Important” may pay for the units, for no actions. Sharing and Taifas box apply (1.3.3, 1.5.2). Discard removes the same number of units from that Lord’s mat.

History. In the early centuries of *al-Andalus*, Arabs brought in enslaved Crimean, Balkan, and other Slavs (Arabic *saqalibah*), mainly boys to be raised as not only as servants but as soldiers and administrators. Muslim *saqalibah* rose to positions of power under the Caliph, especially as military commanders. When the Iberian Caliphate broke apart, such Slavs took over control of *taifas* along the eastern coast—ruling Valencia, Denia, and Tortosa. (See also Christian Event #C22 BERBERS.) Slavs, still enslaved or as mercenaries, continued to serve as soldiers just as under the Caliph, probably most often as medium or heavy guard foot troops. [IA p19; BC pp148-150; BRb p13; JM p34; DNm p20; RBS pp 14, 17; “Slavs of Muslim Spain” at <http://michalw.narod.ru/SlavicSpain.html>]

M16. CAMELS

Discard to ignore ARID TERRAIN or DROUGHT

Yusuf and Sir Mules count double for move and Supply

Lords. All Muslims; Yusuf and Sir.

Tips. See Christian Events #C4 ARID TERRAIN and #C5 DROUGHT; the Christian player may not retract play of one of those Events if the Muslim side has and discards CAMELS. CAMELS goes at the board edge, not at a mat (3.4.4). With CAMELS, Mules (only, not Carts) on Yusuf and Sir’s mats (only) carry twice the amount of Provender (4.3.2) and reach twice as far to Supply Sources (4.6.1) but Muster and Feed normally (3.4.3, 4.8.1).

History. Numerous historians on the period describe the Almoravid army’s use of camels. [Lomax p69; JOB p132; BC p254; DN Cid p15; DN *Moors* p23] Earlier and later African armies entering Spain did so: a 12th-Century writer describes such an army marching against Alfonso VII with “great caravans of camels loaded with flour and all food that is eaten”. [B&F pp 226, 238, 241] That said, for the Almoravids of 1086, camels almost certainly were a secondary element only, since horses had gradually replaced camels as the *Murabitun* spread their empire northward. [Vincent Lagardere, *Les Almoravides jusqu’au règne de Yūsuf B. Tāšfīn (1039-1106)*] Camels to mount cavalry (rather than as pack animals), while described in some modern histories, seems unlikely in any significant number. [AAJ]

M17. ARRADA – *Catapults & mangonels*

This Lord at Storm or when Sallying adds 3 Missile Hits per Round with –2 to Enemy Armor

Lords. Taifa Muslim or Rodrigo al-Sayyid.

Tips. Any Lord with ARRADA at a Storm Locale adds the Hits; it need not be the Lord taking the Storm action, and it may be during Christian Storm (4.5.2). Similarly, add the Hits so long as the Lord with ARRADA is Attacking during a Sally (4.5.3, not once he Routs). Relief Sally (4.4.1) counts as Sally for use of ARRADA so long as this Lord is among those joining the Attack. During the Muslims’ Missiles step (4.4.2), add an extra three Hits to Muslim Missile Hits (if any). Armor 1-3 against those three Hits becomes Armor 1, for example, Armor 1-4 becomes 1-2.

History. The wealthy *taifa* states often put considerable effort into fortifications and siegecraft, and this included equipping garrisons with sophisticated devices. The defenses of *taifa* Zaragoza and Granada both featured *arrada* stone-throwing engines, probably light catapults mounted on towers along the city walls. Twenty mangonels equipped Zaragoza’s garrison in 1118, possibly torsion catapults but more commonly in medieval times meaning traction trebuchets (powered by crews pulling ropes rather than by a counterweight). Another machine called *al-manjaniq* probably referred to a heavier trebuchet. [JOB pp 138-139; DNm pp 21-22; DNc p11]

M19. GUADALQUIVIR – *River and shore fleets*



Taifa Lords may March directly among Ports and Sevilla Taifa Cities and Towns where no Christian Lord

Lords. Taifa Muslims.

Tips. GUADALQUIVIR goes at the board edge, not at a mat (3.4.4). March actions with this Capability follow Group March (4.3.1), Laden (4.3.2), and Feed (4.3, 4.8.1) rules normally but may move directly between any two Locales listed that are free of Enemy Lords, rather than across a Way (4.3.3). In addition to Strongholds with Port symbols, origin and destination may include the Cities or Towns of Córdoba, Jaén, Baeza, Lorca, or Murcia. If the destination is an Enemy Stronghold, Besiege or Bypass it normally (4.3.5). Note that Yusuf as a Marshal cannot be a Lower Lord and so can never move via GUADALQUIVIR but Sir could under a Taifa Lord Lieutenant (4.1.3).

History. The great Guadalquivir River, navigable to Arab craft from Córdoba via Sevilla to the sea, formed an economic core to *al-Andalus*. It meshed with coastal sea-lanes that extended from Lisboa around Algeciras and up to Tortosa, served by considerable fleets out of Almería, Valencia, Tortosa, and the Balearic Islands. Andalusian fleets helped Yusuf capture the African port of Ceuta and aided his crossing to Algeciras in 1086. [AAJ; BRb pp3, 11-12, 72; DNm pp 15, 22] Muslim armies could have pressed the *taifas*’ commercial fleets into service as transport and logistical support elsewhere along the coasts and along the Guadalquivir.

M20. AL-RÛM – *Christian mercenaries*

This Lord pays 1 Coin (once) to Muster 2 Knights

If card discarded, remove them

Lords. Taifa Muslim.

Tips. See 3.4.2 ARTS OF WAR. The Taifa Lord with this Capability during a Muster segment in which he is eligible per 3.4 “Important” may pay for the units, for no actions. Sharing and Taifas box apply (1.3.3, 1.5.2). Discard removes the same number of units from that Lord’s mat.

History. The Cid may have been exceptional in his victories, but his occupation as a Christian captain in Muslim service was commonplace in the *taifa* period. The militarized and blossoming Christian communities of the less fertile north had the excess manpower, while the prosperous Muslim emirates of the south had the gold to pay. Christian captains were highly sought after and could receive high-level command in *taifa* armies. When *taifas* warred upon one another, Christian knights often met in battle against one another, both sides in service of Muslims. [IA p36; JM p40; RBS pp 16-17]

M22. WAR DRUMS

Yusuf, Sir, and Muslim Lieutenants Ravage for 1 extra Prov AND may Bypass without stopping

Lords. Yusuf, Sir, and any Muslim Lieutenants.

Tips. WAR DRUMS goes at the board edge, not at a mat (3.4.4). It applies to Yusuf and Sir at all times but to Taifa Lords only while Lieutenants (4.1.3). Ravage for 1 extra Prov means that, each time an eligible Lord succeeds in a Ravage action, add one Provender to that Lord’s mat beyond the Loot and/or Provender normally received (4.7.2). Ravage that has no effect because of Christian Capability #C19 CABALLERÍA VILLANA does not add extra Provender. Bypass without stopping means that the affected Lords may Bypass an Enemy Stronghold and then use a March action on the same Command card (4.3.4).

History. Numerous descriptions of Yusuf’s army note the booming of massed elephant-hide war drums. While the tale that the drums terrifying Christian troops sounds fanciful, Muslim forces clearly did use such drums for signaling during complicated field operations. [DWL p69; BC p254; JOB p132; DNe p15]

M23. COUNT OF BARCELONA

Unless COUNT OF BARCELONA with Christians, this Lord pays 2 Coin (once) to Muster 2 Knights, 2 Men-at-Arms until card discarded

Lords. Al-Mustain or al-Mundir.

Tips. See 3.4.2 ARTS OF WAR and Christian Capability #C13 COUNT OF BARCELONA. Taifas Coin applies (1.3.3). See also Christian and Muslim Events #C13/M23 BERENGUER RAMON.

History. See Geography—The Catalan Counties earlier in this booklet. [AAJ]

M24. AL-GARADA – *Long-range raids*

This Lord may pay 1 Prov to use entire card to Ravage across up to 2 Ways, not at or past any Unbesieged Enemy Lord

Lords. Taifa Muslim or Rodrigo al-Sayyid.

Tips and History. See Christian Capability #C14/C17 CABALGADAS.

M25. EL CID

This Lord on his Command card may play from deck SWOLEN RIVER, CAMP ATTACK, FEIGNED RETREAT, SPEAR WALL, or AFRICAN FLEET

Lords. Rodrigo al-Sayyid.

Tips and History. See Christian Capability #C25 EL CID.

M26. AL-FARAJ – *El Cid’s Muslim lieutenant*

This Lord may use Command card at or adjacent to Christian Lord to cause Christians to discard 1 random Held card

Lords. Rodrigo al-Sayyid.

Tips and History. See Christian Capability #C26 AL-FARAJ.

Heraldry and Fonts

by Ignacio Cobos Rey

Historical immersion and accuracy were a priority for the *Almoravid* team. We tried through extensive discussion to fit all the elements of the game into the realms and period of the action, such as in the embroidery design of the card backs inspired by the 11th-Century Bayeux Tapestry.

A topic that required intensive research was what symbols to use for the various lords. Heraldry, in the sense that we understand it today (family identity symbols passed from one generation to the next), did not exist at the time of the Almoravid intervention: it started to settle by the end of the 12th Century and was fully established by the end of the High Middle Ages (mid-13th Century). For the 11th Century, sources on heraldry are scarce.

We chose hanging banners rather than shields and, by necessity, adapted arms as needed from vague descriptions, sometimes recounted hundreds of years after the events of *Almoravid*. For García Ordóñez, Count of Nájera, whose heraldry proved impossible to document, we took the well-known 12th-Century arms of the city of Nájera, seat of the county. For the Muslim lords, sources were even scarcer. Moreover, Muslims for religious reasons widely banned figurative images. Most sources cite banners or pennants flying simply colors, geometrical patterns, or script such as the *Shahada*.

The fonts to be used for card titles and other decorative text also deserved some debate. It was clear that a font based on the Carolingian script, widely used in Christian Europe since the early 9th Century, would fit the time and region for the Christian lords. However, we also wanted to use a distinctive font for the Muslim faction. We faced the difficulty of not being able to use a proper Arab script for obvious reasons of our main player audience, and also we wanted to avoid falling in some kitsch of an overly adorned font. After an intensive search, we found that a stylised font inspired in the medieval Rotunda script could bring enough differentiation with respect to the canonical Carolingian script with just a little, acceptable concession, historically speaking.

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Source abbreviations used in this booklet:

- AAJ = Albert Alegre Jove
 BC = Catlos, *Kingdoms of Faith*
 BRa = Reilly, *The Kingdom of León-Castilla Under King Alfonso VI* (LIBRO pdf)
 BRb = Reilly, *The Contest between Christian and Muslim Spain*
 B&F = Barton and Fletcher, *The World of El Cid*
 CED = Estepa Díez, *El reinado de Alfonso VI*
 DNc = Nicolle, *El Cid and the Reconquista*
 DNm = Nicolle, *The Moors*
 DWL = Lomax, *The Reconquest of Spain*
 IA = Almond, *Two Faiths, One Banner*
 JM = Morris, *El Cid*
 JOa = O'Callaghan, *A History of Medieval Spain*
 JOB = O'Callaghan, *Reconquest and Crusade in Medieval Spain*
 JVB = Valdeón Baroque, *Cristianos, judíos y musulmanes*
 LPT = Peñarroja Torrejón, *Cristianos bajo el islam*
 Maderuelo.com = Maderuelo.com, *Edad Media: El Reino de Castilla en el siglo XI*
 MW = *Medieval Warfare VII-6*
 RBS = Bodley Scott, *Oath of Fealty*
 SB = Barton, *The World of El Cid*
 WM = Malczycki, *New Understanding of the Ulama*

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Arts of War – Card List

*This chart provides at a glance the numbers, titles, and pairings of each side's Arts of War cards.
See pages 47 to 64 for detailed notes on each Event and each Capability.*

No.	Christian Events	Christian Capabilities	No.	Muslim Events	Muslim Capabilities
C1	HILLS	BATTERING RAM	M1	HILLS	BATTERING RAM
C2	CAMP ATTACK	BALLESTEROS	M2	CAMP ATTACK	AQQARA
C3	SWOLLEN RIVER	ADALIDES	M3	SWOLLEN RIVER	HARBAH
C4	ARID TERRAIN	ARQUEROS	M4	ARID TERRAIN	ALRAMA
C5	DROUGHT	ARQUEROS	M5	DROUGHT	ALRAMA
C6	SURPRISE	SIEGE TOWERS	M6	FEIGNED RETREAT	HARBAH
C7	BAGGAGE PARAPET	JABALINAS	M7	SPEAR WALL	SLINGERS
C8	CANTADOR	HUESTE	M8	AHMAD IBN RUMAYLA	DAWUD IBN AISHA
C9	BETRAYAL OF TERMS	SLINGERS	M9	MALIKI ISLAM	EMIR AL-MUSLIMIN
C10	DEVALUATION	ADALIDES	M10	FATWA	ANDALUSIANS
C11	INDULGENCES	MESNADA	M11	AL-QADIR	HASHAM
C12	SONG OF ROLAND	MESNADA	M12	TAIFA MARRIAGE	AL-YAZIRAT AL-HADRA
C13	BERENGUER RAMON	COUNT OF BARCELONA	M13	SEVERED HEADS	SIEGE TOWERS
C14	POPE GREGORY	CABALGADAS	M14	DEVALUATION	RIBAT MONKS
C15	CLUNIACS	ALFÉREZ	M15	PARIAS REVOLT	SAQALIBAH
C16	BERNARD DE SÉDIRAC	CATHEDRALS	M16	GALICIAN REVOLT	CAMELS
C17	GENOA & PISA	CABALGADAS	M17	LEÓN Y CASTILLA	ARRADA
C18	RUNAWAY SLAVES	MILITES	M18	REFUGEES	RIBAT MONKS
C19	FITNA	CABALLERÍA VILLANA	M19	AFRICAN FLEET	GUADALQUIVIR
C20	AL-QADIR	FUEROS	M20	MUDÉJARES	AL-RÛM
C21	MOZÁRABES	SISNANDO DAVIDEZ	M21	AL-SUMAISIR	HASHAM
C22	BERBERS	BISHOPRICS	M22	MASSACRE	WAR DRUMS
C23	ILLNESS OF THE EMIR	FONSADERA	M23	BERENGUER RAMON	COUNT OF BARCELONA
C24	ABU BAKR IBN UMAR	GARCÍA JIMÉNEZ	M24	AL-MAGHAWIR	AL-GARADA
C25	DE VIVAR	EL CID	M25	FREEBOOTER	EL CID
C26	FREEBOOTER	AL-FARAJ	M26	FREEBOOTER	AL-FARAJ



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